

EasyGradePro4.0 [®]

UserManual

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1 Getting Started

Welcome to EasyGradePro from Orbis Software. With EasyGradePro you can create an electronic gradebook which, like a paper gradebook, can be used to store student information for all of your classes and subjects. Better than a paper gradebook, an EasyGradePro gradebook provides an abundance of tools to save you time, provides you with a wealth of information, and allows you to generate professional paper and internet reports.

System Requirements

EasyGradePro is shipped as a MAC-only, WIN-only or a MAC/WIN cross-platform product. See the License label for specific information about the platforms included on the CD with this package.

Requirements:

- *Macintosh: OS 10.2 or higher*
- *Windows: 2000, XP or higher*
- *Memory: 128 MB or higher*
- *Hard drive space: 10 MB for installation and data files*
- *Monitor: 800x600 or higher resolution with thousands of colors*
- *CD-ROM drive: for installation only*

Installing EasyGradePro

Important note: be sure to log into the computer as the computer's Administrator before installing. Otherwise, the computer may block the EasyGradePro installer or block the registration process.

For Macintosh:

1 Insert the installation CD.

2 Double-click the icon of the CD. In the window that appears, double-click the EasyGradePro 4.0 In-

staller icon and follow the steps. Eject and store the disk.

3 Start EasyGrade Pro by double-clicking the EasyGrade Pro 4.0 icon in the EasyGrade Pro folder in the Applications folder.

For Windows:

1 Insert the installation CD and follow the instructions that appear automatically. If nothing appears, choose Run from the Start menu, type `D:\setup.exe` and press enter. Use the drive letter for your CD-ROM drive in place of D. Eject and store the disk.

2 Start EasyGrade Pro by clicking on Start in the corner of the screen, choosing All Programs, and then choosing EasyGrade Pro.

FAQ: Can EasyGrade Pro be networked?

Because servers are generally slower and less reliable than the hard drives attached directly to computers, we recommend that you install EasyGrade Pro directly to each computer and not to a server.

EasyGrade Pro for Macintosh can be installed to a server using the standard installation instructions. EasyGrade Pro for Windows can also be installed to a server but you will need to copy the ProductID key (at `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Uninstall\EasyGradePro`) to each workstation before the program can be used. Otherwise, EasyGrade Pro will display an error message that it has not been properly installed.

Registering EasyGrade Pro

The first time you use EasyGrade Pro, a registration window will automatically appear. Carefully type the registration (license) number found on the License label. If you are upgrading from an older version, use your original license number. Be sure to include the dashes. Click OK. Then type the registration name (school name for a site license or teacher name for a single-user license) and click OK. Be careful when entering the registration name because it will appear near the top of all reports.

FAQ: Why am I getting an error message when I try to register EasyGrade Pro?

If you are getting an error message after you type in the number and name, it is most likely due to a permissions problem. Your computer may be blocking EasyGrade Pro's attempt to save this information because your login account doesn't have a high enough permissions level. The solution is to log into the computer using the computer's administrator's account just long enough to enter the number and name.

Updating an older version of EasyGrade Pro

If you have an older version of EasyGrade Pro on your computer, it is recommended that you first install the new version of EasyGrade Pro following the instructions for installing and registering EasyGrade Pro in the prior sections.

Deleting the older version of EasyGrade Pro:

On Windows, you do not need to uninstall the older version. The EasyGrade Pro 4.0 installer will replace

the old version of EasyGradePro if it is its normal location at C:\Program Files\Orbis Software\EasyGradePro.

On Macintosh, the EasyGradePro 4.0 installer will not replace the old version. It is recommended that you find the old version and drag it to the Trash can and empty the trash. Warning: do not trash any gradebooks that you'd like to continue using with the new version.

Converting older gradebooks to V4.0:

EasyGradePro 4.0 can open all gradebooks created with old versions of EasyGradePro beginning with version 2.0. Here's how:

1 Startup EasyGradePro 4.0.

2 If a gradebook opens, choose Close from the File menu.

3 Choose Open from the File menu.

4 In the window that opens, navigate to the older gradebook, select it and click the Open button.

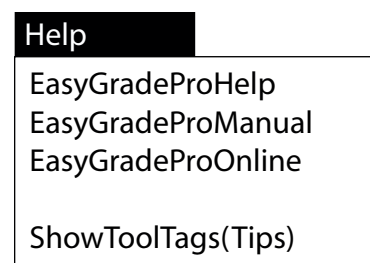
EasyGradePro will inform you that the gradebook is from an old version and ask if it should be converted. If you click Yes, EasyGradePro will make a copy of the gradebook and then convert the copy. The original gradebook will not be affected.

Learning EasyGradePro

EasyGradePro 4.0 offers many tools to help you learn how to use it. These tools include:

- EasyGradePro User Manual (pdf)
- EasyGradePro Help
- EasyGradePro Online
- ToolTags (Macintosh) and ToolTips (Windows)

All of these items can be accessed from the EasyGradePro Help menu.



The most thorough source of information about EasyGradePro is this EasyGradePro User Manual. It is designed to teach you how to use EasyGradePro. It begins with a Tutorial and then explains step-by-step how to start your own gradebook, add classes, set options, add students and so on. The manual comes as an electronic pdf file. PDF, or portable document format, is a standard format for sharing readable docu-

ments on computers. If your computer does not have the ability to open pdf files, free Reader software can be downloaded from www.adobe.com. With this program, you can view the manual on screen. You can also print some or all of the pages.

To view the EasyGradePro User Manual:

- Start EasyGradePro. From the Help menu, choose EasyGradePro Manual.
- Alternate method: With Windows press on Start, choose All Programs -> EasyGradePro -> EGP User Manual. With Macintosh, the manual can be found in the EasyGradePro folder in the Applications folder.

The quickest way to get an answer to a question while using EasyGradePro is through EasyGradePro's in-context Help. It provides information about the part of the program you are currently using so that you don't have to spend a lot of time searching for what you need.

To view Help:

Choose EasyGradePro Help from the Help menu or click on the Help tool



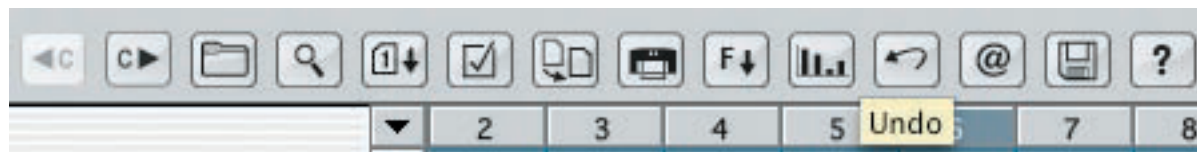
found on the Toolbar.

For the most current information about EasyGradePro, technical support information, update information, or plug-in files with educational standards from different states, visit the EasyGradePro website.

To view the EasyGradePro website:

- Choose EasyGradePro Online from the Help menu
- Alternate method: browse to www.easygradepro.com.

If you are unsure of the function of any tool on the toolbar, simply point your mouse to the tool. A small box, known as a *tool tag* (Macintosh) or *tooltip* (Windows) will appear below the tool with the name of the tool.



To turn on/off tool tips or tool tags:

Show Tool Tags (Tips) from the Help menu.

FAQ: What is the best way to learn the basics of EasyGradePro in the shortest amount of time?

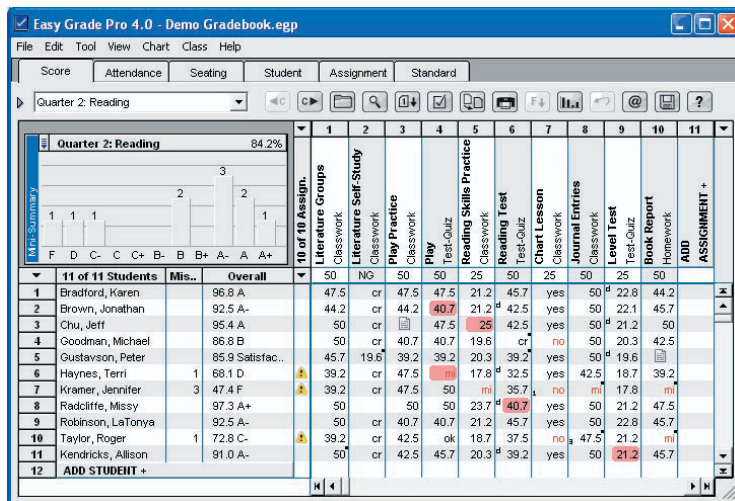
If you are new to EasyGradePro, we enthusiastically recommend that you take a tour of EasyGradePro by going through the Tutorial found both in the user manual (starting on the next page) and the in-context Help. The time spent taking this tour will be time that you save later. It will also help you get started right!

2 Tutorial: Four Short Lessons

The lessons in this chapter will introduce you to the structure, tools and options found in EasyGrade Pro. The time spent here will almost certainly save you as much and more time later. The word to remember is *explore*; these lessons are meant to be springboards for your own exploration of EasyGrade Pro.

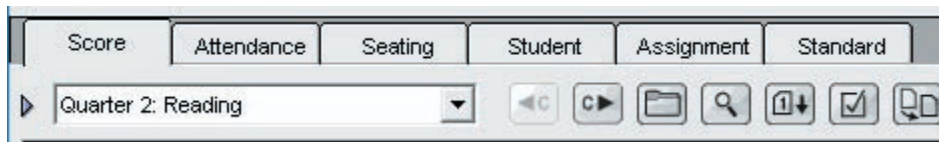
Lesson 1: Moving around in a Gradebook

1 Open the gradebook named Demo Gradebook. To do this on a Macintosh computer, double-click on the icon titled Demo Gradebook found inside the EasyGrade Pro Folder. On a Windows computer, click on Start in the corner of your screen, point to Programs, point to EasyGrade Pro and click Demo Gradebook.



You should be viewing the gradebook of a fictitious sixth grade teacher, Ms. Demo, who teaches reading, math, language arts and science. She also teaches science to the students in the other sixth grade class. The other sixth grade teacher teaches Social Studies to both groups. Ms. Demo is currently in the second quarter of the school year and you are reviewing the score chart for the class Quarter 2: Reading. Notice the name

of this class on the toolbar.



The Class menu on the toolbar indicates that the class being viewed is Quarter 2: Reading. This menu can be used to switch to any class in any term of a gradebook.

2 Press on the Class menu on the toolbar to switch to Quarter 2: Math. Notice that Ms. Demo's math class has most of the same students as her reading class but the assignments are different.

3 Use the Class menu to move to Quarter 2: Science-1 and then to Quarter 2: Science-2. Recall that Ms. Demo teaches science to both sixth grade classes. The science classes have the same assignments but different students. To save time, Ms. Demo enters assignments into just one science class and then copies them to the other class. You'll have a chance to do this in Lesson 2.

4 Move to the Social Studies class to view a class imported from the other sixth grade teacher's gradebook. Notice that the students are the same but other items are different because this class was created by the other sixth grade teacher. Although Ms. Demo does not teach this class, she wants to keep track of her students' performance in all classes and wants to include their Social Studies grades in the progress reports sent to parents and posted on her website. So, periodically, she imports the entire Social Studies class from her associate's EasyGrade Pro gradebook using a floppy disk or her school's network.

5 Switch back to Quarter 2: Reading. Now, click on the Attend. tab above the Class menu to switch to the attendance chart. *Makesure that you are reviewing Quarter 2: Reading.* Notice that the new chart displays dates and attendance marks. Ms. Demo takes attendance in just one class, Reading, because it is the first class of her day. She could, if she wanted to, take attendance in any or all classes.

6 A class actually has six different charts: score, attendance, seating, student, assignment and standard. Although Ms. Demo spends most of her time using the Score chart, she does use the others on occasion. Use the tabs above the Class menu to switch to each of the charts. In the student and assignment charts, be sure to use the scroll bars so that you can view all the different columns.

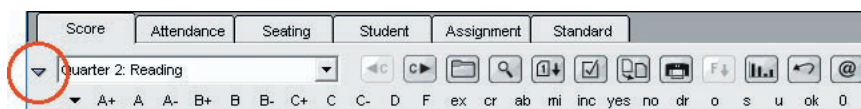
7 Each class in a gradebook can have its own students, assignments and configuration of the charts. Before moving on to Lesson 2, take a few moments to use the Class menu, the Prior Class  and Next Class  tools, and chart tabs to examine the rest of Ms. Demo's gradebook. Remember, *explore!*

Lesson 2: Adding Assignments and Scores

The most time-consuming task in the grading process is that of adding assignments and scores. EasyGrade Pro provides many tools to make this as easy and fast. In this lesson, you'll be introduced to some of these tools. To begin this lesson, the Demo Gradebook must be open and the score chart must be visible.

1 Using the Class menu, move to Quarter 2: Science-1. You'll know that you are in this class when its title is visible on the toolbar. Be sure you are reviewing the score chart. If necessary, click the Score tab or choose Score from the Chart menu.

2 To prepare for the entering of scores, click the small triangle below-left of the first tab so that the triangle points downwards. The triangle (circled below) shows and hides a row of grades and special scores.



Click on the triangle (circled above) to show the row of grades and special scores below the tools.

3 Click the Add Assignment button visible after the last assignment or choose Add Assignment from the Tool menu. After clicking, the Records window will open to an empty assignment record.

The Records window is used to add assignments, students and classes to a gradebook.

4 In the Name field, type *StarLab*.

5 Press tab to move to the Max. Score field. Type 25.

6 Press tab to move to the Points field. Type 100. For a detailed explanation of maximum score and points, see *FAQ: What are maximum score and points? How should I set them?* on page 44.

7 Set the due date of the assignment by clicking on the calendar. The date is used by Easy Grade Pro when sorting, using filters to show or hide certain assignments and when producing graphs.

8 Press on the Category menu and select *Classwork*. The category is used when sorting assignments, in filters, graphs, summaries, reports and in grading if you have category weighting turned on. You can view, edit and create score categories in the Class Options window but you'll see this later.

9 Click the Done button. You should be viewing the score chart again. The first score cell under the new assignment's title should have the flashing cursor in it. If not, click on the first empty box under the *StarLab* assignment.

10 Now it's time to enter scores. Just to make things interesting, you'll enter scores in several different ways. Follow the directions below to enter the first four scores. If you make a mistake, simply click on the score cell with the error and try again.

Student #1: Type the number 25 and press enter.

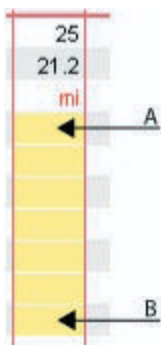
Student #2: Click on the B grade on the toolbar. *Do not* press the enter key because the next cell is automatically selected after clicking. You can set up the grades that appear on the toolbar. In fact, you can have a different set of grades for each student and for each category.

Student#3: Press the letter *m*. This enters a score of *m* for missing. You can customize up to thirty special scores and give them any meaning you wish. Notice that the score returns red. Ms. Demohas set things up so that all failing scores are displayed in red.

Student#4: Type the number 25. *Do not* press enter. Now click the Fill Down tool  on the toolbar. Notice that 25 is repeated all the way down.

11 Click the Undo tool  on the toolbar or choose Undo from the Edit menu to prepare for the next step. Notice that the score of 25 is removed from the students. Undo is nearly always available to reverse the last action.

12 Select these seven blank score cells by pressing on the first and dragging to the last. Release the mouse. These seven score cells should be highlighted as shown below.



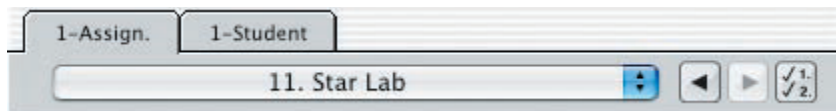
Press on A and drag down to B to highlight the score cells.

13 Click on the A+ grade on the toolbar. A score of 25 is entered for each student. Try clicking on other grades and special scores on the toolbar.

Ms. Demohas decided to begin assessing her students based on her school district's educational standards. She also has decided to ease into standards-based grading by focusing just on science at first. If you are interested in learning about EasyGradePro's standards-based grading tools, proceed with the next set of steps. Otherwise, skip ahead to step 19.

14 Click on the Standard tab or choose Standard from the Chart menu.

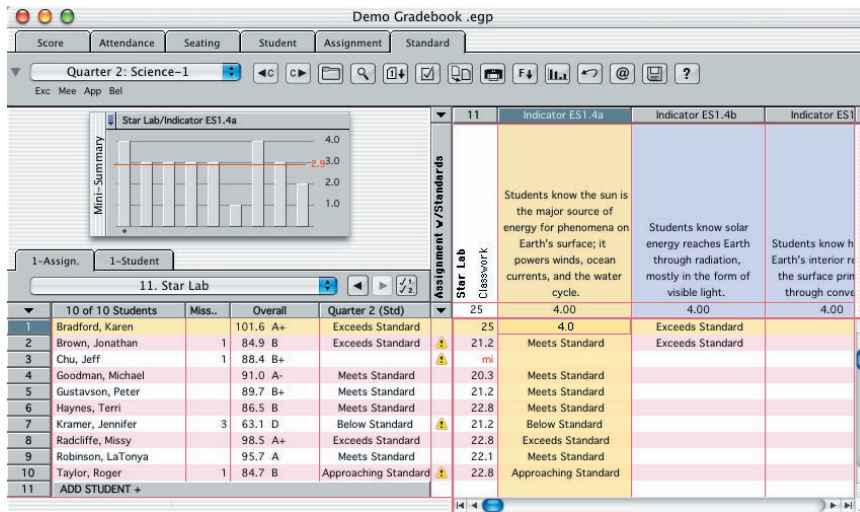
You should be viewing the Standard chart in the class Quarter 2-Science-1. Notice that there is a second toolbar with tabs labeled *1-Assign.* and *1-Student.* Below these is a menu with the name of an assignment. To the right, are three tools. Make sure that the *1-Assign.* tab is selected.



15 Press on the menu and choose *11.StarLab*. Or click on the Next Item tool  until the menu displays *11.StarLab* (shown above). Note that the StarLab assignment will appear in the first column to the right.

With EasyGradePro's standards-based grading features, every assignment can have up to ten standards linked to it for independent scoring. These standards can be very diverse from having to do with spelling, completion, effort, skills and knowledge. Summaries of performance on standards can be viewed and printed that are independent of any specific assignment. In the next step, you'll select three knowledge standards that correlate to the Star Lab activity.

16 Press on the Standard tool  and, from the menu that pops up, select the following standards: *ES1.4A*, *ES1.4B* and *ES1.4C*. You'll know that you've selected them if they appear in the column to the right of the Star Lab column as shown below.



Ms. Demo did not need to type these standards into EasyGradePro. In fact, she easily imported them into this class from special plugin files.

At the top of each standard column is the standard's ID--a unique identifier for the standard. Below this is the standard's text and a number that represents the value of the highest rubric label. Ms. Demo set up a single rubric as follows: *Exceeds Standard* (4.0), *Meets Standard* (3.0), *Approaching Standard* (2.0) and *Below Standard* (1.0). If she had wanted to, she could have set up multiple rubrics for her standards.

Notice the blue color behind the standard text. This color indicates the level of the standard. In EasyGradePro, standards can be at three levels. By default, these levels are Standard, Strand and Indicator but these labels and colors can be changed.

Notice that the scores entered in steps 10 through 13 are present in the Star Lab assignment column. These scores could just have easily been entered in this chart instead of in the Score chart.

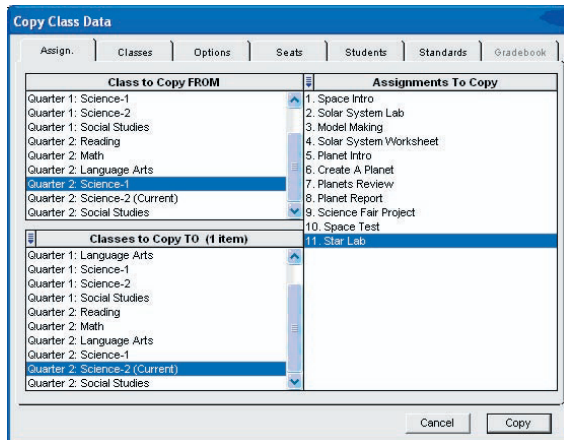
17 Click on the first score cell under the *ES1.4A* column. Notice that the grade clicks bar displays the rubric labels. Enter scores on all three standards using the same technique taught in steps 10 through 13.

18 When done entering the scores, click the Score tab or choose Score from the Chart menu.

Recall that Ms. Demoteachestwoscienceclassesandbothhavethesameassignments.Itiseasytocopy assignmentsfromoneclasstoanother.Inthenextfewsteps,you'lldojustthat.

19 Using the Class menu on the toolbar, move to Quarter 2: Science-2.

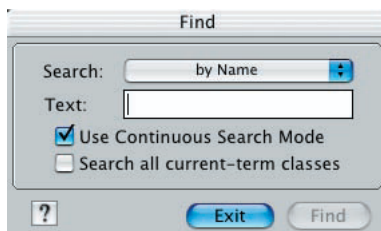
20 Click on the Copy Class Data tool  or choose Copy->Assignments... from the Tool menu. The Copy Class Data window will open. The Copy window can be used to copy assignments, students, options and other class data. It can copy several items together and copy them to several classes at the same time.



21 First click on the Assign. tab at the top. In the top-left list, click on Quarter 2: Science-1. In the bottom-left list, click on Quarter 2: Science-2. In the right-hand list, click on Star Lab. Finally, click Copy. The assignment will be copied from Science-1 to Science-2. After the window closes, the first score cell for the new assignment will be selected, ready for you to enter scores.

The rest of this lesson will focus on entering scores for the copied assignment. You'll use a very powerful tool that allows you to easily enter scores from a mixed stack of papers. Since you don't actually have the student papers, you'll simply pretend.

22 Click on the Find  tool on the toolbar or choose Find from the Tool menu. The Find window will open.



23 Select *Use Continuous Search Mode*. Then click Exit--you *must* close the Find window. The continuous search mode causes EasyGrade Pro to return to the Find window after every score is entered. This means that whenever the enter key is pressed, or whenever a grade is clicked on the toolbar, the Find window will reopen automatically.

24 In the score chart, select the first score cell for the Star Lab assignment. This score cell is for Kelly Armstrong.

25 You will be pretending to enter scores directly from student papers. Follow these steps:

Paper#1: In Kelly Armstrong's score cell, type 25 and press enter. The Find window will reopen.

Paper#2: The next paper belongs to Josef Talbo. In the Find window, type the letter *T* and notice that Easy Grade Pro completes it with 'Talbo, Josef'. Press enter. Now click *Sa* on the toolbar. The Find window reopens.

Paper#3: Tad Nguyen earned a 20. Type an *N* in the Find window and press enter. Type a 20 and press enter again.

Paper#4: Justin Bronine earned an 18. Type the letter *B* and notice that Easy Grade Pro completes it with 'Benjamin, Atunde'. Type the letter *R* and notice that Easy Grade Pro completes it with 'Bronin, Justin'. Press enter. Type his score.

Go ahead and finish the remaining scores on your own--just make them up! When you are done, be sure to deselect the Use Continuous Search Mode box so the Find window will stop reappearing. By the way, the Find window and the continuous search mode work in *all* of Easy Grade Pro's charts: score, attendance, seat, student, assignment and standard.

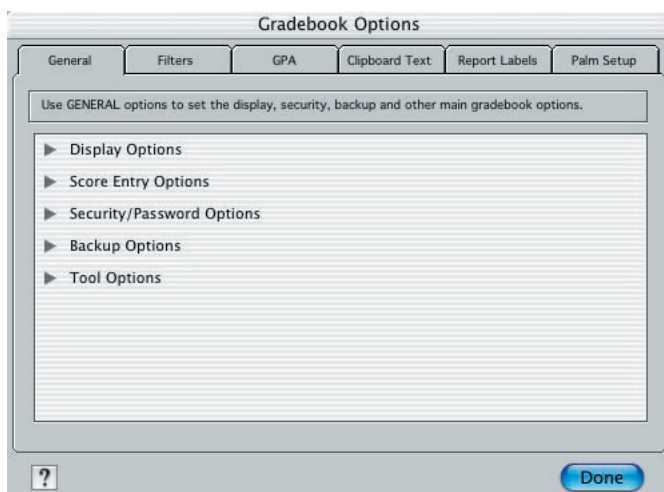
Lesson 3: Options and Tools

This lesson, which has been divided into five short parts, will guide you in an exploration of some of the options and tools within a gradebook. To begin this lesson, the Demo Gradebook must be open.

Part A: Gradebook Options and Class Options

Easy Grade Pro offers an abundance of options to accommodate your personal style. Some options, such as font and font size, affect the entire gradebook and are called Gradebook Options. But many options apply only to a single class; these are called Class Options and include items like grade scales, categories, weighting, calendars, colors and more. In this section, you'll view both types of options. Don't forget to utilize the Help tool to gain additional information about the options.

1 Select Gradebook Options from the Edit menu and explore all tabs. Click Done.



2 Select Class Options from the Edit menu and explore all tabs. Click Done.

Class Options for Quarter 2: Science-2

Grade | Rubric | Category | Footnote | Score | Attend. | Calendar | Term | Seat | Color

Use GRADE options to set up the grade scale(s) for this class. Since students are initially assigned Scale #1, your main scale should be dragged to that position.

Select a Grade Scale	Grades in Scale	Minimum%
1 Standard Scale	1 A+	97
2 OSU Scale	2 A	93
3 Pass-Fail Scale	3 A-	90
	4 B+	87
	5 B	83
	6 B-	80
	7 C+	77
	8 C	73
	9 C-	70
	10 D	60

Rounding level for calculated percents:
Tenths

Cancel Done

Part B: Adding a New Data Column

You have many ways to configure the charts so that they best suit your needs. In the score chart, for example, special columns can be added which show class rank, points, or nearly any other data about your students. The next few steps will show you how to do add special columns.

1 Switch to the score chart view of Quarter 2: Reading. Above the column of student names, press on the *11 of 11 Students* title (shown below).

▼ 11 of 11 Students
1 Bradford, Karen
2 Brown, Jonathan
3 Chu, Jeff
4 Goodman, Michael
5 Gustavson, Peter
6 Haynes, Terri
7 Kramer, Jennifer
8 Radcliffe, Missy
9 Robinson, LaTonya
10 Taylor, Roger
11 Kendricks, Allison

2 From the menu that appears, choose *Add NEW Column* (first item). A new column will appear to the immediate right. It will also be titled *11 of 11 Students*.

3 Press on the new column's title and choose *Main Grades -> Class Rank*. The title and content of the column will change to display the rank for each student.

4 To resize the new column, move the mouse so that the arrow is over the line to the right of the *Class Rank* title. Press and drag the line to the left or right.

▼ 11 of 11 Students
1 Bradford, Karen
2 Brown, Jonathan
3 Chu, Jeff
4 Goodman, Michael
5 Gustavson, Peter
6 Haynes, Terri
7 Kramer, Jennifer
8 Radcliffe, Missy
9 Robinson, LaTonya
10 Taylor, Roger
11 Kendricks, Allison

5 To relocate the new column, press on any cell below the title. The cursor will change to a hand. Drag the column left or right to the new position and let go.

6 Press on any student's name. The cursor will change to a hand but you won't be able to drag the column left or right. However, you can drag the student's row up or down to a new row position. Try moving students to new rows. This also works on assignments: press on an assignment's title and drag left or right to move the assignment to a new location.

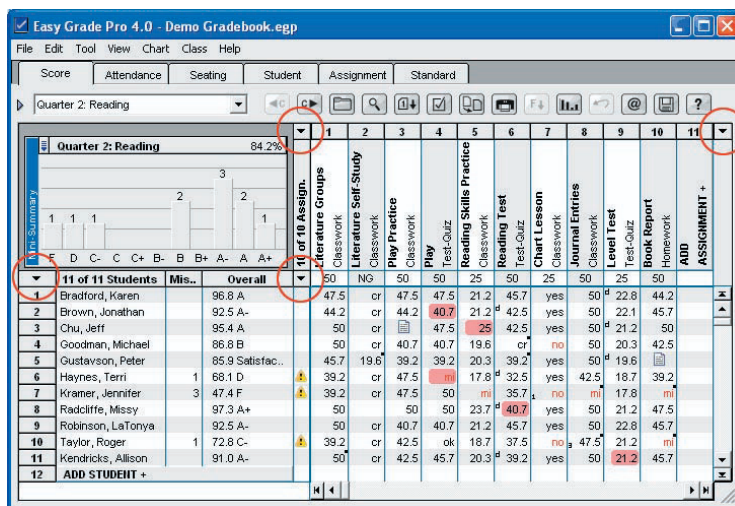
Add up to eight data columns in both the score and attendance charts. Resize and relocate them. Go ahead and explore.

Part C: Using Filters

Easy Grade Pro allows you to configure the charts so that they display just the students, assignments, scores or attendance data that you would like to see. In this section, you will explore ways to do this.

1 Switch to the score chart and explore the four filter menus (circled below).

2 Switch to the other charts (except seating); find and explore the filter menus.



Press on the four menus (circled) to filter students and assignments and to set the display of scores.

Part D: Setting the Display of Seats and Furniture

The seating chart allows you to place seats and furniture nearly anywhere. It also allows you to change the shape, size, rotation and color of these items. Use the Chart menu or tab to switch to the seating chart. Then try these:

- Move a single item by dragging it.
- Swap two seats by dragging one to another. (The upper-left corners must be aligned.)
- Select more than one item by clicking while holding down the shift key or by dragging a rectangle around the seats.
- Drag a group of selected items.
- Double-click on a seat to open the Seat Options window. Try different settings.
- Double-click on a piece of furniture to open the Furniture Options window. Try different settings.

Part E: Other Tools and Windows

Many special windows can be opened by double-clicking, right-clicking and control-clicking in different regions of the charts. Try these suggestions for opening special windows in the score chart:

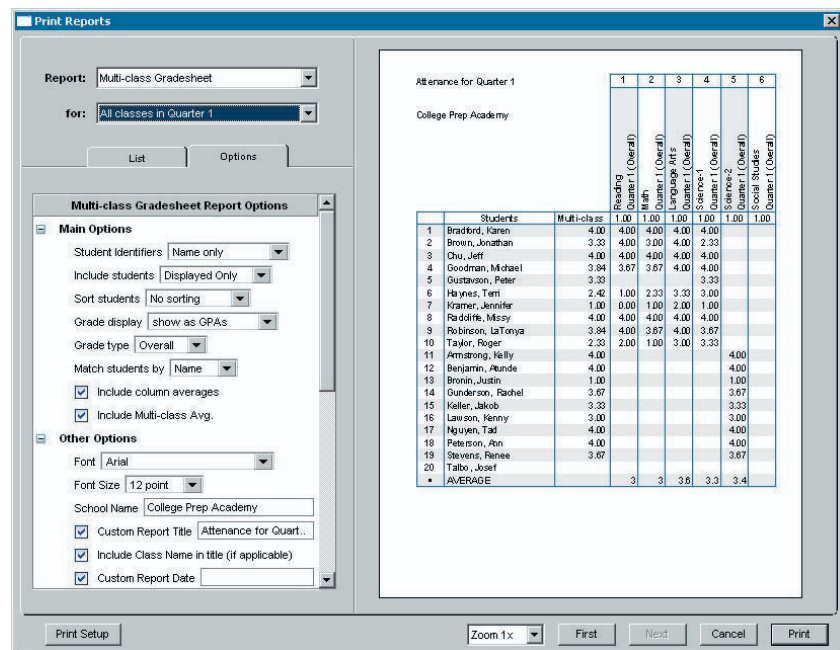
- Double-click on a row number or column number to open the Summaries window for that item.
- Double-click on any student or assignment name to open the Records window.
- Double-click on any score cell to open the Score Note window.
- Single-click in the small box to the left of the first score for any student to open the Lock/Curve Grade window.
- Right-click (Windows) or control-click (Macintosh) on student names and assignment names.

Lesson 4: Working with Reports

In this lesson, you will be taken through the steps of selecting a report, its range and options. Then, instead of printing the report, you will preview the report on screen. The Demo Gradebook should be open. You can be in any class.

1 Click the Print  tool on the toolbar or choose Print from the File menu. The Print Reports window will open.

2 Choose a Report from the Reports menu near the top. Then explore all the tabs and buttons in the window. Notice how, as you change options, the preview changes immediately. If the preview is too large to view in its entirety, press on it with the mouse to grab the page and drag it about. Try different reports and different options. Remember: *explore!*



3 Click the Cancel button to close the Print Reports window.

This is the end of Lesson 4 and the end of this tutorial. By the way, the changes that you made during these lessons have been automatically saved. With EasyGradePro, changes are always automatically saved. If you are ready to create your gradebook for your own classes, proceed to the next chapter.

3 Gradebooks and Classes

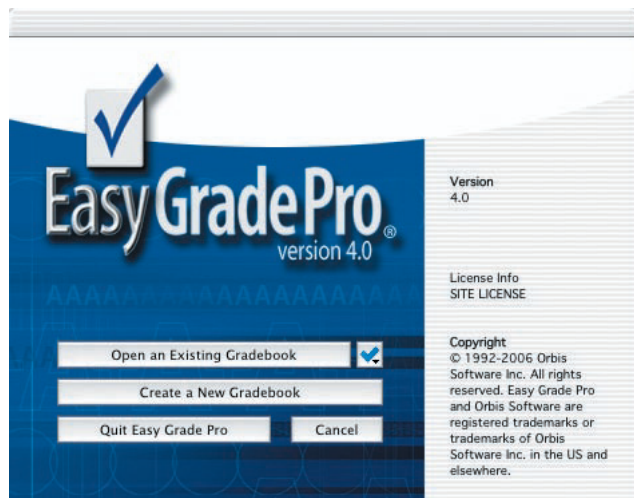
This chapter is for you if you are ready to begin using Easy Grade Pro to manage your student data. It will take you through the steps of creating a gradebook, adding classes and a few other basic tasks.

Starting a New Gradebook

You're likely to need only a single Easy Grade Pro gradebook at a time. Since a gradebook can hold up to 250 classes in up to ten terms, you might want to use a single gradebook for an entire school year because it saves time and minimizes the duplication of efforts. Since a gradebook can become large, you may want to create a new gradebook for each major term. Don't do this, however, if the student grades in one term must be combined with the grades in another.

To start a new gradebook:

1 Start Easy Grade Pro. On a Macintosh, do this by double-clicking on the Easy Grade Pro 3.6 icon in the Easy Grade Pro folder. On a Windows computer, do this by clicking on Start, choosing Programs, and then choosing Easy Grade Pro. A title window will appear (shown below).



2 Click the *Create a New Gradebook* button. The standard Save window will open where you can name and choose a location for your new gradebook.

3 In the Save window, type the name of your new gradebook. What names should you give it? We recommend that you use your last name and the year (or term) such as *Smith2003-4* or *Smith Winter Term 2003*.

4 Choose the location for your gradebook. We recommend that you save it to your computer's Desktop because 1) you'll have ready access to it, 2) you'll be able to open it easily by double-clicking its icon, and 3) the Desktop is a reliable place to store an important file since it is part of your computer's hard drive.

5 Click the Save button. EasyGradePro will create an empty gradebook and open the gradebook's window.

FAQ: EasyGradePro saves automatically. What does this mean?

Likemany programs that deal with large amounts of data, EasyGradePro automatically saves your changes while you work. When you switch classes, switch charts, choose most menu commands or even pause for a few moments, you trigger EasyGradePro's save feature, causing it to write changes to your gradebook file.

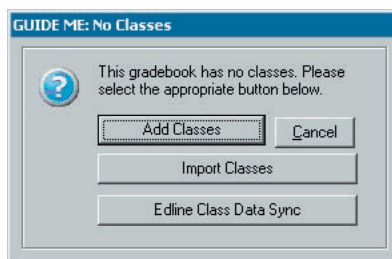
In EasyGradePro's File menu, there is no Save command; you never manually save your work. However, there is a Save Copy command and, when you close a gradebook, there may be a prompt for saving a copy. It is highly recommended that you make copies of your gradebook but keep in mind that these are copies -- they should never be used unless something happens to make your original gradebook unusable.

Adding Classes to a Gradebook

In EasyGradePro, a class is a collection of students and their data for a single subject in a single term. A subject might be Reading, Math, Physics or Art History. A term might be Quarter 1, Semester 2 or even Final Exam.

It is generally best to have a one-to-one correspondence between the classes that you teach and the classes in your gradebook. If you teach five subjects this term, you probably should have five classes in the current term of your gradebook. If you teach multiple sections of the same class (i.e. three sections of Earth Science), there generally is no benefit to combining these sections into a single class. EasyGradePro makes it easy to switch from one class to another and to copy assignments and options from one class to others. By keeping your classes separate, you will be able to view summaries of each making it easy to make comparisons. If you are an elementary teacher with multiple reading (or math) groups from your main group of students, you can choose to have all groups in a single class or break them into separate classes. EasyGradePro can handle either setup well.

If you have just created a new gradebook, one without classes, a window will automatically appear (shown below) directing you to add classes.



Obviously, a gradebook without classes is not very usable, so it is a good idea to click the Add Classes button. Here are some general guidelines about adding classes to a gradebook:

- Add a class to the gradebook for each class you teach in your current term only.
- *Do not* add classes for future terms; it is best to add them later.

To add a class:

1 If your gradebook has no classes, click the Add Classes button. Otherwise, choose Add Class from the Tool menu. In either case, the Records window will open (shown below) to an empty class record.

Term Labels	Terms	Custom Labels	Custom Data
Term 1		Custom 1	
Term 2		Custom 2	
Term 3		Custom 3	
Term 4		Custom 4	
Term 5		Custom 5	
Term 6		Custom 6	
Term 7		Custom 7	
Term 8		Custom 8	

2 Type the name of the class in the Class / Subject Name field and press **Tab**. Be sure to use a unique name for the class. Examples include Math, Reading, English (1), English (2), etc. Do not include a term name with the name of the class.

3 (Optional) Edit the Class Weight and press **Tab**. It's not likely that you'll ever need to change the class weight. It is used only in the multi-class progress report and the multi-class gradesheet report when a student's weighted average or GPA for several classes is calculated. In most cases it should be left at 1.00. If you have a class that is worth half of a normal class, set the class weight to 0.50 and so on.

4 Edit the Term Labels in the column on the left so that they match the term labels used by your school. You can use First 6 Weeks, Quarter 1, Semester 2, etc. If you will give a final exam that must be weighted, then you must add the final exam as a term. Changes made to these labels will apply to all classes so you won't have to change them again in the gradebook.

5 Select the current term for the class by clicking in the box to the right of your current term's label. A checkmark 'x' will appear. You must select at least one term and you may select more. We recommend that you select your current term only. Later on, when you are ready to begin the next term, you can add a new term.

6 (Optional) Edit the Custom Labels and enter Custom Data. These eight custom fields are very important to some users of Easy Grade Pro but are not used by most. They are used to hold course number, section number, teacher name and other course-specific data. These values are critical if you will be importing your student rosters from school administration software and exporting grades. These are also used when uploading internet reports to Edline or Basmati. Generally, you won't use them unless your school in-

structs you to do so.

7 (Optional) To add more classes, click the Next Class button. Then repeat steps 2 through 6.

8 Click Done to close the Records window. To switch to the different classes, use the Class menu or the Prior Class  and Next Class  tools.

Managing the Classes in your Gradebook

You can add, delete and rename your classes. You can sort them into any order. Terms can be added to classes and terms can be renamed. This section explains how to perform these basic tasks.

To add a class:

To add a new class, follow the steps found on the prior page. Note: if you need to add a new term to an existing class, see *To add a term to an existing class* below.

To delete a class:

- 1 Choose Delete -> Class from the Tool menu. The Delete Records window will open with a list of all the classes in the gradebook.
- 2 Select the class or classes to delete from the list. Press on the blue arrow to select or deselect all items in the list.
- 3 Click the Delete button.

To rename a class:

- 1 Use the Class menu to switch to the class.
- 2 Choose Records from the Chart menu or click the Record stool .
- 3 Select the Classes tab.
- 4 Edit the name of the class and click Done.

To sort or reorder your classes:

- 1 Choose Sort Classes from the View menu. The Sort Classes window will open.
- 2 Press on classes and drag them to the desired locations in the list. Use the sample class menu at the top of the window to view the effects of your changes.
- 3 Click Done.

To add a term to an existing class:

We recommend that you wait until right before the start of the new term before adding a term to a class.

- 1 Use the Class menu to switch to the class.
- 2 From the Tool menu, choose Term Tools -> Start New Term. Easy Grade Pro will automatically put a check or 'x' for the appropriate term in the Records window for the class. It will then switch to the new term and automatically copy the students to it from the prior term. Be sure to take a look at *Working with Terms* on page 81 for a thorough discussion of this topic.

To rename a term:

- 1 Choose Records from the Chart menu or click the Record stool .
- 2 Select the Classes tab.
- 3 Edit the name of the term. This change applies to all classes in a gradebook.

4 Setting Options

EasyGradePro attempts to accommodate your grading style by providing options on two levels: classes as well as gradebook. *Class options* apply to a single class in one term. *Gradebook options* apply to all classes. Since getting EasyGradePro to match your style is so important, this chapter should not be missed!

About Class Options

Each class within your gradebook has its own grading scales, score categories, special scores, attendance categories and other options. Together, these are known as class options because they are stored with the class and are unique to it.

A class does not have options until you view it for the first time; EasyGradePro will automatically copy options into it from another class, either from a prior-term class or from an adjacent one. If there is no 'other' class because it's your first one, EasyGradePro will copy from a built-in set and display a message letting you know what it has done. Since the built-in set is unlikely to match your style, you'll want to edit it as soon as possible, ideally before you view other classes.

To view or edit the options, choose Class Options from the Edit menu or click the Class Option tool



. In the window that opens, you'll find a series of tabs, one for each type of option. There is a section in this chapter for the options found under each tab except for the *Rubric* tab, which is covered on page 62, and the *Term* tab, which is covered in page 81.

Keep in mind that the changes you make to the options will have no effect on other existing classes in your gradebook. This allows you to have options that vary from class to class and term to term. However, since you'll likely have some options that you'll want the same in all classes, be sure to read the section *Copying Class Options to Other Classes* on page 31.

Class Options: Grade Scale

A grade scale is used to convert the percent on an assignment, a category average and the overall average to some meaningful label called a *grade*. For example, it may be used to convert a 98% to an A+.

A scale consists of one or more grades with a minimum or cutoff percent for each. Grades can be letters (A, B, C), words (Outstanding, Satisfactory) or numbers (4.00, 3.00). A class may have multiple scales. Each student is assigned the first grade scale but you can have different scales for different students. You can even assign scales to score categories in case you wish a category of assignment to use a certain scale.

Class Options for Quarter 2: Reading

Use GRADE options to set up the grade scale(s) for this class. Since students are initially assigned Scale #1, your main scale should be dragged to that position.

Select a Grade Scale		Grades in Scale		Minimum%
1	Standard Scale	1	A+	97
2	OSU Scale	2	A	93
3	Pass-Fail Scale	3	A-	90
		4	B+	87
		5	B	83
		6	B-	80
		7	C+	77
		8	C	73
		9	C-	70
		10	D	60

Rounding level for calculated percents:
Tenths

Buttons: ? Cancel Done

To edit grade scale options:

- 1 Choose Class Options from the Edit menu and select the Grade tab.
- 2 To view or edit a scale, first click on its row number. The grades and minimum percents will appear in the list to the right.
- 3 To create a new scale, click the blue button above the left list and choose New Item. Type the name of the scale and then type the grades and minimum percents in the list to the right. The minimum percents must be in descending order and the last percent must be 0. Use the small blue arrows to insert or delete a row anywhere in a scale.
- 4 To duplicate or delete a scale, click the blue button above the left list and choose the appropriate item. Then click the appropriate button below the list.
- 5 The first grade scale in the list is the most important one because it is initially assigned to all students. To move a scale to the top position, press on its row number and drag.

FAQ: What is grade-clicking? How does it work?

EasyGradePro allows you to enter scores by clicking on grade buttons in a process known as grade-clicking. You can also enter scores by typing grades if the 'Allow typing of Grades and Special Scores' option is on in the Gradebook Options window.

What score does a student get when an A+ or C+ is clicked or typed? The score is based on the grade-click value of the grade. The grade-click value for the top grade is always 100%. For the other grades, it is the average percent for the grade. If an A+ is the top grade, the student will get a score that is equivalent to 100%. If a C+ ranges from 76% to 80%, the student will get a score that is equivalent to 78%.

Grade-click values are automatically set and editing is usually unnecessary. To edit them, click the blue arrow above the scrollbar on the right in the Scale view of the Class Options window.

6 Set the rounding level. Rounding options include whole numbers, tenths and hundredths, and are used whenever percents are calculated. As an example, suppose a student has earned 89.638%. After rounding, the number displayed will be 90% for ones rounding, 89.6% for tenths rounding and 89.64% for hundredths. Ones rounding results in cleaner looking numbers. Hundredths rounding results in greater accuracy. For many teachers, tenths rounding offers a good compromise.

7 To assign a scale to a student (other than the first scale), exit from the Class Options window and choose Students from the Chart menu. In the Grade Scale column, select a scale for the student.

8 To assign a scale to a score category (other than the student's scale), click the Category tab in the Class Options window and make your selection from the popup menu after the category's name.

FAQ: How do I set up my 5-point (or some other point) grading system? (Part 1)

The simplest way to do this is to set the maximum score on assignments to five and type the numbers one through five as scores into score cells.

Before you do this, be sure you understand how this will affect student percents: since a score of 1 out of 5 is a 20%, 2 out of 5 is a 40%, etc., students may have assignment and overall percents that are much lower than what is typically considered acceptable. To compensate for this, you can create a grade scale that looks something like this: +5 (90%), +4 (70%), +3 (50%), +2 (30%), +1 (10%) and +0 (0%). You will almost certainly want to hide percents in reports so you don't get questions from parents like "My daughter has a 49% and this is OK?" You might be wondering why we added the '+' before each grade--this is so you can tell the difference between the number five and the grade of five on screen and in reports--grades and numbers are not the same!.

The biggest drawback of this method is that, once set up, you must use it for every assignment in the class. Since a grade scale applies to a student, you don't want a situation in which a 50% is good on one assignment (grade of +3) but bad on another (grade of F). This topic is addressed again in Part 2 on page 28.

Class Options: Score Category

Whenever you add an assignment to a class, a score category must be selected. Categories are used in graphs, summary charts, filters and reports. They help provide useful information about a student's performance. They can also affect a student's overall grade if the weighted-categories option is turned on. A class can have up to fifteen score categories.

To edit category options:

1 Choose Class Options from the Edit menu and select the Category tab.

2 View and edit the category names. Since each class has its own set of options, you can use subject-specific names such as Lab Activity.

3 Turn on category weighting (click the Yes button) if you want your categories to have a certain proportionate effect on overall grades. Enter percents in the Weights column so that their sum is 100%. To learn how category weighting affects calculations, refer to *FAQ: How is a Student's Overall Grade Calculated?* on page 51.

4 Grade Scale Option. If you would like to use a special grade scale for all assignments in a certain category, select it from the Grade Scale Options column. As an example, you can have a category named Effort that uses a +1, +2, +3 grade scale. Easy Grade Pro will use the category's assigned grade scale in the score chart, in assignment graphs and in reports. Grade scales are created in the Grade view of the Class Options

window.

Class Options for Quarter 2: Reading

Use CATEGORY options to create categories for the assignments in this class. You can weight categories, use alternate grade labels and set dropping and extra credit options.

	Category Name	Weight	Grade Scale Option	Dropping/Extra Credit
1	Test-Quiz	25	▼	Drop up to 2 scores ▼
2	Performance	25	▼	▼
3	Homework	25	▼	Drop up to 2 scores ▼
4	Classwork	25	▼	▼
5	Extra Credit	5	▼	Extra Credit ▼
6			▼	▼
7			▼	▼
8			▼	▼

☒ Use Category Weighting
Sum of weights: 100.0 + 5.0 for extra credit

? Cancel Done

5 Dropping Option. When an assignment is added to a class, Easy Grade Pro allows you to set the status of the assignment to *Can be Dropped*. From among these, it will drop the single most-damaging score for student. If you'd like Easy Grade Pro to drop more than one, then select the number of scores to be dropped from the Dropping/Extra Credit column. You are limited to four dropped scores. For more information on dropping, see *Adjusting Grades: Dropping, Extra Credit, Curving and Locking* on page 53.

6 Extra Credit Option. To make one of your categories an extra credit category, select Extra Credit from the last column. This will cause the name of the category to be changed to Extra Credit. Be careful if you have category weighting turned off: all points earned by a student on assignments in this category will be added to the student's point total. However, if you have category weighting turned on, then you can set a percentage limit, or weight, on the value of the extra credit. For more information on extra credit, see *Adjusting Grades: Dropping, Extra Credit, Curving and Locking* on page 53.

Class Options: Score Footnote

Score footnotes are short comments that can be attached to scores to provide additional meaning. They can be included adjacent to scores in printed reports. Footnote text can be edited in the Footnote view of the Class Options window. Up to nine footnotes can be set up but a score can have only one footnote attached to it. For more information, see *Adding Footnotes and Notes to Scores* on page 50.

Class Options: Special Score

Special scores are scores that can be used in place of numeric scores to provide special meaning. Easy Grade Pro provides a variety of special scores that you can use, modify and delete. In addition, you can create your own.

Here is a list of some of the most used special scores with suggestions for use:

- *ex*, short for *excused*, is for an assignment that has not been submitted and not required of the student, perhaps due to a late enrollment or other special circumstance. It has no value and does not affect the overall grade.
- *cr*, short for *credit*, is for an assignment that has been submitted but is not to be graded. It has no value and does not affect the overall grade.
- *ab*, short for *absent*, is for an assignment not submitted due to an absence. It has a value of 0%. It

implies that the assignment can and should be submitted for a new grade. This score causes the assignment to appear in missing work reports.

- *mi*, short for *missing*, is for an assignment not submitted and for which no valid excuse exists. It has a value of 0%. Teacher policy determines how this grade can be changed. This score causes the assignment to appear in missing work reports.
- *inc*, short for *incomplete*, is for an assignment that has been submitted but must be redone or completed. It has a value of 0%. It implies that the assignment can and should be completed for a new grade. This score causes the assignment to appear in missing work reports.

Score Names	Code	Shortcut	Value%	Counts as...
1 Excused	ex	E		☐ Missing
2 Credit	cr	C		☐ Missing
3 Absent	ab	A	0	☒ Missing
4 Missing	mi	M	0	☒ Missing
5 Incomplete	inc	I	0	☒ Missing
6 Yes	yes	Y	100	☐ Missing
7 No	no	N	0	☐ Missing
8 Drop	dr	D		☐ Missing
9 Outstanding	o	O	100	☐ Missing
10 Satisfactory	s	S	80	☐ Missing

To edit special score options:

1 Choose **Class Options** from the **Edit** menu and select the **Score** tab.

2 In the **Score Names** column, put the name to be used as a key in reports.

3 In the **Code** column, put the text that will be used as the score. To avoid confusion, we strongly recommend that you not use numbers unless you include other symbols. For example, consider using ‘+1’ instead of ‘1’.

4 Optionally, you can include a single *Shortcut* key that, when pressed, enters the code into a score cell. If used, it must be unique in the list.

5 The *Value%* of a special score should be blank or between 0 and 100%. If you leave this blank, the special score will have no effect on a student’s grade.

6 If you would like the score to be picked up when a missing work report is printed or when a missing work filter is used, be sure to set the *Missing* attribute.

For information about using special scores, refer to the section *Entering Scores* starting on page 47.

FAQ: How do I enter a checkmark as a special score?

EasyGradePro allows you to use nearly any font on your computer that includes the alphabet, numbers and punctuation. On Macintosh computers, most fonts that have these characters also have a checkmark. Simply type or point to it. On Windows computers, the checkmark is only found in special typographic fonts that are not suitable for use in *EasyGradePro* because they do not include alphabetic and numeric characters.

FAQ: How do I set up my 5-point (or some other point) grading system? (Part 2)

(This is a continuation of a FAQ started on page 33).

Because of the tremendous range of percents that occurs when the maximum score on an assignment is as low as 5 (i.e. $1/5=20\%$, $2/5=40\%$, $3/5=60\%$, $4/5=80\%$, $5/5=100\%$), the use of special scores instead of numbers may be a better way to set up a 5-point system. Your special scores could be +5 (100%), +4 (90%), +3 (80%), +2 (70%) and +1 (60%). If you were to enter a +5 as a score, the student would receive 100% of the maximum score; for a +4, the student would receive 80% and so on.

This use of special scores has advantages over the use of true numbers: 1) the range of percents is more typical, 2) you don't have to use a modified grade scale, 3) percents can be displayed in reports if you choose, and 4) you don't have to use a maximum score of 5 on every assignment--use whatever you want on any assignment!

Create your special scores in the Score review of the Class Options window. Put the '+5' and other scores in the Code column. Be sure to add the '+' or some other symbol to minimize confusion with true numeric scores. Put the percents in the Value% column. Be sure to create a shortcut for each to make data entry of your special scores very fast.

Class Options: Attendance Category

Any class can be used for recording student attendance marks. If you are an elementary teacher, you may find it best to use your first class of the day for recording attendance; when you print multi-class progress reports, EasyGradePro will automatically find and use the right class when printing the attendance chart portion of the report. If you are a secondary teacher, you can record attendance in every class.

Class Options for Quarter 2: Science-1

Grade Rubric Category Footnote Score Attend. Calendar Term Seat Color

Use ATTENDANCE options to define up to 15 attendance categories in up to 10 different master categories. Totals are calculated for each category. For help, click the Help button.

	Master Category	Category	Code	Value	Autofill Score
1	Absent	Excused absence	AE	1.00	'ab'
2	Absent	Unexcused absence	AU	1.00	'ab'
3	Absent	Half-day Absence	AH	0.50	'ab'
4	Absent	Suspension	AS	1.00	'ab'
5	Tardy	Excused tardy	TE	1.00	
6	Tardy	Unexcused tardy	TU	1.00	
7	Other	Field Trip	OF	1.00	
8	Other	In-School Absence	OI	1.00	
9	Other	Withdrawn	OW	1.00	

? Cancel Done

To record attendance marks in a class, attendance categories and a term calendar must be set up. (Setting up a calendar is discussed in the next section). You can set up to fifteen attendance categories. An attendance category has five attributes. The *category*, such as *Excused Absence*, is the full name of the category. The *master category*, such as *Absent*, names the major grouping that the category belongs to. The *code*, such as *AE*, is the one- or two-character mark that is entered in an attendance cell. The *value* is used when calculating totals and should be 1.00 for full-day marks, 0.50 for half-day, etc. EasyGradePro will calculate totals for all of your categories and master categories. The *auto-fill score* is used if you want to have EasyGradePro enter scores in the score chart based on attendance. For example, you can have EasyGradePro enter a special score of *ab* for students who are marked absent on a day when an assignment is due. For more information on this, refer to the section *Auto-filling Attendance Scores* starting on page 58.

To edit attendance category options:

- 1 Choose Class Options from the Edit menu and select the Attendance tab.
- 2 To edit the list of Master Categories, first press and hold on any row in the Master Category column. From the menu that pops up, choose *Edit this Menu*. In the window that appears, edit the list of master categories.
- 3 For each of your attendance categories, select the Master Category and enter the category, code and value. Optionally, enter an auto-fill score.

Once you start using your attendance codes, it is important that you don't change their order or meaning and that you don't delete items that are in use.

Class Options: Calendar

Calendar options are used to set the days of the week, the starting and ending dates and no-school days. These only need to be set if you plan to use the class for recording attendance marks.

Class Options for Quarter 2: Reading

Grade | Rubric | Category | Footnote | Score | Attend. | **Calendar** | Term | Seat | Color

CALENDAR options are used to prepare and maintain the calendar for this term

Days: ☐ S ☒ M ☒ T ☒ W ☒ T ☒ F ☐ S

First Day of Term **No-School Days** **Last Day of Term**

November 2006 November 2006 January 2007

Monday, November 06, 55 school days Friday, January 19, 2007

0 no-school days

Cancel Done

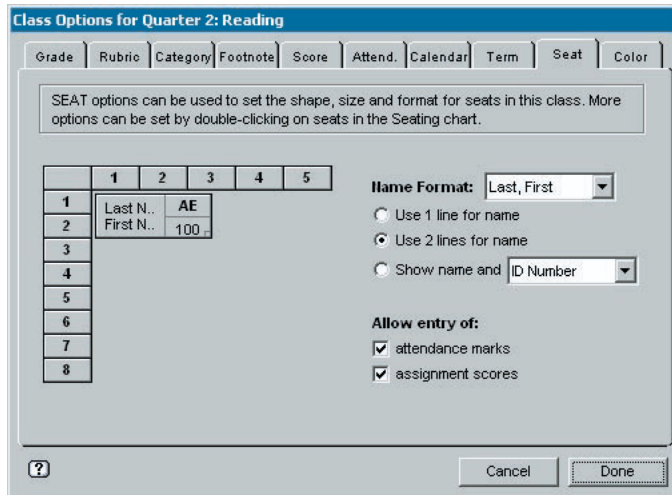
In EasyGradePro, a class is an entity within a single term only; the calendar that you set up should reflect this. If you use EasyGradePro's Term option to combine student data across terms, you will be able to obtain attendance totals for multiple terms. This is explained in *Working with Terms* on page 81.

To edit calendar options:

- 1 Choose Class Options from the Edit menu and select the Calendar tab.
- 2 Set the days of the week that the class meets. If your class meets on varying days, be sure to select any day that the class might meet. Once you begin recording student attendance marks, the days of the week cannot be changed.
- 3 Set the first day of the term by clicking on the date in the first calendar. Once you begin recording attendance marks, the first day of the term can't be changed.
- 4 Set the last day of the term and the no-school days on the other calendars. These can be changed at any time.

Class Options: Seat Format

If you plan to use the seating chart for a class, you can set the size, shape, name format, and attendance formats for all of these seats in the Class Options window. Additional options, such as color and rotation, can be set for individual seats but must be set in the actual seating chart.



To edit seat options:

- 1 Choose Class Options from the Edit menu and select the Seat tab.
- 2 To change the shape, drag the box in the lower-right corner of the sample seat.
- 3 To change the name format or to allow entry of attendance or scores into seats, use the buttons and menus on the right.

To set options for individual seats:

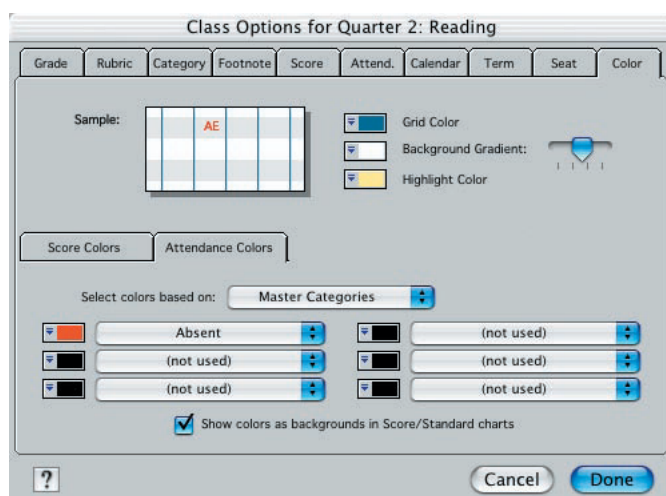
- 1 Choose Seating from the Chart menu.
- 2 Double-click on a seat to open the seat's format window.
- 3 Change the rotation, color, and locked status as desired. Locking a seat prevents the seat from being moved or being affected by sorting.

Class Options: Color

Color options allow you to set the background and grid colors. You can choose to have a solid background color or have alternating, complementary row colors. You can color-code scores and attendance marks for emphasis.

To edit color options:

- 1 Choose Class Options from the Edit menu and select the Color tab.
- 2 Use the Grid Color and Background Color buttons to open a window where you can choose new colors.
- 3 Move the Gradients slider to the left to have the background color used on every row. Move the gradient slider to the right to have alternating row colors. Contrast between the alternating colors increases as the slider is moved to the right.
- 4 Use the Score Colors and Attendance Color tabs to switch between setting colors for the score chart and for the attendance chart. You may set colors for both charts.
- 5 Use the *Select colors based on* menu to choose the basis for color selection.



6 Use the six popup menus and six buttons in the bottom half of the window to select specific colors for scores and attendance marks.

7 Turn on the *Show colors as backgrounds in score cells* option if you'd like your attendance color to appear as the background colors in score cells. This feature makes it easy to see if a student was absent on the day the assignment was due. This option affects the score, seat and standard charts.

47.5	47.5	21.2	45.7
44.2	40.7	21.2	42.5
	47.5	25	42.5
40.7	40.7	19.6	cr
39.2	39.2	20.3	39.2
47.5	mi	17.8	32.5
47.5	50	mi	35.7
50	50	23.7	40.7
40.7	40.7	21.2	45.7

Copying Class Options to Other Classes

One of the most important features in Easy Grade Pro is the ability to copy some or all of your class options from one class to others using the Copy Class Data window. This can save you a lot of time and help you ensure that your options are consistent across classes and terms.

To copy class options from one class to others:

1 Choose **Copy->Class Options** from the Tool menu or click the Copy Class Data tool



and select the Optionstab.

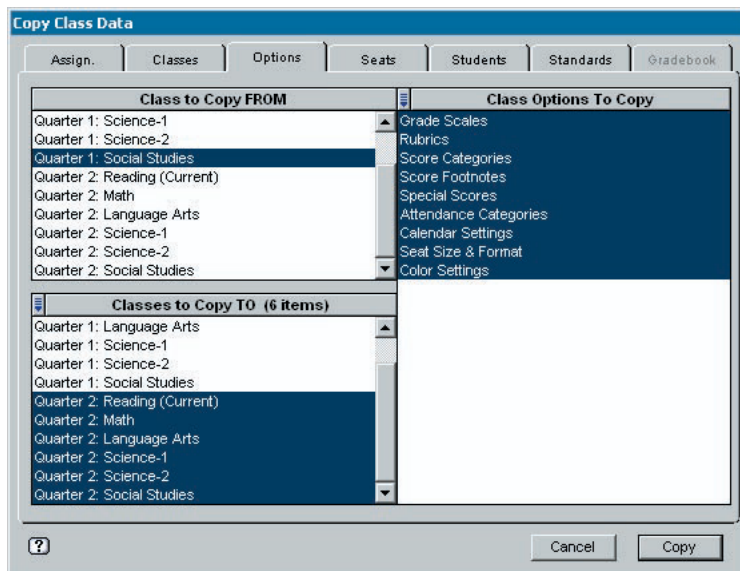
2 In the upper-left list, select the class to copy from.

3 In the lower-left list, select the class(es) to copy to. Be sure that you don't select the class that is selected in the upper list. To select multiple items, hold down the shift, ctrl (Windows) or command (Macintosh) key while clicking.

4 Select the options you wish to copy in the list on the right. Use the blue arrow button to select or deselect all list items. To select multiple items, hold down the shift, ctrl (Windows) or command (Macintosh) key while clicking.

5 Check all of your settings to ensure that you are copying the right options to the right classes.

6 Click the Copy button.



About Gradebook Options

Unlike Class Options, Gradebook Options are settings that affect your entire gradebook. You can set the font, the order of first and last names, passwords, types of warnings and whether you want to be able to directly type grades or special scores shortcuts. You can create reusable text items for notes and reports, create filters for showing just the desired students and assignments, customize the labels used in student reports and even set up your gradebook to be used with EGPClipboard, the Palm OS companion to Easy GradePro.

To view or edit these options, choose Gradebook Options from the Edit menu. In the window that opens, you'll find a series of tabs, one for each option group. The remaining sections in this chapter describe the options found under each tab.

Gradebook Options: General

Use General options to set the primary options that affect how your gradebook looks and behaves.

To edit General options:

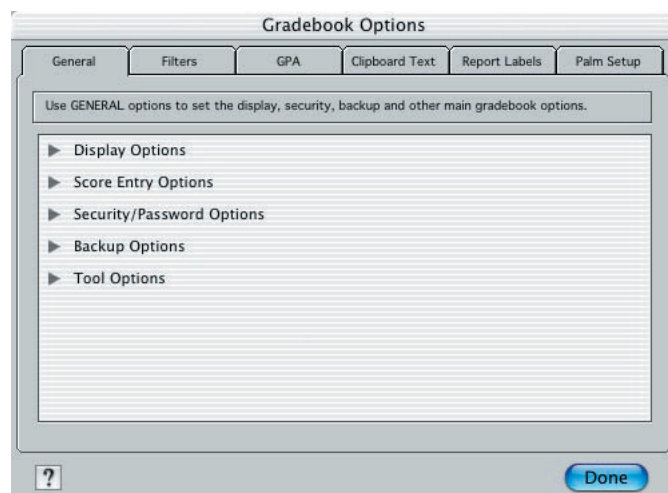
1 Choose Gradebook Options from the Edit menu and select the General tab. Notice that there is a list of categories of options with a graphic to the left of each.

2 Press on the graphic to the left of an item to reveal the options in that category. These are explained next.

Display Options

- *Font Options.* Set the font and font size to be used in the main charts. This does not affect reports.
- *When a cell is selected highlight... minimally, entire row, entire column or entire row and column.* Use this to control how much of a row or column is highlighted when a cell is selected. For maximum readability, have the entire row and column selected.

- *Display student names as... Last, First or First Last.* This affects onscreen charts and reports. It does not affect the seating chart which has its own option in the Class Options window.
- *Display assignment scores... as raw scores (20), as percents (80.0%), as grades (B-) or using Assignment Record settings.* The assignment record setting can be found by double-clicking on an assignment's name in the score chart or by choosing Assignment from the Chart menu. This option can also be set by pressing on the small filter menu next to the first score for the first student in the score chart.
- *Display overall grades as... as percent only (100.0%), grades only (A+) or percents and grades (100A+).*
- *Display standard grades as... numbers only (3.00), rubric only (Meets Standard) or numbers/rubrics (3.00/Meets Standard).* This option can also be set by pressing on the small filter menu next to the first score for the first student in the standard chart.
- *Show score/attendance colors.* Use this to turn on or off the colors for scores and attendance marks in the main charts. To set the colors, choose Class Options from the Edit menu and select the Color tab.
- *Hide assignment dates in Score and Standard charts.* If dates are not relevant to your assignments, turn this option on. Dates will be hidden onscreen as well as in certain reports.
- *Show warning symbol for students with missing work.* This symbol appears as a . It will appear only if the student has scores that count as missing in the Class Options window, Score tab.



Score Entry Options

- *Allow typing of.... Special Score Shortcuts and Grades and Special Scores.* The first item allows you to type a shortcut like *a* and have Easy Grade Pro automatically enter an *A* and jump down to the next cell. Special scores and their shortcuts are set in the Score review of the Class Options window. The second item allows you to directly type an *A+*, *A* or *a*--any grade or special score. This option can also be set by pressing on the small triangle to the left of the grade-click palette.
- *When a special score shortcut is entered.... movedown, moveright, and remain in the same cell.* If you typically enter scores down a column, from one student to the next, set the first option. But, if you typically enter multiple scores for one student before moving down to the next, then you'll appreciate the second option. The third option is for those who do both and would rather have to use an arrow key after entering a special score to choose the direction of movement.
- *When the last score in a column is entered.... remain in the same cell, move to the top of the next column, and move to the top of the same column.* If you first enter scores into a paper gradebook, you'll find the first option to be time-saving because it allows you to enter scores the fastest.
- *Display a warning when a score.... is changed, exceeds the Maximum.* These warnings can help prevent

accidental changes. Only a single warning is given when you exceed the maximum score in case you are entering a series of scores with extra credit.

Security/Password Options

- *Full Access Password.* If you would like your gradebook to require a password to be entered whenever you open it or after you choose Lock from the File menu, then enter a password here.
- *Restricted Access (RA) Password.* If you would like other to be able to open your gradebook but you would like to restrict what they can do, then set a password here and set the...allow RA users to options as desired. To turn on the RA mode choose RAMode from the File menu or select the RAMode tool . To turn off the RA mode, choose RAMode as before. The password window will appear and the teacher password must be typed to regain full access.

FAQ: I don't remember the password. How do I get back in?

If you are unable to get into your gradebook, call Orbis Software for help. If you are a registered single-user license holder or if you are the contact person for a school that holds a registered site license, you will be given a special one-day password that will allow you to open the gradebook and set a new password. See www.easygradepro.com for phone number and times in which this support is available.

FAQ: When I switch classes, my gradebook displays a message 'Gradebook is locked--changes could not be saved'. What is happening?

First of all, this message has nothing to do with password protection. Rather, it is EasyGradePro's way of telling you that the computer is not allowing it to save your changes. There are many possible causes. Check that your gradebook is not in a location where you don't have write-permissions. Make sure you are logged into the computer with the right login account. On Windows, open the Properties window for your gradebook and make sure the Read Only attribute is not turned on. On Macintosh, open the Get Info window for your gradebook and make sure the Locked attribute is not on. As a last resort, open your gradebook, choose Save Copy from the File menu and save a copy of your gradebook to a location where you have write-permissions such as your Documents folder. Then open the copy. If it works properly, use it instead.

Backup Options

Anyone who has used a computer for long knows that computers are susceptible to all sorts of problems. Problems may be inevitable but their damaging effects can be minimized if one has a good backup plan in place. A good plan requires multiple, regular backups. EasyGradePro's backup options make this easy:

- *When closing a gradebook... do not save a backup, prompt to save a backup or automatically save a backup.* We recommend that you select the third option so that a backup is made every time you close it.
- *Default backup Name...* 'Year-Month-Day.egp', 'Day of Month.egp' and 'Day of Week.egp'. With these options, you'd get gradebook names like 2006-11-06.egp, 6.egp and Monday.egp respectively. So which is best? The first option offers the greatest security but it will also result in the greatest number of backups by the end of the school year because you'll end each day with a unique backup that will never get replaced by the backup made on another day. With the second option, the backup made on the sixth day of the month will get replaced by the backup made on the sixth day of the next month. And, with the third plan, the backup made on Wednesday of this week will get replaced by the one made next Wednesday. If you have the space on your hard drive, server or flash drive, we recommend the first option.

- *Default backup Location...* You can choose to have the backups saved automatically to a Gradebook Backups folder in your Documents folder, on your Desktop or to a location of your choice. For the greatest security, we recommend the third option if you can set the save location to a server or to a flash drive that you can store at another location when you aren't using Easy Grade Pro.

Tool Options

- *Show Tool Bar.* The toolbar consists of up to twenty tools near the top of the main charts. This can be turned off to maximize the number of student rows visible on your monitor.
- *Show Mini-Summary.* This small window can be used to display graphs and lists that are updated as you enter student data. You can choose to have this small window visible in none of the main charts, in the charts that have a nice empty box for it in the upper-left corner (Score, Attendance and Standard) or in all charts. See the section titled *Using the Mini-Summaries Window* on page 89 for more information.
- *Automatically position Mini-Summary based on chart.* To have the mini-summary stay at the same location regardless of chart, turn this off. Otherwise, the mini-summary will move to a pre-set location based on the current chart.
- *Show Tabs for Score, Attendance and other charts.* These tabs appear near the top of the main charts. This can be turned off to maximize the number of student rows visible on your monitor.

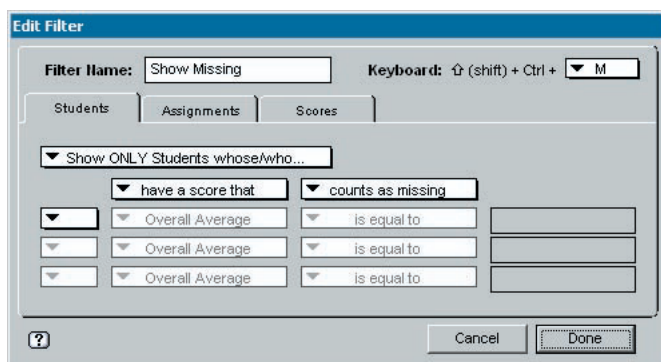
Gradebook Options: Filters

Filters are used to show just the students, assignments and scores you want to see in the charts. For example, a filter can be set up to show the students and assignments in one reading group in your class. Filters can be used in all charts but these at the chart. Before creating your own filter, you should study the built-in filters to see how they were set up.

To create a new filter

1 Choose Gradebook Options from the Edit menu and select the Filter tab.

2 Click the New Filter button. The New Filter window will open.



3 Enter a name in the Filter Name field.

4 (Optional) Use the Keyboard menu to select a unique key to be used to activate your filter.

5 Your filter may contain individual filters for students, assignments and scores. Use the tabs to switch between these three parts. Under each tab, enter up to four rules. The rules can be connected using *and* or *or* found in the small menus to the left. *And* connects two rules so that they must both be met while *or* allows

either rule to be sufficient. Each rule consists of a subject and a condition that are selected using menus. Depending on the type of condition, the rule may or may not have an object that must be completed by typing letters or words into a text field. Case is not important.

6 Be sure to test your filter; you may find that it needs refinement to work properly. Note: filters have no effect on students whose status is WD (hidden).

FAQ: I have a group of students (or just one student) with unique assignments. How can I create a filter to show just this group and its assignments?

The first step is to come up with a code for this group, such as RED. Choose Assignment from the Chart menu and put the code into the Note field of each assignment's record. Choose Student from the Chart menu and put the code into one of the twelve custom fields of each student's record. Now, create a filter that shows students with the code in the custom field and that shows assignments with the code in the Note field. If you have multiple groups of students and assignments in your class, you can create a filter for each group.

Gradebook Options: GPA

GPA, or grade point average, is a numerical point value (i.e. 4.00) assigned to a student's grade (i.e. A). The GPAs from multiple classes can be combined to produce a weighted, multi-class GPA. GPA can be displayed in certain charts and reports.

	Grades (i.e. 'A+')	Point Values (i.e. '4.00')
1	A+	4.00
2	A	4.00
3	A-	3.67
4	B+	3.33
5	B	3.00
6	B-	2.67
7	C+	2.33
8	C	2.00
9	C-	1.67
10	D+	1.33

To edit GPA options:

- 1 Choose Gradebook Options from the Edit menu and select the GPA tab.
- 2 In the Grades column (on the left), enter all grades (i.e. A+) that are in use in your gradebook in all of your classes. These can be entered in any order.
- 3 In the Point Values column (on the right), enter a numeric point (i.e. 4.00) value for each grade. Values must be between 0.00 and 10.00.

To set the weights used when multi-class GPAs are calculated:

- 1 Choose Record from the Chart menu.
- 2 Select the Classes tab.
- 3 Edit the Class Weight for each class.

To display GPA in the Score (or other) chart:

1 In the Score chart, press on the column title above the column of student names (or an adjacent column) and, from the menu that pops up, choose **Add NEW Column**. A new column with student names will appear. Note: this menu item will become disabled if the eight-column limit has been reached.

2 Press on the *new column's* title to bring up the menu again, but, this time, choose **Main Grades -> GPA**. The printed Score chart report will include this column as well.

▼	11 of 11 Students	GPA	Overall
1	Bradford, Karen	4.00	96.8 A
2	Brown, Jonathan	3.67	92.5 A-
3	Chu, Jeff	4.00	95.4 A
4	Goodman, Michael	3.00	86.8 B
5	Gustavson, Peter		85.9 Satisf...
6	Haynes, Terri	1.00	68.1 D
7	Kramer, Jennifer	0.00	47.4 F
8	Radcliffe, Missy	4.00	97.3 A+
9	Robinson, LaTonya	3.67	92.5 A-
10	Taylor, Roger	1.67	72.8 C-
11	Kendricks, Allison	3.67	91.0 A-

To display GPA in the Multi-class Gradesheet report:

1 Choose **Print** from the File menu. From the Report menu, select **Multi-class Gradesheet**. Select the **Option** tab.

2 Press on the **Grades display** menu and choose *show as GPAs*.

3 To include a column with weighted, multi-class GPAs, turn on the *Include Multi-class Avg.* option.

To display GPA in the Student Progress report:

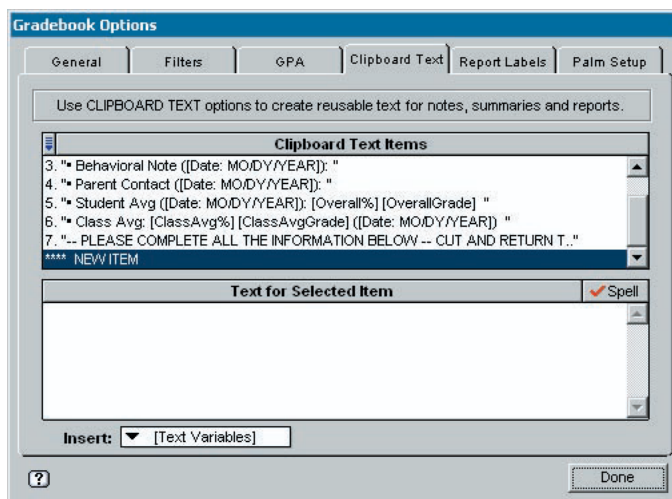
1 Choose **Print** from the File menu. From the Report menu, select **Student Progress**.

2 Under the **Option** tab, turn on the *Include Student Title Data* option.

3 Open this option and from the *Include* menu, select **GPA**. To cause this to be a weighted, multi-class GPA, turn on the *Include Multiple Classes (in each report)* option.

Gradebook Options: Clipboard Text

Use clipboard text options to create and store sentences and paragraphs that can be used and reused in score notes, summary notes and student reports. There is no limit to the number of clipboard text items and each has a 32,000 keystroke limit. Numerous variables can be added to the text; Easy Grade Pro completes the variables with student data at the time the text is printed or pasted into notes. Spell-check is available to help ensure that your text is error-free.



To edit clipboard text options:

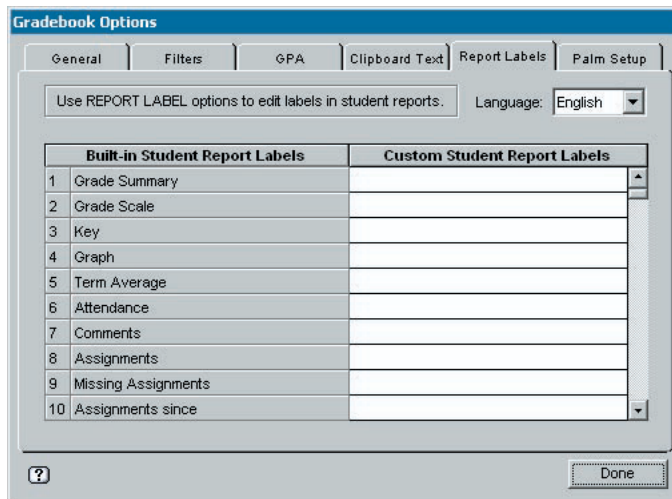
- 1 Choose Gradebook Options from the Edit menu and select the Clipboard Text tab.
- 2 To edit an item, first select it in the upper list. The full text will appear below.
- 3 To create a new item, select the list item titled NEW ITEM. Then type the text.
- 4 To delete or duplicate an item, press on the small blue arrow above the list.
- 5 Use the Insert menu below the text to add text variables. Variables are automatically filled in with the specified student or other data at the time the text is pasted into a note or printed in a report. You may need to put a space before and after each variable to ensure proper spacing when EasyGradePro later substitutes the variable with student data.
- 6 To check spelling, click the Spell button.

Gradebook Options: Report Labels

Report Label options allow you to change the titles and labels used in student reports. EasyGradePro has labels in three different languages (English, French and Spanish) and each can be customized. You can even create labels for a fourth language of your choice. By default, EasyGradePro assigns English to every student. To assign a different language, choose Student from the Chart menu and edit the items in the column labeled Language.

To edit report label options:

- 1 Choose Gradebook Options from the Edit menu and select the Report Label tab.
- 2 Use the Language menu to set the language you wish to customize. Select the last menu item to add your own language or to add an alternate set of labels.
- 3 Edit any of the labels. The built-in label will be used unless you enter your own.

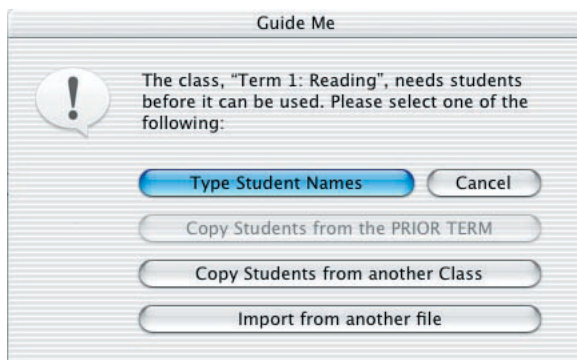
**Gradebook Options: Palm Setup**

EGPClipboard, the Palm OS companion to EasyGradePro, can be used to record student scores, attendance and notes on a Palm OS handheld. EGPClipboard 4.0 is required; older versions of EGPClipboard will not work with EasyGradePro 4.0. For information on obtaining EGPClipboard 4.0, please view www.easygradepro.com.

5 Students and Assignments

A Class Without Students

Whenever you view a class that has no students, a window will appear (shown below) requesting that you choose how students are to be added to the class.



Whenever possible, click the *Copy Students from the PRIOR TERM* button because the students will appear without any more effort on your part and will be identical in both classes. The *Copy Students from another Class* button should be your second choice. This is explained in the section *Copying Students to other Classes* on page 41. If you have access to another Easy Grade Pro gradebook or a text file with the students, you can click the *Import from another file* button. Importing students is explained in Chapter 16, *Porting*. Only select the *Type Student Names* button if it is your only option. This is explained next.

Adding Students to a Class by Typing

1 Open the Records window to the first empty student record. There are four ways to do this: 1) click the *Type Student Names* button (shown above); 2) choose *Add Student* from the *Tool* menu; 3) click the large *Add Student* button found in the charts; or 4) click the *Add Student* tool  on the toolbar.

2 Type the Last name and press *tab*. Type the First name and press *tab*. Notice that after both names are typed, the *Next Student >>* button that leads to the next record becomes highlighted. Any highlighted but-

ton can be selected by pressing the enter key. After the names have been entered, you can move to the next student by pressing this key. Be careful: if you press enter intending to move down to the next field in this record, you will actually move to the next student's record. If this happens, click the << button.

3(Optional) Enter the ID and press tab. The small button to the right of the ID number field opens a window where automatic ID numbers can be set.

4(Optional) Set the student's gender. Gender is used in filters that show and hide certain students and in clipboard text when Easy Grade Pro must choose the proper pronoun when generating text.

5(Optional) Edit the student's status. You may choose between *Active*, *WD (grayed)* and *WD (hidden)*. *WD* is an abbreviation for *withdrawn*.

6(Optional) Edit the student's grade scale. Grade scales can be set up in the Class Options window.

7(Optional) Edit the student's report language. This option affects the titles and labels used in progress and missing work reports. Report labels can be edited in the Gradebook Options window.

8(Optional) Edit the Custom Labels and Custom Data fields. There are twelve custom data fields. You can set the label of these fields as well as enter any kind of information. You might include phone number, parent name, address (to be used in mailing labels), reading group, etc.

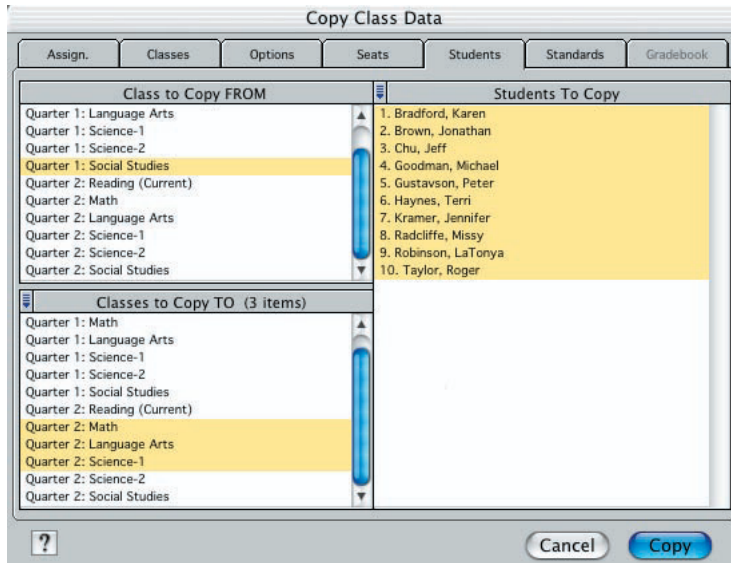
9(Optional) Enter a Website Password. The password is used to gain access to Easy Grade Pro's HTML Multi- and Single-class Website reports. It is not used with any other internet reports. Additionally, the password is used as a filter when creating these reports: only students with passwords will have reports created. The case of the password is not important but it must consist of numbers and letters only. No spaces are allowed. It must be at least six but no more than twenty-four characters in length. The small button to the right of the Website Password field opens a window where automatic passwords can be set.

10(Optional) Enter Email Address #1 and Email Address #2. These are reused when emailing reports to students, parents or guardians. If all or most of your students have the same domain (i.e. @orbissoft.com), then you may omit it. A default domain can be set up in the Email/Internet window that will get used for any student with an incomplete email address in these fields.

11 Press enter or click *Next Student* to move to the next student or click *Done*.

Copying Students to other Classes

If you teach the same students in more than one section or subject, be sure to use the Copy Class Data tool to copy your students from one class to others. You can copy students with some or all of their data. If the student with a matching ID already exists in a class being copied to, the student will not be duplicated but the data about the student will be copied anyway. Use this tool to copy students to other subjects, to update student record information and to transfer a student from one section to another.



To copy students from one class to others:

1 Choose Copy->Students from the Tool menu or click the Copy Class Data tool  and select the Studentstab.

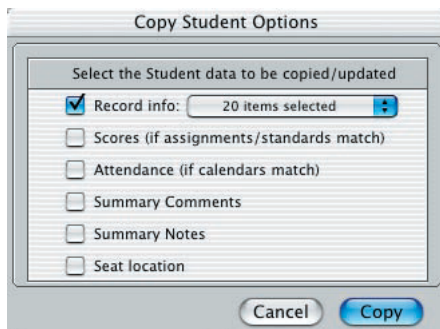
2 In the upper-left list, select the class to copy from.

3 In the lower-left list, select the classes to copy to. Be sure that you don't select the class that is selected in the upper list. To select multiple items, hold down the shift, ctrl (Windows) or command (Macintosh) key while clicking.

4 Select the students you wish to copy in the list on the right.

5 Check all of your settings to ensure that you are copying the right student data to the right classes.

6 Click the Copy button. A window will open allowing you to select the specific student data to be copied. Select all desired data and click the Copy button.



Managing your Students

You can change the names or other data in student records. You can change order, delete, withdraw and transfer your students. This section explains how to perform these basic tasks.

To change a student's name or other record data:

- 1 Open the record by double-clicking on the student's name in any chart except the seating chart.
- 2 Edit the name or other data. Click Done.
- 3 Repeat these steps for each class in which the student data should be changed.

To change the order of your students, do one of the following:

- Press on a student's name in the score, attendance or student chart and drag up or down.
- Choose Sort Students from the View menu. You can sort in a variety of ways.
- Click the Sort tool  to sort by name. In the seating chart this tool sorts randomly.

To delete a single student:

- 1 Click on the student's row number (to the left of the name) in one of the charts.
- 2 Click the Delete tool  or press the delete key.
- 3 Repeat these steps for each class in which the student is to be deleted.

To delete multiple students:

- 1 Choose Delete Student from the Tool menu.
- 2 Select the students in the list. Click the Delete button.
- 3 Repeat these steps for each class in which the students are to be deleted.

To withdraw a student:

- 1 Open the student's record by double-clicking on the student's name in one of the charts.
- 2 Use the Status menu to select either *WD (grayed)* or *WD (hidden)* and click Done. If you choose *WD (grayed)*, the student will remain visible in the charts but will appear grayed and the data will not be editable. The letters *WD* are appended to the name of the withdrawn student. If you choose *WD (hidden)*, the student will be removed from all charts but will remain in the Records window.
- 3 Repeat these steps for each class in which the student is to be withdrawn.

FAQ: How do I show a student once the status has been set to *WD (hidden)*?

To show a student whose status has been set to *WD (hidden)*, choose *Records* from the Chart menu and select the *Student* tab. Use the *Record* popup menu in the right corner to switch to the student's record. Use the *Status* menu to change the status to *Active* or *WD (grayed)*.

To transfer a student when classes match:

If the two classes match exactly (assignment order, assignment settings, calendar settings, score footnotes, etc.), it is easy to transfer a student using the Copy Class Data window. Refer to the section titled *Copying Student to other Classes* on page 41 for help with this. You could also use basic copy and paste as follows:

- 1 Select the student's row number (to the left of the name) in one of the charts.
- 2 Choose Copy from the Edit menu.
- 3 Switch to the class the student is transferring to. If this class is in another gradebook, be sure you don't quit Easy Grade Pro. Rather, choose Close from the File menu and then open the other gradebook.
- 4 Select the row number where you want to insert the student.
- 5 Choose Paste from the Edit menu.

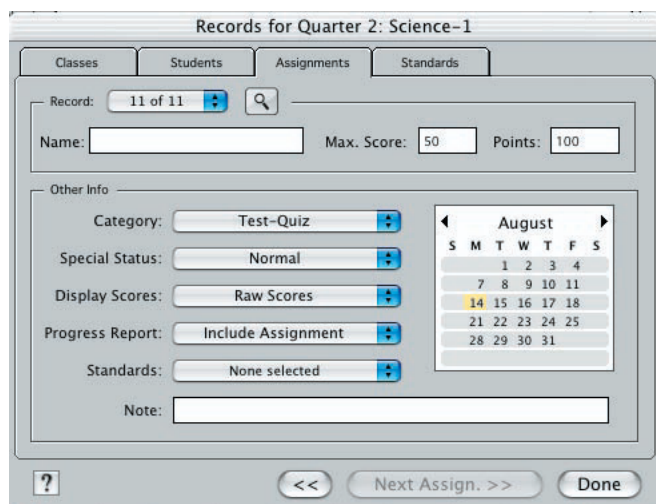
To transfer a student when classes do not match:

Transferring a student is more difficult when the classes don't match. If possible, print out scores and attendance charts and retype the data into the proper columns. If this is not possible, you may want to add a new assignment column used solely to give the student a transfer grade. Use an assignment name like Tommy's Transfer Grade. Set the assignment's maximum score to 100. Set the assignment's points value to the sum of all the points currently in the class. This will ensure that the student's transfer grade has the same weight as all the assignments currently in the class. Set the assignment's progress report option to *Include if student has score*. In the score cell for this student, enter the transfer percent. If you use category weighting in the class, you may need to follow these steps for each of the categories.

Adding Assignments

Assignments can be added to a class by typing, by copying from another class or by importing from a class in another gradebook. This section explains how to add assignments by typing.

1 Open the Records window to the first empty assignment record. There are three ways to do this: 1) select Add Assignment from the Tool menu, 2) click the large Add Assignment button in the score or assignment charts or 3) click the Add Assignment tool .



2 Type the assignment Name and press tab.

3 Type the assignment's Maximum Score and press tab. Type the assignment's Points. Ignore these fields if the assignment is being used for extra credit or is an ungraded item. For a thorough discussion of Maximum Score and Points, be sure to take a look at the FAQs on the next page.

4 Select the assignment's due date. The calendar is initially set to the current date. If the date showing is not the current date, the computer's clock may be improperly set or its clock battery may be dead.

5 Select the assignment's category. The category is used in summaries, reports and in grading (if categories are weighted). To edit categories, choose Class Options from the Edit menu and select the Category tab.

FAQ: Why are the dates wrong on the calendars and in the charts?

This problem indicates that the computer's clock is not set properly or the clock's battery is dead. Use the computer's Date and Time control panel to set the clock. Refer to your computer's manual for help in replacing a dead battery.

FAQ: What are maximum score and points? How should I set them?

By definition, an assignment's **maximum score** is the score that is worth 100%. It's the score that is given when everything is correct (ignoring extra credit). Perhaps you like to score papers using percents (scores between 0 and 100). In this case, as a **percents-grader**, you should keep the maximum score at 100. Perhaps you count the number of problems the student has correct to get the score. In this case, as a **problems-grader**, you should set the maximum score to the total number of problems. Perhaps you apply differing amounts of points to problems based on difficulty and then sum the points the student has earned to get the score. In this case, as a **points-grader**, you should set the maximum score to the number of points possible on the assignment.

Easy Grade Pro uses the maximum score to do one thing only: calculate a student's percent on the assignment. If a student's score is 15 and the maximum score is 20, Easy Grade Pro calculates $(15/20) \times 100$ and gets 75%. Notice that the maximum score has nothing to do with the value of an assignment. A student can have a 15 out of 20 on a small assignment as well as on a huge semester project. How is one assignment given more value than another? It is done through the use of assignment points!

By definition, an assignment's **points** is the number of points to be earned when a student's score is equal to the maximum score. Using the example above in which the student's score is 15 out of 20, the student will get 75% of whatever value is set for points. The student will receive 15 points if there are 20 points possible, 75 points if there are 100 points possible, 150 if there are 200 points possible and so on.

So, how should you set an assignment's points? The answer depends on your grading style. If you are a **points-grader**, you should use the same number for maximum score and points. When you do this, the student's score, whatever it is, will be equal to the number of points earned. If you are a **percents-grader** or a **problems-grader**, simply keep the points set at 100 for a typical assignment, 200 for an assignment worth double, 50 for an assignment worth half and so on. Be sure to see **FAQ: How is a student's overall grade calculated?** on page 51.

FAQ: If I use category weighting, does it matter how I set assignment points?

If you use category weighting (i.e. Quiz 30%, Homework 50%, Final Exam 20%) and you want all assignments in a category to have the same value, simply set points on all of them to 100, or to 10 or to anything--as long as they are all the same. However, if you want one assignment to be worth more than another assignment in the same category, then follow the guidelines in the prior FAQ.

6 Select the Special Status option. Special status options include the following:

- **Normal.** No special action is taken.
- **Extra credit.** Any score entered for a student will increase the number of points the student has earned without increasing the number of points possible. In other words, the student's average will go up. Students without scores are unaffected.
- **Can be dropped.** Easy Grade Pro will drop this assignment for a student if, by dropping it, the student's overall percent is improved more than by dropping any other assignment that can be dropped. A letter is drawn next to a dropped score. Easy Grade Pro will drop the single, most-damaging score for a student among assignments whose status is *Can be dropped* unless you have set dropping options in the Class Options window.
- **Not for grade.** The assignment will not be included when determining grades. It can be used for recording items such as whether a progress report has been returned. It can also be used to temporarily turn off a group of assignments so that they do not influence the overall grades.
- **(-) Negative Points.** A score entered for a student will decrease the number of points the student has

earned without decreasing the number of points possible, causing the average to go down. Students with out-scores are unaffected.

FAQ: Why can't I change the status on one of my assignments? It is stuck on Normal.

If you have set up an Extra Credit category in the Class Options window for a class, then all assignments in that category will automatically have their status set to Normal. This can't be changed because it makes no sense to have a droppable, extra credit or non-graded extra credit assignment. For more information on Extra Credit categories, refer to the section Class Options: Score Category on page 25.

7 Select the Display Scores option. Use this to set whether the scores will appear as scores, percents or grades in the score chart. A popup menu in the score chart (see page 59) can override this setting.

8 Select the Progress Report option. Progress report options include the following items:

- **Include Assignment.** The assignment will be included on every progress report whether the student has a score or not.
- **Include if Student has Score.** The assignment will be included only if the student has a score. This option allows you to add columns to your score chart that only apply to one or some students. It also allows you to enter assignments in advance and prevent them from appearing too soon in progress reports.
- **Exclude Assignment.** The assignment will not be included in any progress report.

9 (Optional) Select one or more standards from the Standards menu. If there are standards in this class, you can link up to ten of them to an assignment. By linking a standard, you will be able to enter rubric scores on this standard in the Standard chart.

10 (Optional) Enter text in the Note field. Text could include the assignment objective or purpose. It can also be used in conjunction with custom filters to allow you to show or hide the assignment based on any criteria that you choose.

11 Select Next Assignment >> to move to the next assignment or select Done.

Copying Assignments to other Classes

If you teach more than one section of a subject, be sure to use the Copy Class Data tool to copy your assignments from one class to others. This can save you a lot of time and help ensure that your assignments are consistent across classes.

To copy assignments from one class to others:

1 Choose Copy -> Assignments from the Tool menu or click the Copy Class Data tool



and select the Assign. tab.

2 In the upper-left list, select the class to copy from.

3 In the lower-left list, select the class(es) to copy to. Be sure that you don't select the class that is selected in the upper list. To select multiple items, hold down the shift, ctrl (Windows) or command (Macintosh) key while clicking.

4 Select the assignments you wish to copy in the list on the right. Use the blue arrow button to select or deselect all list items.

5 Check all of your settings to ensure that you are copying the right assignments to the right classes.

6 Click the Copy button.

Managing your Assignments

You can change the name or other data in an assignment's record. You can change the order or delete your assignments. This section explains how to perform these basic tasks.

To change an assignment's name or other record data:

1 Open the assignment's record by double-clicking on the assignment's name in the score or assignment chart.

2 Edit the name or other data. Click Done.

To change the order of your assignments, do one of the following:

- Press on an assignment's name in the score or assignment chart and drag to the new location.
- Choose Sort Assignments from the View menu. You can sort by name, date, and category.

To delete a single assignment:

1 In the score chart, click the assignment's column number.

2 Click the Delete tool  or press the delete key.

To delete multiple assignments:

1 Choose Delete Assignment from the Tool menu.

2 Select the assignments to be deleted in the list. Click the Delete button.

6 Using the Score Chart

The posting and manipulation of student scores and notes can be tedious and time-consuming. This chapter explains EasyGradePro's numerous tools to make the tasks both fast and easy.

Entering Scores

This section describes a variety of ways to enter scores.

To enter scores by typing:

- 1 Select the score cell.
- 2 Enter any number from zero through 999.9.
- 3 Press Enter, return or one of the arrow keys.

To repeat a score:

- 1 Select the score cell other than the first cell in a column.
- 2 Press the '=' key.

To delete one or more scores:

- 1 Select the scores. To select multiple scores, press on the first and drag to the last.
- 2 Press the delete key.

To move a group of scores:

Use these steps if you have entered a group of scores into the wrong cells, perhaps offset by a single row or column.

- 1 Select the first score cell in the group and drag to the last.
- 2 Choose Cut from the Edit menu.
- 3 Select the first cell where the scores should go.
- 4 Choose Paste from the Edit menu.

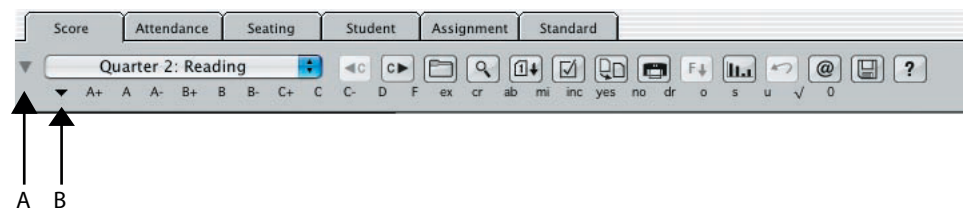
To enter a special score (i.e. *mi*) using its shortcut (i.e. *m*):

- 1 Make sure that the typing mode is set to *Allow typing of Special Score Shortcuts*. This can be set using the

typing mode menu on the toolbar (see the illustration below) or in the General view of the Gradebook Options window.

2 Select a score cell.

3 Type the shortcut key. *Do not* press enter or return; Easy Grade Pro will automatically advance to the next cell.



Use the grade click menu (A) to show or hide the row of grades and special scores. Use the typing mode menu (B) to switch between typing shortcuts and typing of grades and special scores.

To enter special scores and grades by typing:

1 Make sure that the typing mode is set to *Allow typing of Grades and Special Scores*. This can be set using the typing mode menu on the toolbar (see the illustration above) or in the General view of the Gradebook Options window.

2 Select a score cell.

3 Type the full text of the grade or special score.

4 Press enter or return.

To enter special scores and grades by grade-clicking:

1 Make sure that the row of grades is visible on the toolbar (see the illustration above).

2 Select one or more score cells. To select multiple cells, press on the first and drag to the last.

3 Click on the grade or special score on the toolbar.

For additional information on working with grades and special scores, see *Class Options: Grade Scale* on page 23, *FAQ: What is grade-clicking? How does it work?* on page 24, *Class Options: Special Score* on page 26, and *To display scores as raw scores, percents or grades* on page 56.

To fill down a score:

To fill down means to copy a score from a starting cell downward to the last row. It is typically used when most of the scores on an assignment are the same. If there are a few scores that are different, they can be changed after filling down.

1 Select a score cell.

2 If the cell is blank, type the score but do not press enter.

3 Select the Fill Down tool  or choose Fill Down from the Tool menu.

To fill across a score:

To fill across means to copy a grade from a starting cell across to the last column. It is normally used on a transferring student to apply the transfer grade to all assignments given prior to the transfer. Note that the grade, not the score, is filled across. Each assignment may have a different score but each will have the same grade value. An assignment whose special status is Not for grade is ignored during filling across.

1 Select a score cell.

2 If the cell is blank, type the score but do not press enter.

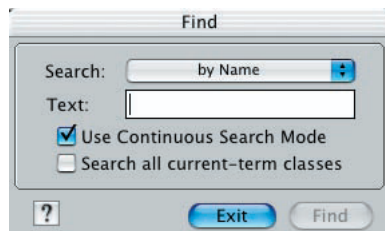
3 Select the Fill Across tool  or choose Fill Across from the Tool menu. If this tool is not visible, press on any tool or empty tool location and hold the mouse down for at least a second. From the menu

that pops up, choose the tool.

To enter scores directly from student papers:

By using EasyGradePro's Find tool, it is easy to enter scores directly from student papers—even if the papers consist of an unsorted mixture of assignments, classes and students. Here's how:

1 Open the Find window by clicking the Find tool  or by choosing Find from the Tool menu.



2 Choose *by Name* from the Search menu and select *Use Continuous Search Mode*. By selecting the continuous search mode, EasyGradePro will reopen this window after each score is entered.

3 (Optional) If the stack of papers includes several classes, select *Search all current-term classes*. If this is selected, EasyGradePro will search other classes if the student cannot be found in the current class. If you have the same student in multiple classes, you may wish to search using some other search field that you've set up for this purpose.

4 Click **Exit**. The window will close. You are now ready to begin entering scores.

5 Select the score cell for the first paper. Enter the score and press **Enter**. The Find window will reopen.

6 Enter a few letters of the name from the next paper. EasyGradePro will attempt to complete the student's name for you.

7 Click **Find** or press **Enter**. EasyGradePro will find the student and select the score cell in the same column as before. If the wrong student is selected, edit the search text and click the **Find Again** tool , choose **Find Again** from the Tool menu or simply press **Enter** twice to find the next match. If the selected cell is in the wrong assignment column, use the arrow keys to switch columns.

8 When you are done, deselect *Continuous Search Mode* and click **Exit**. The window will close.

FAQ: Why does the Find window keep popping up when I enter a score?

This window will reappear whenever a score is entered if the *Use Continuous Search mode* is turned on. This mode allows you to quickly enter scores directly from student papers. The next time the Find window opens, turn this option off.

FAQ: How does EasyGradePro treat blank score cells? How can I easily set all blanks to a certain score?

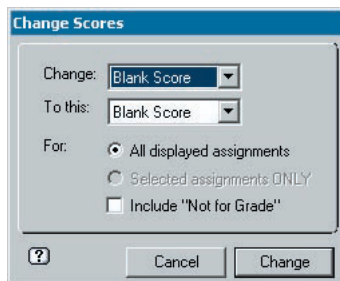
In EasyGradePro, a blank score has no value and is completely ignored when calculations are made. This allows you to add assignments in advance without affecting calculations. It also allows you to add assignments that are not meant for all students. If you set an assignment's *Progress Report* option to *Include if Student has Score*, the assignment won't even appear in a report until the student has a score. The *Show Blanks* filter can be used from the *View* menu to hide all scores except those that are blank. Don't think that you'll have to spend a lot of time filling in all the blanks with zeros; the *Change Score* tool  can easily change all blanks (or just some blanks) to zeros (or something else) with just a few clicks. (See the next section.)

To convert blank cells to a certain score:

Using the Change Scores tool , you can change scores of one type, such as blank, to another score, such as *mi*. You can choose to change scores on all assignments, displayed assignments or just selected ones.

1 (Optional) If you want to change scores on some, but not all assignments, select the assignments (by pressing on the column number and dragging left or right) or use a filter in the View menu to show just certain assignments.

2 Select the Change Scores tool or choose Change Scores from the Tool menu. If this tool is not visible, press on any tool or empty tool location and hold the mouse down for at least a second. From the menu that pops up choose the tool.



3 Use the first menu to select the score to change. If you select Text Score --> from the menu, be sure to type a numeric score.

4 Use the second menu to select the new score. As before, if you select the last item in the menu, be sure to type a numeric score.

5 Select the range of assignments to be included. If you choose *All displayed assignments*, any assignments hidden by filters will not be affected. Choose *Selected assignments ONLY* if you selected at least one assignment column before opening the window.

6 (Optional) If you would like ungraded assignments to be included, select the *Include "Not for Grade"* item. The "Not for Grade" attribute is set in the record window for an assignment.

7 Click the Change button.

Adding Footnotes and Notes to Scores

A footnote is a short, numbered, predefined note that can be quickly added to one or more scores. It is used to provide additional meaning about the score. Footnotes can be viewed and edited in the Class Options window, Footnote view.

In the score, seat and standard charts, a footnote appears as a small number between one and nine in the lower-left corner of the score cell. However, in a progress report, the full text of the footnote appears with the score.

FAQ: How is a student's overall grade calculated?

Understanding the math behind the calculation of a student's overall grade can help you use EasyGrade Pro more effectively. It can also help you explain a student's grades when asked by an inquisitive parent or student. Two examples will be used to explain the process and both use the following five sample assignments:

Assignment Data			Student Data		
Name	Maximum Score	Points	Score	%	Points Earned
Quiz 1	10	100	6.5	65%	65
Quiz 2	15	100	12	80%	80
Hwk 1	8	50	8	100%	50
Hwk 2	12	50	9	75%	37.5
EC	---	---	2	---	2

Let's take a close look at this chart. The student is being graded on two quizzes, two homework assignments and one homework assignment with status set to extra credit. On Quiz 1, the teacher set maximum score to 10 and points to 100. The student's score is 6.5. EasyGrade Pro first calculates percent: $(6.5/10) \times 100 = 65\%$. It then calculates points earned: $65\% \text{ of } 100 \text{ points possible} = 65$. Take a moment to examine the numbers for the other assignments.

Example 1: When Category Weighting is Off

When category weighting is off, EasyGrade Pro calculates an overall grade by summing the points earned and dividing by the total points possible. Here's how it does it:

1. Sum the points earned (last column): $65 + 80 + 50 + 37.5 + 2 = 234.5$
2. Sum the points possible (Points column): $100 + 100 + 50 + 50 = 300$
3. Divide points earned by points possible to get the overall percent: $234.5/300 = 78.17\%$

Example 2: When Category Weighting is On

In this example, the Quiz category is weighted 30% and Homework is weighted 50%. A third category, Final Exam, is weighted 20% but is not yet being used. When category weighting is used, EasyGrade Pro goes through the calculations in Example 1 for each category. Then it combines the categories using the category weights to calculate the overall percent. It works properly even though not all categories are being used.

- | | Quiz | Homework |
|--|--|------------------------|
| 1. Sum the points earned (last column): | $65 + 80 = 145$ | $50 + 37.5 + 2 = 89.5$ |
| 2. Sum the points possible: | $100 + 100 = 200$ | $50 + 50 = 100$ |
| 3. Divide to get the category percent: | $145/200 = 72.5\%$ | $89.5/100 = 89.5\%$ |
| 4. Combine the categories percents using their weights to get the overall percent: | $((72.5\% \times 30\%) + (89.5\% \times 50\%)) / (30\% + 50\%) = 83.125\%$ | |

How an Extra Credit category affects calculations

With EasyGrade Pro, you can add extra credit by increasing a student's score, by setting the status of an assignment to Extra Credit (illustrated above) and by creating an Extra Credit category in the Class Options window.

When using an extra credit category that is not weighted, EasyGrade Pro will use the assignment's Maximum Score and Points to calculate the points earned by the student on the extra credit. Then it will follow the steps in Example 1 but ignoring the Points possible on the extra credit assignment in step 2.

When using an extra credit category that is weighted, EasyGrade Pro will follow steps 1 through 3 in Example 2 above to calculate the student's extra credit category percent. But in step 4, it will exclude the extra credit category when summing the category weights (the part to the right of the division symbol).

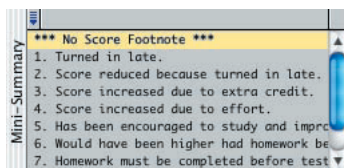
For a related topic, see FAQ: How can I check the calculations for one of my students? on page 89.

A	47.5	B	8	12/4/06	Classw..	Journal Entries	47.5/50	47.5/50	95.0% A
									Score increased due to extra credit.

A footnote number appears in the lower-left corner of a score cell (A) but the full text appears with the score in a progress report (B).

To attach a footnote to a score, do one of the following:

- Right-click (Windows) or control-click (Macintosh) on the cell and select the footnote from a contextual menu that pops up. To delete a footnote, choose the first item in the menu.
- Double-click the score to open the Score Note window and select a footnote. To delete a footnote, select the first list item.
- Select one or more score cells and click on a footnote in the Mini-summary palette. If the palette is not visible, choose *Show Mini-sum.* in the Gradebook Options window, under the General tab. Press on the menu on the palette to display the list of footnotes. Select the first list item to delete a footnote.

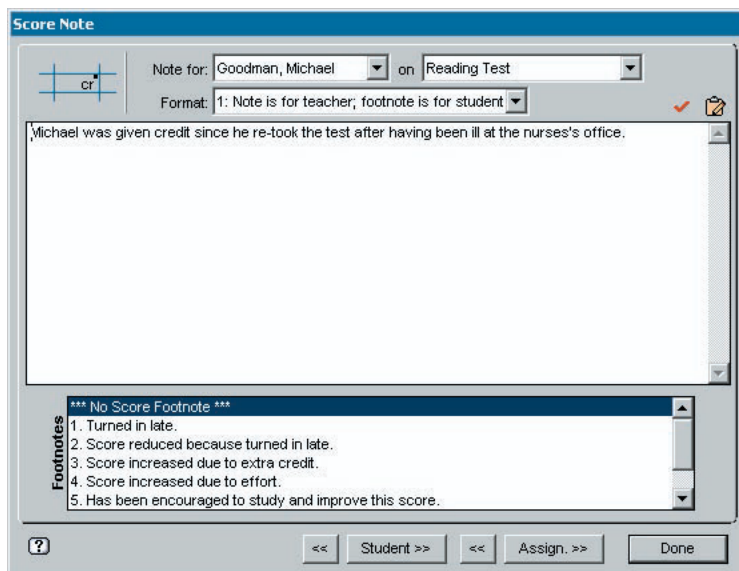


The Mini-summary window can be used to attach footnotes to scores.

In addition to score footnotes, you may attach unique and lengthy notes to scores. You may even use notes instead of scores for special situations. This section that follows explains how to attach notes to scores.

To attach a note to a score:

- 1 Double-click on a student's score cell or select the score cell and click the Open Score Note tool.
- The Score Note window will open.



The Score Note window allows you to attach a unique, lengthy note to a score. This sample Score Cell in the upper-left corner shows how the note alters the appearance of the score cell.

2 Use the Format menu to select one of the following:

- *Note is for teacher; footnote is for student.* The footnote but not the note will appear in a student's progress report.
- *Note is for student.* The note will appear in a student report. A footnote is not allowed.
- *Note is for student in place of score.* The note will appear in a student report in place of a score. A footnote

is not allowed.

3 Type the note or use the Clipboard tool to paste in a note created in the Clipboard Text view of the Gradebook Options window. See *Gradebook Options: Clipboard Text* on page 37 for additional information on Clipboard text.

The sample Score Cell in the upper-left corner shows how the note alters the appearance of the score cell. If you add a note using the first or second format, a small, black box appears in the upper-right corner of the cell. A footnote number may appear in the lower-left corner. If you choose the third format, a picture of a notebook cover shows the score cell indicating that a score is not allowed.

4 (Optional) To check the spelling of the note, click the Spell button.

5 (Optional) To add a note for a different student or assignment, use the menus and buttons at the top and bottom.

6 Click Done.

Adjusting Grades: Dropping, Extra Credit, Curving and Locking

You can raise and lower student grades by dropping scores, adding extra credit, curving assignments and curving/locking over all grades. This section explains how to perform these tasks.

To drop the most damaging scores for each student:

1 Choose Assignment from the Chart menu.

2 In the Status column, choose *Can be Dropped* for one or more assignments. Only assignments with this setting will be eligible for dropping.

3 Choose Score from the Chart menu.

Easy Grade Pro will regrade each student and drop the score that results in the greatest improvement in the student's overall grade. If you would like to drop more than one score, then complete the next steps as well:

4 (Optional) To have Easy Grade Pro drop more than one score, choose Class Options from the Edit menu and select the Category tab. In the Dropping/Extra Credit column, select the number of scores to be dropped in each category. There is a limit of four. For more information on this, refer to the section *Class Options: Score Category* on page 25.

When a score is dropped, a small letter *d* is drawn in the upper-left corner of the score cell. As new scores are entered, the *d* may move about, disappear and reappear.

FAQ: Why wasn't the lowest score dropped? Why are fewer scores being dropped for some students?

First of all, Easy Grade Pro only drops scores on assignments with status of *Can be Dropped*. Choose Assignment from the Chart menu and look in the Status column to check for this. Next, it drops only one score for a student unless Dropping options have been set in the Class Options window. In this case, up to four scores can be dropped. Choose Class Options from the Edit menu and select the Category tab to check for this. Finally, Easy Grade Pro does not drop the lowest scores. Rather, it drops the most damaging scores. These are the scores that, when dropped, result in the greatest improvement in the student's overall percent. For a student who has her lowest score on an assignment with little point value or in a category with little weight, Easy Grade Pro may drop a higher score. For a student who performs well on tests but poorly on homework, the student's lowest test score may actually be helping to prop up his overall percent; in this case Easy Grade may not drop any test. In all cases, Easy Grade Pro will drop scores or not drop scores to maximize the benefit to the student.

To add extra credit, do one of the following:

- Increase the score on any normal assignment.
- Add a new assignment and set its *status* to Extra Credit. With this method, the assignment does *not* have a maximum score or points value. Scores that are entered for students are treated as points and are added directly to the students' points-earned totals. Be careful to enter scores that are proportional to the number of points possible in the class or else the effect of the extra credit may be too little or too great.
- Add a new assignment and set its *category* to Extra Credit. This option is only available if you've set up an extra credit category in the Class Options window. With this method, the assignment *does* have a maximum score and points value. If you are not using category weighting, be careful to set the points value in proportion to the number of points possible in the class. When you enter a score, Easy Grade Pro will calculate the student's point earned and add them to the total point earned.

To view how extra credit is affecting a student's grade, see *FAQ: How can I check the calculations for one of my students?* on page 89.

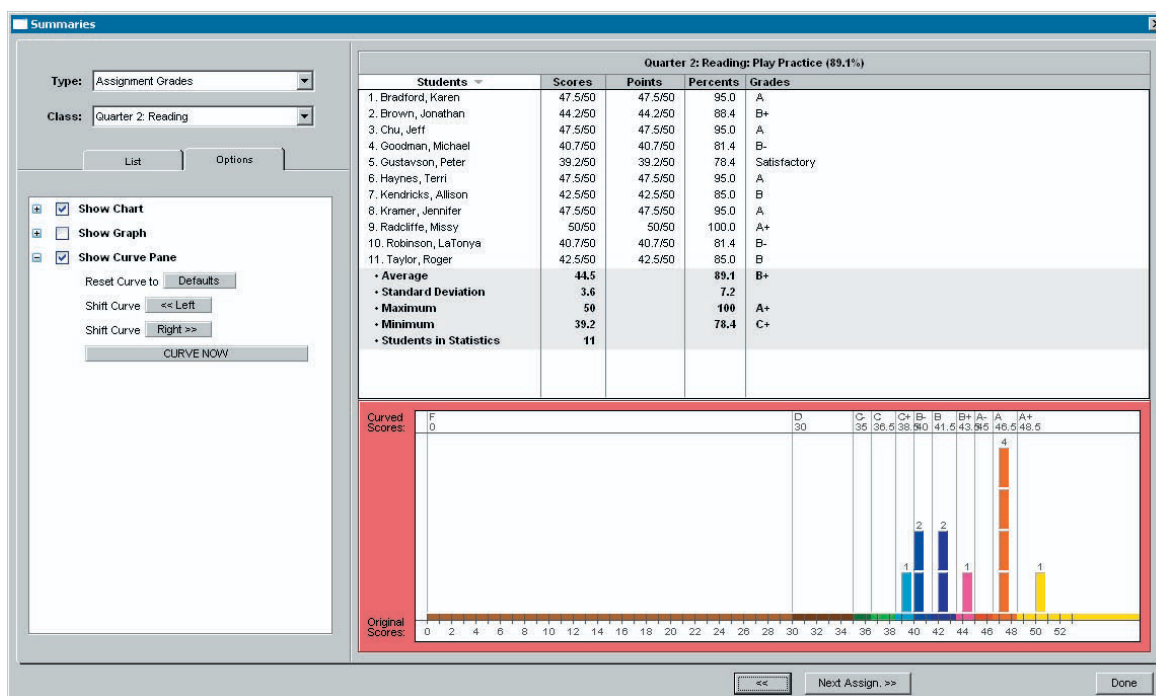
To curve an assignment:

In Easy Grade Pro, curving an assignment means to change student scores in a methodical way to produce a better distribution of grades. Some assessments result in distributions of scores that are too wide or too low. Curving can help produce the desired distribution in cases like these. Here's how:

1 Select the assignment by clicking on its title in the score chart.

2 Choose *Curve Assign.* from the Tool menu or select the Curve tool . The Summaries window will open to the Assignment Grades view where you can optionally view a list of students ranked by scores, a graph of student performance as well as a curve pane (bottom).

3 In the Options pane on the left, turn on the Show Curve Pane item and click the disclosure button to its left to reveal the curve options (shown below).



To the right, you will see a curve graph. Here are some things to notice about the graph:

- Along the bottom axis are numbers that represent possible range of scores on the assignment. The colors indicate each grade.
- Above this axis are boxes -- one for each student. These are also color coded to indicate the grade.
- There is a vertical line for each grade in the grade scale. At the top of the line is the grade label. Below each grade is a number that represents the cutoff score for that grade.

4 To change the distribution of grades, do the following:

- Click the Shift Curve <<Left button to cause the vertical lines to move to the left on a step.
- Click the Shift Curve Right >> button to cause the vertical lines to move to the right on a step.
- Press on a vertical grade line in the graph and drag it left or right. Note: a line cannot be moved onto or past another grade line.

5 To view the exact score that a student will receive based on your changes, click on a column of boxes.

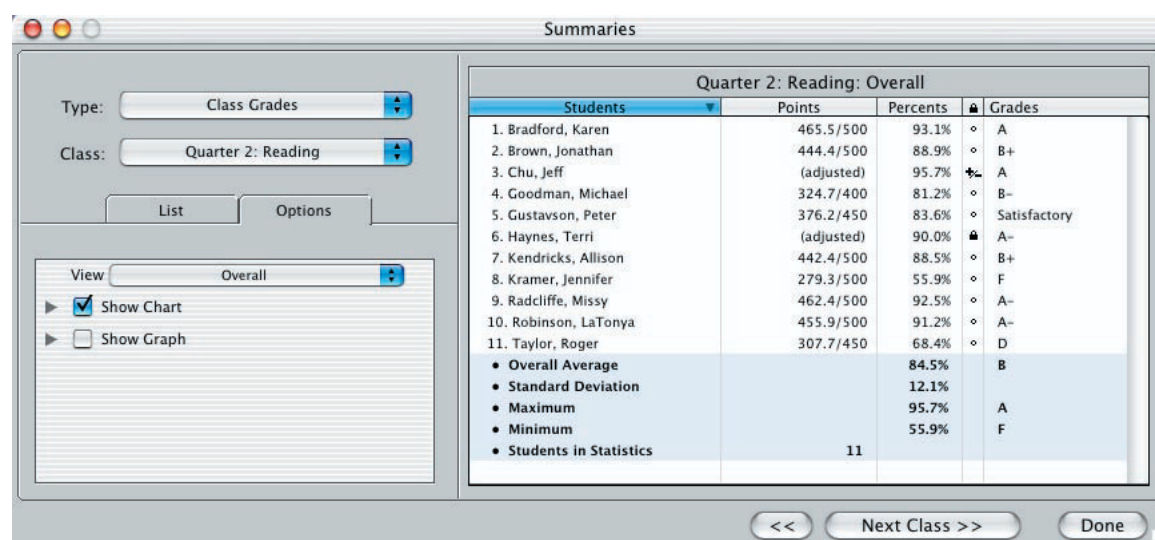
6 To curve the assignment, click the CURVE NOW button. *Warning: Easy Grade Pro will replace the students' original scores with the new scores.* The assignment's title will change to reflect that this assignment has been curved. If you do not want to lose your original score, first duplicate the assignment before curving.

FAQ: How can I keep my original scores on an assignment that I want to curve?

When an assignment is curved, the original student scores are replaced by curved scores. If you'd like to keep the original scores but not have them impact student grades then try this: 1) Choose Assignment from the Chart menu. 2) Press on the assignment's row number to select it. 3) Choose Copy from the Edit menu. 4) Choose Paste from the Edit menu while the column is still selected. It will become duplicated. 5) In the status column, change the status of the original assignment to Not for Grade. Optional: change the Progress Report option to Exclude Assignment. Be sure to curve the duplicated assignment instead of the original.

To lock or curve the overall grade:

1 Choose Lock/Curve Grade from the Tool menu. The Summaries window will open to the Class Grades view (shown below).



2 In the Options pane on the left, set the View menu to Overall. Turn on the Show Chart item.

3 To lock a grade, press on the small circle under the column with the lock icon. From the menu that pops up, choose *Next higher grade*, *Next lower grade* or *Other* (if you would like to type in your own percent). The new percent will appear in the list and a lock icon will appear in the lock column. Typically, locking a grade is something that is only done at the end of a term because, once a grade is locked, it does not change even when scores are added.

4 To curve a grade, press on the small circle under the column with the lock icon. From the menu that pops up, choose one of the *Curve* items or *Other* (if you would like to type in your own percent). If you type a new percent, be sure to put a '+' or a '-' in front of the offset percent (i.e. '+5.0' or '-5.0'). The new percent will appear in the list and a curve icon will appear in the lock column. Curving a grade can be done at any time. The student's grade is adjusted by the offset amount every time a score is entered.

To unlock a grade or to remove a curve offset, press on the lock or curve icon and, from the menu that appears, choose *Unlocked value*.

5 Click Done. A small +/- symbol is drawn in the score chart for a student with a curved grade. A small padlock is drawn for a locked grade.

3	Chu, Jeff	4.00	95.7 A	+
4	Goodman, Michael	2.67	81.2 B-	
5	Gustavson, Peter		83.6 Satisfac..	
6	Haynes, Terri	3.67	90.0 A-	🔒

A small +/- symbol is drawn for a student with a curved grade. A small padlock is drawn for a locked grade. Click on these symbols to open the Summary window where overall grades can be edited.

Customizing the Display of your Data

You can customize the display of data in the score chart in a variety of ways. This section explains how to customize the score chart to meet your unique and changing needs.

To display scores as raw scores, percents or grades:

An assignment's display of scores can be set in its record window. To override this setting so that the scores on all assignments are displayed as raw scores, percents or grades, use the small menu next to the intersection of the first student row and the first assignment column shown below.

A		10 of 10 Assign.	Literature Group
			Classwork
	Overall		50
	96.8 A		47.5
	92.5 A-		44.2

Press on this menu (A) to set the display of scores or raw scores, percents or grades.

To resize the assignment title region:

If your assignments' titles are long, you can give them more room in the score chart. If the titles are consistently short, you can take away some spaces so that more student rows can be shown on your screen. To resize the column height, press and drag the thick, horizontal line below the assignment titles up or down.

Play Prac Classwork	Play Test-Quiz	Reading Classwork	Reading Test-Quiz	Chart Le: Classwork	Journal E Classwork	Level Te: Test-Quiz
50	50	25	50	25	50	25
47.5	47.5	21.2	45.7	yes	50 ^d	22.8
44.2	40.7	21.2 ^d	42.5	yes	50	22.1
	47.5	25	42.5	yes	50 ^d	21.2

← A

To resize the column height, press on the thick line below the assignment titles (A) and drag up or down.

To add a column to display point earned, term grades, attendance totals, special student record information, class rank, etc.:

1 Press on the column title above the column of student names (or an adjacent column) and, from the menu that pops up, choose **Add NEW Column**. A new column with student names will appear. Note: this menu item will become disabled if the eight-column limit has been reached.

2 Press on the new column's title to bring up the menu again, but, this time, choose the desired content for the column.

3 To resize the column, press on the vertical line to the right of the title and drag left or right.

4 To move the column to a new location, press on any data beneath the column's title and drag left or right. Note: this does not work with the column of student names. To move this column, drag the other columns around it.

5 To delete a column, press on the column title and choose **Delete THIS Column**.

10 of 10 Students	Rank	Overall
Bradford, Karen	2	98.4 A+
Brown, Jonathan	5	93.6 A
Chu, Jeff	3	97.6 A+
Goodman, Michael	6	90.3 A-
Gustavson, Peter	8	86.7 Satisfac..
Haynes, Terri	7	90.2 A-
Kramer, Jennifer	10	69.1 D
Radcliffe, Missy	1	100.1 A+
Robinson, LaTonya	4	94.8 A
Taylor, Roger	9	86.6 B
ADD STUDENT +		

To add a column or to change its content, press on the column's title (A).
To resize a column, press on the vertical line to the right of the title (B).

and drag. To move a column, press on a data cell and drag.

To show just one student or a subset of students:

- To show only a single student, choose the student from the popup menu immediately above the first row number in the score chart. This enters the *show one* mode in which the vertical scrollbar scrolls the students one at a time drawing each in the first row. The Find tool allows you to find any student and still never have more than one student visible.
- To show or hide selected students, press on a student's row number. Drag up or down to select multiple rows. Then choose Show Selected or Hide Selected from the View menu.
- Choose Show All from the View menu to return to the normal view.

To show just one assignment or a subset of assignments:

- To show a single assignment, choose the assignment from the popup menu to the left of the first assignment's column number.
- To show assignments in a single category, choose the category from the popup menu to the left of the first assignment's column number.
- To show or hide selected assignments, press on an assignment's column number. Drag left or right to select multiple columns. Then choose Show Selected or Hide Selected from the View menu.
- Choose Show All from the View menu to return to the normal view.

To show missing work, failing students, blank scores, absent students, the top 10, improvers, decliners or other special groups:

Choose one of the custom filters from the View menu or from the popup menu immediately above the vertical scrollbar. For information on editing and creating custom filters, see *Gradebook Options: Filters* on page 35.

Auto-filling Attendance Scores

You can have Easy Grade Pro enter scores into your score chart based on attendance codes that you've entered in the attendance chart. For example, if you've entered an attendance code of AE (excused absence) for three students on a day when one or more assignments are due, you can have Easy Grade Pro enter scores of *ab* on those assignments for those three students.

To set up scores for auto-filling:

- 1 Choose Class Options from the Edit menu and select the Attendance tab.
- 2 Under the Auto-fill Score column, select the special scores to be used for auto-filling. Scores can be created under the Score tab in the same window.

To auto-fill attendance scores:

- 1 Choose Score from the Chart menu.
- 2 Select the column or columns that you would like to auto-fill by pressing on an assignment's column number and dragging left or right. You can select any assignments regardless of date because Easy Grade Pro will only fill in scores when the date of the assignment matches the date of the attendance code.
- 3 From the Tool menu, choose Score Tools -> Auto-fill Attendance Scores or click on the Auto-fill Attendance Score tool . If this tool is not on the toolbar, press on hold on any unused tool (or on an empty tool location) and, from the menu that pops up, choose this tool.

7 Using the Standard Chart

This chapter explains how to use EasyGradePro's standard chart for standards-based grading. It first presents the rationale for standards-based grading and then explains how to set up and manage rubrics and standards. Finally, it describes the two views of the standard chart: how and when to use each to enter standards scores. Since the standard chart has much in common with the score chart (i.e. how scores and notes are entered and how to customize the display of data), be sure to refer to Chapter 6, *Using the Score Chart* to become familiar with the features common to both. To view the standard chart, choose Standard from the Chart menu.

Traditional Grading vs. Standards-based Grading

Since standards-based grading is new relative to traditional grading, it may be helpful to compare the two grading methodologies. Traditional grading is easy to spot because it typically involves:

- Simple letter grades.
- Assessments based on teacher-defined criteria.
- A single overall grade per student based on a combination of related and unrelated assessments of skills, knowledge, performance and conduct over a period of time.

The main advantages of this method are simplicity and professional freedom. However, it results in a very limited measure of a student's abilities. The A on a child's report card might thrill the parents, but this grade obviously doesn't convey any precise information. Standards-based grading overcomes this problem. The essential qualities of standards-based grading involve:

- Rubrics with meaningful labels.
- Assessments based on specific state, district or school-wide standards.
- Multiple grades per student: one for each standard that reflects the student's ability related to the standard at a certain moment in time.

Obviously, this more complete assessment comes at a significant cost: it takes more time. EasyGradePro offers tools to help minimize the amount of extra time needed and tools to take advantage of all the new information.

Rubrics

Before standards-based grading can occur, a class must have one or more rubric scales. Each class in an Easy Grade Pro gradebook automatically comes with a set of rubrics but you can edit these and add your own to better match your standards. A rubric consists of labels like *Exceeds Standard*, *Meets Standard*, *Approaching Standard* and *Below Standard* and numeric values like 4.00, 3.00, 2.00 and 1.00.

To edit rubric options:

1 Choose Class Options from the Edit menu and select the Rubric tab.

2 To set the rounding level for all rubrics to whole numbers, tenths or hundredths place, use the menu below the left list.

3 To view or edit a rubric, click on its row number. The labels and values will appear in the list to the right where they can be edited.

4 To create a new rubric, click the small blue button above the left list and choose the appropriate item from the menu that appears. Type the name of the rubric in the list on the left and then type the labels and values in the list to the right. The values must be in descending order. Use the small blue arrows to insert or delete a row anywhere in a rubric.

Class Options for Term 1: Science

Grade Rubric Category Footnote Score Attend. Calendar Term Seat Color

Use RUBRIC options to set up the rubric scales for this class. Since standards are initially assigned the first rubric in the list, your main rubric should be dragged to that position.

Select a Rubric	Items in Rubric	Value
1 4-pt Rubric	1 Exceeds Standard	4.00
2 5-pt Rubric	2 Meets Standard	3.00
	3 Approaching Standard	2.00
	4 Below Standard	1.00
	5	
	6	
	7	
	8	
	9	
	10	

Rounding level for scores and averages:
Hundredths

Cancel Done

5 (Optional) Easy Grade Pro automatically calculates the minimum value needed for each item in a rubric scale. To edit these minimums, click on the small blue button above the right-most scrollbar. A window will open where editing can occur.

6 To duplicate or delete a rubric, first click on its row number. Then click the small blue button above the left list and choose the appropriate item from the menu that appears.

7 The first rubric item in the list is the most important one because it is initially assigned to all standards. In addition, it is automatically used for the overall, or combined, standard grade. To move a rubric to the top position, press on its row number and drag it upwards.

To copy rubrics from one class to others: See *Copying Class Options* to other Classes on page 31.

To set the display mode of rubrics: See *Gradebook Options: General* on page 32.

Standards

Before standards-based grading can occur, standards must be added to a class. What is a standard? In Easy GradePro, a standard consists of an ID, level, text, rubric, grading method, and weight. Here is a partial list of standards for middle school sciences showing these attributes:

ID	Level	Standard Text	Rubric	Grading	Weight
SCI1	STANDARD	SYSTEMS: THE STUDENT KNOWS AND APPLIES SCIENTIFIC CONCEPTS AND PRINCIPLES TO UNDERSTAND THE PROPERTIES,...	4-POINT	AVG. OF STRANDS	1.00
SCI1.1	Strand	Properties: Understand how properties are used to identify, describe, and categorize substances, materials, and objects...	4-POINT	Avg. of Indicators	1.00
SCI1.1.1	Indicator	Understand how to use physical and chemical properties...	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00
SCI1.1.2		Understand the positions, relative speeds, and changes...	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00
SCI1.1.3		Understand sound waves, water waves, and light waves...	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00
SCI1.2	Strand	Structures: Understand how components, structures, organizations, and interconnections describe systems.	4-POINT	Avg. of Indicators	1.00
SCI1.2.1	Indicator	Analyze how the parts of a system interconnect/influence each other...	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00
SCI1.2.2		Understand how various factors affect energy transfers...	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00
SCI1.2.3		Understand that all matter is made of particles called atoms...	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00
SCI1.3	Strand	Changes: Understand how interactions within and among systems cause changes in matter and energy.	4-POINT	Avg. of Indicators	1.00
SCI1.3.1	Indicators	Understand factors that affect the strength and direction of forces.	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00
SCI1.3.2		Understand how forces can change the motion of objects.	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00
SCI1.3.3		Understand that matter is conserved in physical/chemical changes.	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00
SCI2	STANDARD	INQUIRY: THE STUDENT KNOWS AND APPLIES THE SKILLS, PROCESSES, AND NATURE OF SCIENTIFIC INQUIRY.	4-POINT	Avg. of Indicators	1.00
SCI2.1	Strand	Investigating Systems: Develop the knowledge and skills necessary to do scientific inquiry.	4-POINT	Avg. of Indicators	1.00
SCI2.1.1	Indicator	Understand how to generate a question that can be answered...	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00
SCI2.1.2		Understand how to plan and conduct scientific investigations.	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00
SCI2.1.3		Apply understanding of how to construct a scientific...	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00
SCI2.2	Strand	Nature of Science: Understand the nature of scientific inquiry.	4-POINT	Avg. of Indicators	1.00
SCI2.2.1	Indicator	Apply curiosity, honesty, skepticism, and openness when...	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00
SCI2.2.2		Understand that scientific theories explain facts using infer. logic.	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00
SCI2.2.3		Analyze inconsistent results from scientific investigation to...	4-POINT	Powerlaw	1.00

Standard Attributes:

- The standard *ID* uniquely identifies a standard just as a student *ID* is unique to each student.
- It is common for lists of standards produced by educational agencies to display standards in a hierarchical list. In Easy GradePro, the standard's *Level* indicates its position in the hierarchy. In the list above, there are three levels: Standard, Strand and Indicator. You may have all standards at the same level if desired. If you use levels, be aware that student scores can only be entered on standards at the bottom level. Easy GradePro will then use these scores to calculate the grades for the higher-level standards.
- The *Standard Text* is the description of the standard.

- The *Rubric* is the set of labels to be used to display a student's performance on the standard. Each standard can have its own rubric.
- *Grading options* include averaging, power law, and manual. Standards that have standards linked to them from below are always automatically graded based on the average of linked standards.
- The *Weight* can be used to make some standards worth more than others for calculations.

FAQ: How many standards should I add to my class?

It is typical for the list of standards produced by educational agencies to have literally dozens of standards for a single curriculum area at a single grade level. Although, EasyGrade Pro has been designed to accommodate these long lists, we recommend that you actually report on no more than a dozen standards. Otherwise, the effort and time required may become overwhelming. Students and parents may become overwhelmed as well. Notice the emphasis on the word *report*. It is possible to have standards in a class that are used for scoring but not for reporting. For example, if you have 36 standards with six at a highest level, each with six linked, lower-level standards, you can use the 30 lower-level standards for scoring but the six higher-level standards for reporting. You may end up with only a few scores on each of the 30 lower-level standards but these can produce every meaningful data point on the six standards that get reported. You decide!

Adding Standards to a Class by Typing

Each class in EasyGrade Pro can have up to 128 standards. Standards can be added to a class by typing, copying from another class, importing from another grade book, or through the use of plug-in files. This section explains how to add standards by typing.

1 Choose **Add Standard** from the **Tool** menu. The **Records** window will open to the first empty record.

2 Type the *Standard ID* and press **Tab**. Standard IDs must be unique and can be up to 11 keystrokes in length. If your standards are at multiple levels, it's recommended that you use a dot notation like that shown in the list in the prior section to clearly indicate each standard's position within the list.

3 Choose the standard's *Level* from the **Level** menu. If your standards are all at the same level, choose the top-most level for each. If you choose level 2 (i.e. Strand) or level 3 (i.e. Indicator), then you'll also need to choose the link standard—the higher-level standard that this standard belongs to. To edit the label, text

style and background color for each level, choose **Edit Level Options** from the menu.

4 Type the standard's *text*. It can be up to about 200 keystrokes long.

5 (Optional) Type additional text regarding the standard in the *Note* field.

6 Select the *Progress Report* option. Progress report options include the following items:

- *Include Standard*. The standard will be included on every progress report.
- *Include if Student has Grade*. The standard will be included only if the student has a grade. This option allows you to prevent standards from appearing in progress reports unless actually used.
- *Exclude Standard*. The standard will not be included in any progress report.

7 Select the *Rubric* to be used for converting a student's numeric grade to a label.

8 Select the grading option from the *Grade* menu. When making your choice, be sure to consider that a student's standard grade is meant to reflect performance at a certain moment in time rather than performance over an extended period of time. Your choices are:

- *Average of scores*. Averaging has less usefulness with standards-based grading. However, it can be appropriate for very broad standards.
- *Power Law Formula*. The power law is an excellent tool when used appropriately. For more information, read this section *FAQ: What is the Power Law Formula for standards-based grading?*
- *None*. This option is best if you want the most accurate grades--ones that reflect your understanding of all the details involved in sets of scores--and if you have the time! With this option, you would then manually enter standard grades in the *Summaries* window as you analyze graphs of performance.
- *Avg. of linked standards*. This option is automatically selected for any standard that has standards linked to it.

9 Press **Enter** or click *Next Standard* >> to move to the next standard or click *Done*.

Managing Standards

You can distribute standards via plug-in files, copy standards from class to class, sort them and delete them. This section explains how to perform these tasks.

To use plug-in file to distribute standard to other teachers:

Once a set of standards has been entered into a class, it can be saved as a plug-in file for distribution to other teachers. To create the plug-in file, choose **Records** from the **Chart** menu, click the **Standard** tab, press on the small blue arrow next to the **Standard ID** field and choose *Save Standards as Plug-in* from the menu that appears. It is recommended that you name the file using a subject-grade format (i.e. *Math Grade 5, Reading Grade 6*, etc.). Plug-in files can be distributed to other computers and should be placed in the *Plug-ins* folder found in the same folder as the *Easy Grade Pro* application. To import the standards from a plug-in file into a class, choose **Records** from the **Chart** menu, click the **Standard** tab, press on the small blue arrow next to the **Standard ID** field and choose the desired set from the menu that appears. It is possible to import standards from multiple plug-in files into a single class; *Easy Grade Pro* will filter out any standards with IDs already present in the class.

FAQ: What is the Power Law Formula for standards-based grading?

An internet search for “Power Law Formula” results in hundredsof listings in a wide variety of fields including astronomy, meteorology, and engineering. In his highly regarded book *TRANSFORMING CLASSROOM GRADING*, Robert J. Marzano describes the use of this formula for standards-based grading. The math behind the power law formula is quite complex (see below), but all that’s necessary for its use is that you know what it does, how to interpret its scores, and when best to use it.

In essence, the power law formula predicts what the student’s next score will be based on scores already present. It can be thought of as a mathematical calculation that answers the question: “If the student were assessed right now on a skill, at what level would the student likely perform?” Since a student’s grade on a standard is meant to be an indication of skill at a certain moment in time, the power law formula can be used to calculate standard grades.

To gain an understanding of how the power law works, let’s look at a set of student scores and Easy Grade Pro’s power law calculation of each set. To keep things simple, let’s say there are four assessments and four students and each student has earned the same scores 1.00, 2.00, 3.00 and 4.00, but in a different order. If we were to simply average the four scores, all students would receive a 2.50. However, with the power law, we’ll get different values because the power law puts more weight on recent assessments. Let’s take a look:

	Assessment #1 (least weight)	Assessment #2	Assessment #3	Assessment #4 (greatest weight)	Power Law Score	Interpretation of the Power Law Score
Student #1	1.00	2.00	3.00	4.00	4.00	The scores show continuous improvement. The student will likely demonstrate mastery on the next assessment.
Student #2	1.00	3.00	2.00	4.00	3.66	The scores show irregular improvement. The student will likely demonstrate high but not complete mastery on the next assessment.
Student #3	2.00	4.00	1.00	3.00	2.16	The scores show very uneven performance. The student will likely demonstrate mid-level of achievement on the next assessment.
Student #4	4.00	3.00	2.00	1.00	1.28	The scores show continuous decline. The student will likely demonstrate a low level of achievement on the next assessment.

As you can see, the power law formula can result in more meaningful values than averaging. Should it then always be used? No! The power law formula is best used on narrowly defined standards (i.e. subtraction of mixed numbers with borrowing). Avoid its use with broadly written standards that consist of multiple skills—the results will be less meaningful.

For those with the inclination, here’s the power law formula used by Easy Grade Pro where x is the ordinal number of the score, s is the score and N is the number of scores with all scores in date order:

$$\text{power law score} = e^{\left[\frac{\sum (\ln x) \left[\frac{\sum (\ln x)(\ln s) - \frac{(\sum \ln x)(\sum \ln s)}{N}}{\sum (\ln x)^2 - \frac{(\sum \ln x)^2}{N}} \right]}{\sum (\ln x)^2 - \frac{(\sum \ln x)^2}{N}} + \frac{\sum (\ln y) - (\sum \ln x) \left[\frac{\sum (\ln x)(\ln s) - \frac{(\sum \ln x)(\sum \ln s)}{N}}{\sum (\ln x)^2 - \frac{(\sum \ln x)^2}{N}} \right]}{N} \right]}$$

To copy standards from one class to others:

- 1 Choose Copy->Standards from the Tool menu.
- 2 In the upper-left list, select the class to copy from.
- 3 In the lower-left list, select the class(es) to copy to. Be sure that you don't select the class that is selected in the upper list.
- 4 Select the standards you wish to copy in the list on the right. Use the blue arrow button to select or deselect all list items. Hold down the Ctrl (Windows), Command (Macintosh) or shift key to select multiple items.
- 5 Check all of your settings to ensure that you are copying the right standards to the right classes.
- 6 Click the Copy button.

To change a standard's text, grading option or other record data:

Open the standard's record by double-clicking on the standard's name in the standard chart. Edit the name or other data. Click Done. If you change the level of a standard, Easy Grade Pro will automatically re-sort your standards by level.

To change the order of your standards, do one of the following:

Note: If you have standards at multiple levels, Easy Grade Pro will enforce a level-order to your standards.

- Press on a standard's text in the 1-Student view of the Standard's chart and drag to the new location.
- Choose Sort Standards from the View menu.

To delete one or more standards:

Note: If you have standards at multiple levels, you cannot delete a standard that has standards linked to it unless you delete the linked standards as well.

- 1 Choose Delete->Standard from the Tool menu.
- 2 Select the standards you wish to delete from the list. Use the blue arrow button to select or deselect all list items. Hold down the Ctrl (Windows), Command (Macintosh) or shift key to select multiple items.
- 3 Click the Delete button.

The Two Views of the Standard Chart: 1-Assignment and 1-Student

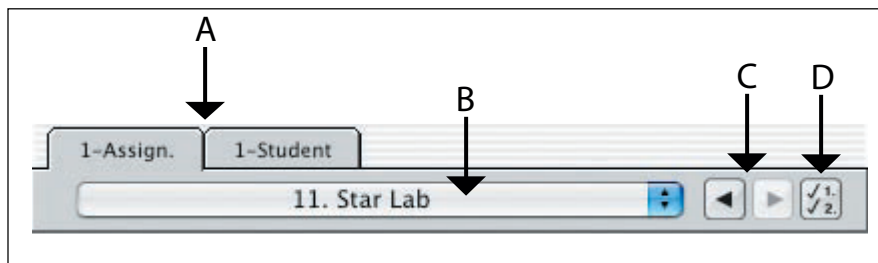
The Standard chart actually consists of two separate charts: 1-Assignment and 1-Student. You'll find tabs for these below the tool bar. Both the 1-Assignment and 1-Student views can be used to enter scores and notes on your assignments and standards. So why are there two charts? Because there are four types of data – students, assignments, standards and scores -- it is impossible to show all the data in a two-dimensional view. With the 1-Assignment chart, you can view scores for all students on a single assignment (with linked standards). With the 1-Student view, you can view scores on all assignments (with linked standards) for one student.

To view or switch between the two standard charts:

- 1 Choose Standard from the Chart menu.
- 2 Find the standard tool bar below the main tool bar. Press on the 1-Assign. and 1-Student tabs to switch between the two charts.

To choose an assignment or student for viewing:

- Press on the menu immediately below the tabs (B).
- Click on the Prior Item  or Next Item tool  (C).

**To link 1 or more standards to an assignment:**

- In the 1-Assignment chart, press on the Standards tool  (D). From the menu that appears, select up to ten standards. Note: only standards that do not have standards linked to them from below can be selected and scored.
- Standards can also be linked to an assignment in the assignments record. To view a record, double-click on the assignment's name or choose Record from the Chart menu. From the Standards menu, select up to ten standards.

Traditional versus Standard Scores

In the standard chart, two types of scores can be entered: traditional and standard. *Traditional* scores are the percents-based scores that virtually all grading programs have been designed to handle: $8/10 = 80\%$ B-. *Standard* scores are scores that correlate to the levels in a rubric: 2.00 = *Meets Standard*. In standards-based grading, traditional scores are not required. However, they can be used in beneficial ways. For example:

- Traditional scores can be used in exactly the same way as they are used in non-standards-based grading. In other words, a teacher can continue to grade based on traditional grading methods and simply add standards-based grading to the process.
- Traditional grades can be used to record completion only. For example, a teacher may use the special scores *yes, no, mi, ab, inc*, etc. to keep track of whether assignments have been completed or not. With this method, missing work reports can still be generated.
- Traditional scores can be used to keep track of an effort grade using a typical A, B, C grade scale or some other scale. Although an effort standard could easily be set up, using traditional grading for effort allows effort and performance on skill-based standards to be graded separately.

Entering traditional scores:

In the 1-Assignment chart, traditional scores can be entered into the column with the assignment's name. In the 1-Student chart, traditional scores can be entered into the first row below all of the assignment names. Since scores can be entered using the same techniques described in the Chapter 6, *Using the Score Chart*, that information will not be duplicated here.

Please refer to the Quick Reference pages that follow for concise information about using the Standard chart.

QuickReference:The 1-AssignmentStandard Chart

Switching Classes
Use this to switch to any class in a gradebook.

Grade Clicks
To show/hide the row of grades, click here.

Mini Summary
To switch between views, click here.

1-Assign./1-Student
To switch between two different views for entering scores, click these tabs.

Switching Assignments
To view a specific assignment, click here or on the two arrow buttons.

Linking Standards
To link up to 10 standards to an assignment, press on this menu.

Adding Students
To add a student, click here.

Moving Columns
To move a column to a new location, press anywhere on its data and drag left or right.

Symbols
Symbols here indicate missing scores, locked and curved grades.

Assignment Scores
Enter traditional assignment scores in this column. Double-click to enter notes.

Standard Scores
Enter rubric scores in the columns below the standard text.

Viewing Records
To view the record for an assignment or standard, double-click on its title.

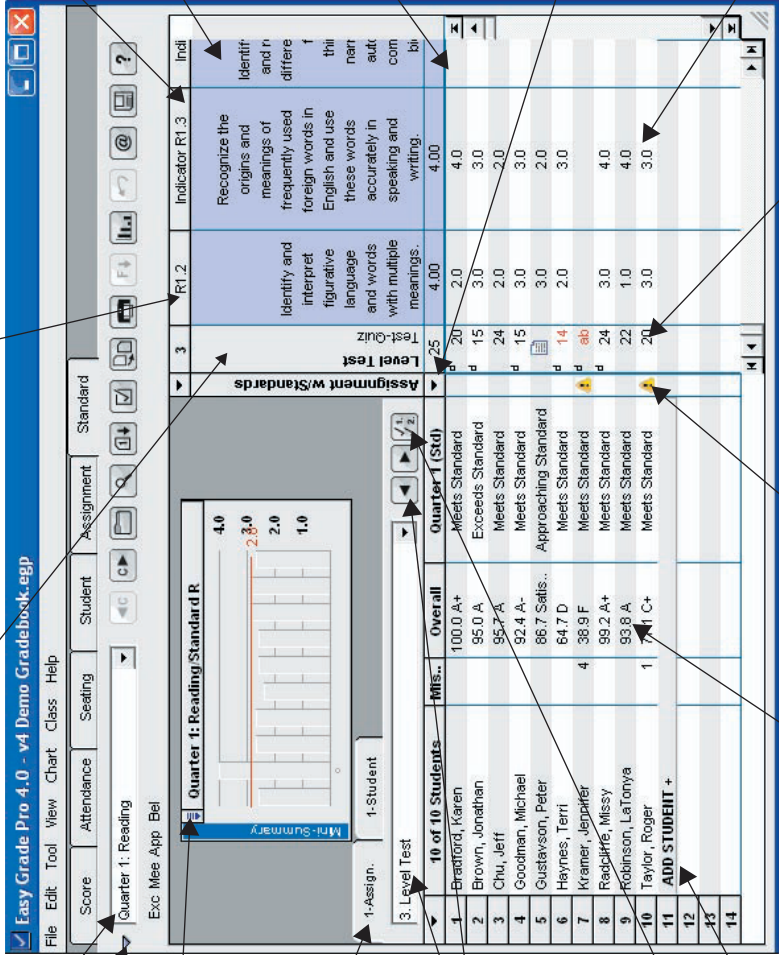
Viewing Summaries
To view the summary for an assignment or standard, double-click on its column number.

Standard IDs
The column titles display the standard IDs. The standard text is displayed below.

Standard Colors
The color indicates the standard's level, which is set in the Record window.

Title Height
To change the height of the assignment titles, press on this line and drag up or down.

Score Filters
To set the display of standard scores on numbers or rubric labels, press on this menu.



QuickReference:The 1-StudentStandard Chart

Switching Classes
Use this to switch to any class in a gradebook.

Rubric Clicks
To show/hide the row of rubric labels, click here.

Mini Summary
To switch between views, click here.

Switching Students
To view a specific student, click here or on the two arrow buttons.

Filtering Standards
To show some or all of the standards, press here.

Viewing Records
Double-click on a standard's text to view the record for a standard.

Viewing Summaries
Double-click a row number to view a summary of any standard.

Filtering Assignments
To view just certain assignment columns, press on this filter menu.

Linking Standards to Assignments
To link a standard to an assignment, double-click on its title.

Viewing Summaries
To view the summary for an assignment, double-click on its column number.

Locking Standards
This indicates a locked standard grade. Click in these boxes to lock or unlock standard grades.

Title Height
To change the height of the assignment titles, press on this line and drag up or down.

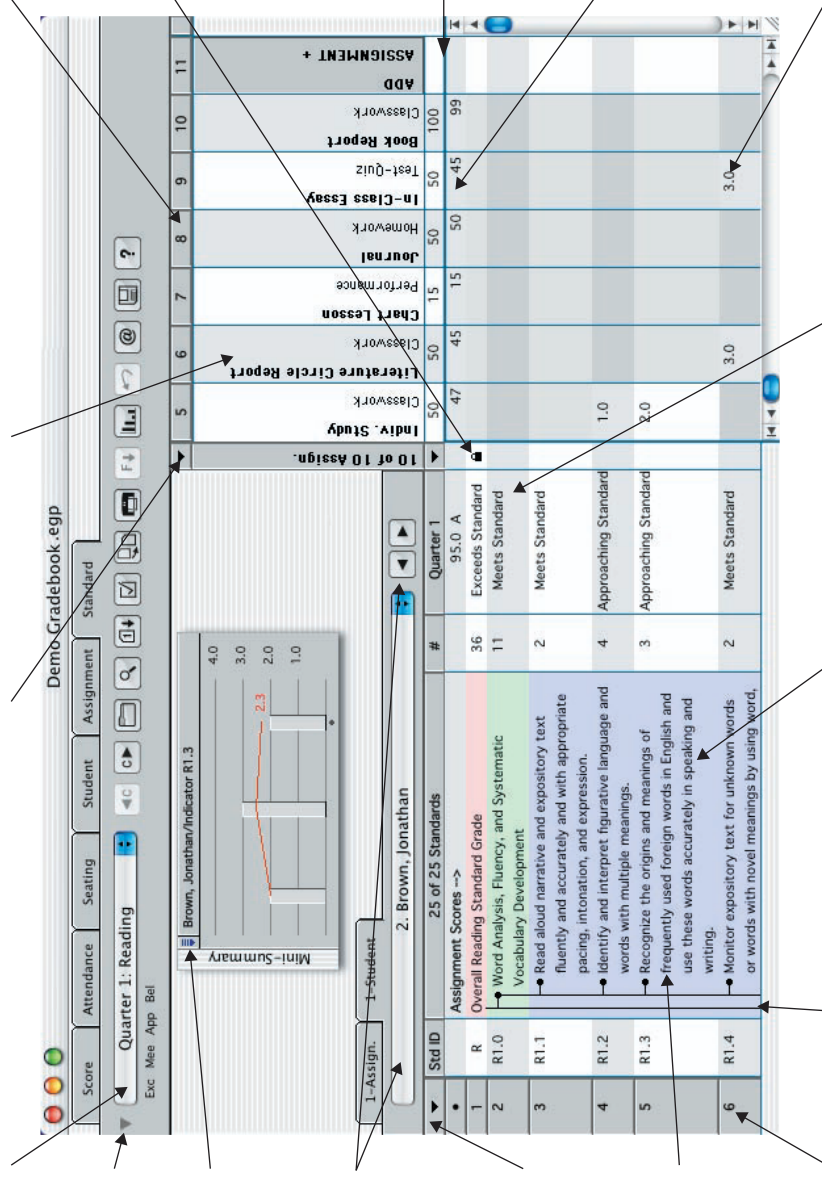
Traditional Scores
Enter traditional (percent-based) assignment scores in this row. Double-click to enter notes.

Standard Scores
You can enter scores only for standards that have been linked to the assignment in this column.

Sorting Standards
Press and drag up or down to relocate a standard. The hierarchy will be preserved.

Standard Colors and Link Lines
The colors and lines indicate the hierarchy and level of the standards. Double-click and press on the Level menu to set options.

Automatic Grades
A standard with standards below that are linked to it cannot be scored. They are graded automatically.

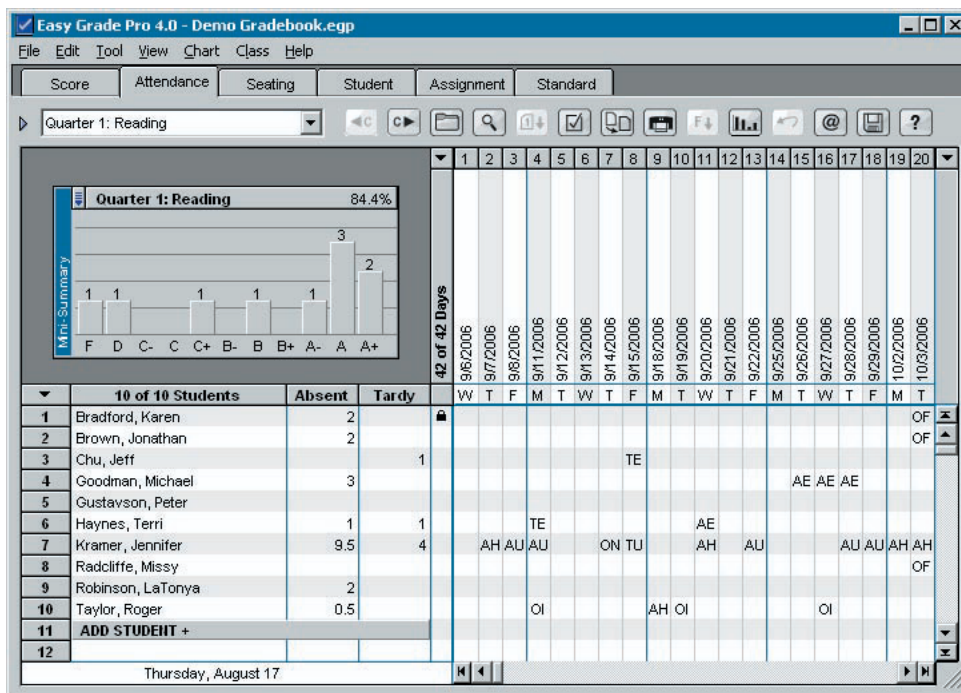


8

Although the score and standard charts are the most comprehensive of the six charts, the attendance, seating, student and assignment charts share many of its tools and offer a variety of new ones to help you manage your student data. This chapter describes the unique features of these charts. Be sure to refer to Chapter 6, *Using the Score Chart* for explanation of tools shared by the charts. To view any chart, use the items in the Chart menu.

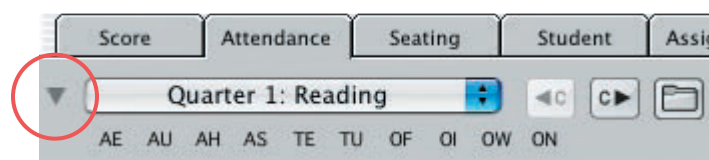
TheAttendanceChart

The attendance chart allows you to record attendance data for a single term.



To set the attendance chart:

- Attendance and calendar options must be set before using the attendance chart. Color options may also be set for your attendance categories. Refer to Chapter 4, *Setting Options* for help with this.
- Each column of the chart represents a single date in the calendar for the class. Column numbers indicate the day numbers into the term. No-school days are grayed and cannot be selected.
- To filter the dates displayed in the chart, use the menu to the left of the first column number. You can choose between showing all days, the current day, current week, current month or a selected range of dates. If the current day, week or month is selected, the actual dates will automatically change at the right times.
- To quickly hide all dates but one, click on the date. When only one date is visible, use the horizontal scrollbar to scroll through all dates while keeping only a single date visible at a time. To return to the normal view, click the date again.
- To resize the space for the date titles, press and drag the thick, horizontal line below the titles up or down.
- Be sure to display the attendance codes on the toolbar. This lets you know what marks can be typed and allows you to enter marks by clicking. To display these codes, press on the small triangle to the left of the class menu.



Click on the triangle (circled above) to show the row of attendance marks.

- To add a note to an attendance mark, double-click on a cell to open the student note view of the Summaries window. You may find it helpful to press on the Clipboard tool in this window and choose *Attendance Note ([Date:MO/DY/YEAR])*. This text will be pasted into the text field with the actual date.
- Attendance can be exported over your school's network. Refer to the section *Exporting Attendance* on page 114 for information on this.
- To print the attendance chart, choose Print from the File menu. Under the Chart tab, select and print the Attendance Chart report.
- To combine attendance data from multiple terms, refer to *Working with Terms* starting on page 81.

The Seating Chart

You can set up a seating chart to match your classroom, furniture included. Once set up, attendance marks and assignment scores can be entered directly into the seats.

To set up a seating chart:

- To set the shape, size, name format and attendance/assignment format of all seats in a class, use the Seat options in the Class Options window. Refer to page 30 for help.
- The first time the seating chart is viewed for a class, EasyGrade Pro places the first 128 students into

seats using a built-in arrangement.

- To move any seat, press and drag it to the desired location. To move a group of seats, first select the seats by clicking on each while holding down the shift key or drag a rectangle that encloses or touches the seats. To move the group, press on one and drag. To deselect all selected seats, click on any empty place.
- To swap two students, drag the first seat on top of the other. If one seat is rotated and the other is not, be sure to drag the upper-left corner of the first seat to the upper-left corner of the second. Swapping also works on groups of seats.
- To set the color, rotation or locked status of an individual seat, double-click on the seat. A seat that is locked cannot be moved or sorted.
- To sort your students into the seats, choose Sort Seats from the View menu and select one of the patterns. To randomize your students, click the Sort tool  or choose Randomly from the View menu.
- To add furniture, choose Add Furniture from the Tool menu or click the Add Furniture tool . If this tool is not visible, press on any tool or empty tool location and hold the mouse down for at least a second. From the menu that pops up, choose the tool.
- To change the size of a piece of furniture, drag the small rectangle in the lower corner. To set the format, rotation or name, double-click on the item. The Furniture Options window will open.
- Furniture can be copied and pasted using Copy and Paste in the Edit menu. To delete an item, select it and click the Delete tool  or press the delete key.
- The structure of a seating chart and its furniture can be copied to and from other classes. Choose Copy Seats from the Tool menu and follow the prompts. When furniture is copied from one class to another, it always replaces any furniture that the class may already have.
- To print the seating chart, choose Print from the File menu. Under the Chart tab, select and print the Seating Chart report.

To take attendance using the seating chart:

- Attendance and calendar options must be set before using the attendance chart. Refer to pages 28 for help with setting Attendance options and page 29 for help with setting Calendar options. In addition, seat options must be set to allow the entry of attendance marks. See page 30 for help with this.
- The current date, if it is within the calendar for the class, will be displayed in the lower-left corner of the window. Use the '+' and '-' buttons to switch to other dates. If the date is not the current date, it will be displayed in red.
- To record attendance, press on the menu in the seat and select a mark, or select one or more seats and click on an attendance code on the toolbar.
- Attendance can be exported over your school's network. Refer to the section *Exporting Attendance* on page 114 for information on this.

To enter assignment scores using the seating chart:

- Seat options must be set to allow the entry of assignment scores. See page 30 for help with this.

QuickReference:The SeatingChart

Switching Classes

Use this to switch to any class in a gradebook.

Grade Clicks

To show/hide the row of grades, click here.

Furniture

To add a piece of furniture, choose Add Furniture from the Tool menu.

Setting Attendance

To enter attendance data, click on the arrow on a seat and choose the code.

Entering Scores

To enter a score, click here and type or click on a grade button above.

Switching Seats

Use the arrow keys to switch the selection from one seat to the next.

Score Notes

Double-click to type a score note. Right-click (Win) or ctrl-click (Mac) to select a footnote.

Format Options

Double-click on any piece of furniture to set the title, shape, color, and rotation.

Seat Options

To open a window where the format and function of all seats can be set, click the Class Options tool.

Copying a Chart

To copy a chart from another class, click the Copy Class Data tool.

Selecting Items

You can select seats and furniture by clicking, by shift-clicking, or by dragging a rectangle around a group of items.

Editing Furniture

To edit selected furniture, choose Cut, Copy, Paste, or Clear from the Edit menu.

Resizing Furniture

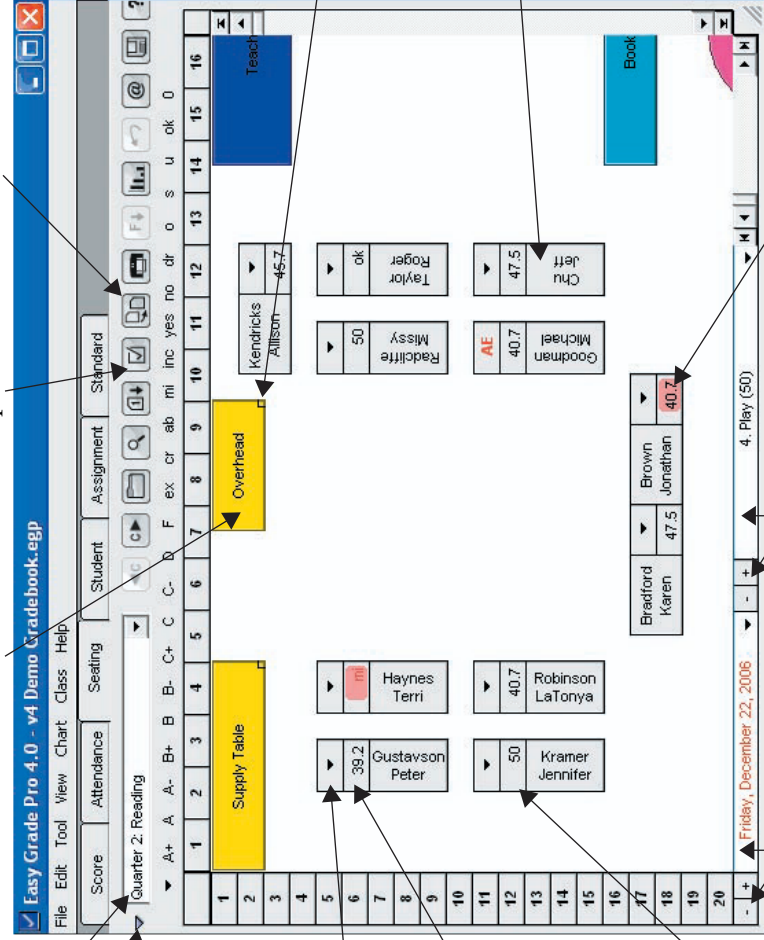
To resize a piece of furniture, drag the small box in the lower-right region.

Swapping Seats

To swap two seats (or a group of seats), drag the first seat to the top-left corner of the second seat.

Rotate Seat

Use the Rotate Seat tool to rotate all selected seats or pieces of furniture 90° clockwise.



- To select an assignment for scoring, press on the menu at the bottom of the seating chart. Use the '+' and '-' buttons to switch to other assignments.
- To enter a score, first click on the score cell in the seat. Enter the score by typing or grade-clicking.
- Use the arrow keys to move to other seats.
- Use the Continuous Search Mode of the Find tool to instantly jump to the right student. See page 49 for help with this.
- To enter a score note, double-click on the score cell. To enter a footnote, right-click (Windows) or ctrl-click (Macintosh) on the seat.

The Student and Assignment Charts

The student and assignment charts have a lot in common with the Records window: both display virtually the same information. While the Records window displays one record at a time, the charts can display all records together making them easier to view and manipulate. The charts also offer a variety of tools not available in the Records window such as fill down, copy, paste, find and filters.

	10 of 10 Students	ID	M/F	Status	Language	Grade Scale	Password
1	Bradford, Karen	4335	F	Active	English	Standard Scale	password
2	Brown, Jonathan	4987	M	Active	English	Standard Scale	password
3	Chu, Jeff	4988	M	Active	English	Standard Scale	password
4	Goodman, Michael	4122	M	Active	English	Standard Scale	password
5	Gustavson, Peter	4188	M	Active	English	OSU Scale	password
6	Haynes, Terri	4557	F	Active	English	Standard Scale	password
7	Kramer, Jennifer	4155	F	Active	English	Standard Scale	password
8	Radcliffe, Missy	4133	F	Active	English	Standard Scale	password
9	Robinson, LaTonya	4156	F	Active	English	Standard Scale	password
10	Taylor, Roger	4123	M	Active	English	Standard Scale	password
11	ADD STUDENT +						
12							
13							
14							
15							
16							
17							
18							
19							
20							
21							
22							
23							

To use the student and assignment charts:

- The columns in these charts correspond to the fields in the Records window.
- Data can be entered into any cell except in the first column with names. Many of the fields bring up menus when selected.
- To change the order of the columns, press on a column's title and drag the column left or right to the desired location.
- To change the width of a column, move the cursor until it is over the vertical line to the right of a col-

umntitle. Press on the line and drag the line to the desired location.

- To view the record for any row, double-click on the row.
- To rename any of the twelve custom field columns in the student chart, double-click on the row and edit the Custom Labels.
- As with the score chart, you can use filters, dragging of rows, find, fill down, and cut, copy and paste on rows and columns.
- The last six columns of the student chart can be used to enter comment numbers. Although it is easy to enter student comments in the Summaries window, the student chart can be used to view and edit groups of comments.

9 Making and Managing Backups

Why you should have a Backup Plan

Anyone who has used a computer for long knows that computers are susceptible to all sorts of problems: software conflicts, corrupted memory, damaged disks, network glitches, hardware breakdowns, user errors and more. Problems may be inevitable but their damaging effects can be minimized if one has a good backup plan in place and it is followed without exception.

Many computer users maintain only a single backup copy. This is risky behavior! If the backup is stored on the same computer as the original, both files could be lost if the hard drive crashes or the computer is stolen. Even if the backup is stored apart from the original, there could be problems if the backup was made after an undetected problem occurred.

If you have responsibility for reporting student data to others, there will be times during the year in which you must have access to your EasyGrade Pro data. Imagine a problem occurring during one of those times... if you follow a good backup plan, the solution will be painless.

In the next section, we present a plan for making and managing backup of your gradebook data. You are strongly encouraged to follow this plan or some other comprehensive plan for securing your gradebook data.

A Two-part Plan for Securing your Student Data

For greatest security it is best to make backup of your student data in different ways and at different locations. Here is a two-part plan that might work for you:

- **Part 1: Daily Backups.** EasyGrade Pro makes this part easy because it can be set up to make automatic backup of your gradebook to the volume of your choice using filenames that are automatically created and that change from day to day to ensure that you have multiple backups. Be sure to see *Backup Options* on page 34 for help with setting up EasyGrade Pro's automatic backup options.
- **Part 2: Bi-Weekly Archived Backups or Printed Reports.** Get a box of CD-Rs or other removable media. Once a week, save a copy of your gradebook to a disk and store it at a different site. Do not erase a backup

until after the school year has ended. Or print score and attendance chart reports for each current class on a biweekly basis. Store these away from your archived backups.

How to Make a Backup

We recommend that you take advantage of EasyGradePro's automatic backup option explained on page 34. You can also make a backup copy of your gradebook manually. Here's how:

1 Choose **Save Copy** from the **File** menu or select the **Save Copy** tool



2 In the window that opens, set the name of the backup. The default backup name is *Copy of 'gradebook name'* (on Windows) or *'gradebook name' copy* (on Macintosh).

3 Set the location for the backup to a folder created for backups or some other location set aside for your backups.

4 Click the **Save** button.

FAQ: My gradebook's name is 'Copy of copy of...'. What is going on?

*If you have a gradebook with a 'Copy of copy of...' in its name, it means you are opening and using your backup copies instead of your main gradebook. A backup copy of a gradebook is like an insurance policy--it's something that you hope you never have to use. Don't get your gradebook and its backup copies confused, and don't work on a backup of your gradebook unless there is a good reason. For more information on this, see **FAQ: EasyGradePro saves automatically. What does this mean?** on page 20.*

10 Working at Home and School

If you would like to use your EasyGrade Pro gradebook on computers at both school and home, this chapter is for you. It explains how to transfer your gradebook from one computer to another using a USB flash drive, even if the computers are of different platforms (Macintosh and Windows).

Using an EasyGrade Pro gradebook at two locations is similar to using a paper gradebook at two locations: in both cases, you have to move the gradebook back and forth. There is, however, a fundamental difference that can cause problems if you're not careful. When transferring an EasyGrade Pro gradebook using, you'll be leaving behind a copy so that both computers have identical gradebooks at first. Once you make changes to one of the gradebooks, it becomes your *current* one, turning the other into nothing more than a recent backup. Be careful to work only with the *current* gradebook and to transfer it before working at a different location. Otherwise, you may find yourself with two gradebooks in which neither is current, forcing you to retype data into one of them.

You may be tempted to use your gradebook directly from a USB flash drive to avoid this problem. We don't recommend this because flash drives are slower than hard drives. Also, if you accidentally pull out the flash drive too early, you risk damaging your gradebook.

Getting Started

1 Make sure that you have EasyGrade Pro installed on both computers and that they have the same version number (i.e. v4.0). To find the version, choose About EasyGrade Pro from the EasyGrade Pro (Macintosh) or Help (Windows) menu.

2 If your gradebook is on a Windows computer, we recommend that you move it to the Desktop or some other convenient location so that you'll have easy access to it. To move it, press on its icon and drag. If you don't know where your gradebook's icon is, try looking at this path: C:\Program Files\Orbis Software\EasyGrade Pro. Its name ends with '.egp'.

3 It is important that the gradebook's name ends with the four characters '.egp'. By default, an EasyGrade Pro gradebook will end with this extension even if the extension is not visible.

Using a USB Flash Drive to Transfer a Gradebook

1 Insert a flash drive into the USB port of your computer.

2 Copy the gradebook to the flash disk. **Windows:** Right-click on the gradebook's icon and choose Copy. Right-click on the icon of the flash drive and choose Paste. **Macintosh:** Drag the gradebook's icon to the icon of the flash drive.

3 Eject the flash drive following the instructions for that came with it. Don't just pull it out or you will likely damage the drive or its files. Insert it into the other computer's USB port.

4 Copy the gradebook from the flash drive. **Windows:** Double-click on the flash drive's icon to open a window to it. Right-click on the gradebook's icon and choose Copy. Right-click on the folder on the hard drive to receive the gradebook or right-click on an empty place on the Desktop and choose Paste. **Macintosh:** Double-click on the icon of the flash drive. Drag the icon of the gradebook to the folder on the hard drive to receive the gradebook.

5 Eject the flash drive as before.

6 To start your gradebook, double-click on its icon. This will ensure that you are opening the right gradebook.

Working Cross-Platform

EasyGrade Pro 4.0 for Macintosh and for Windows can share gradebooks easily and seamlessly. Nearly all program features are identical but there are a few platform-specific differences that you should be aware of as follows:

- Different characters are found in fonts. Some characters on the Macintosh, such as the checkmark, are not available in Windows and vice versa.
- Menu item terminology and keyboard keys have some platform-specific differences.
- Macintosh printer typically allows scaling to enlarge or shrink printed reports. Since fewer Windows printers offer this, you will likely need to adjust font size to enlarge or shrink printed reports.

11 Working with Terms

If you teach a class that continues with the same students from one term to the next, then this chapter is for you. It explains the simple process of starting a new term for an existing class in your gradebook. It also explains the more complex process of combining student grades and attendance data from classes in different terms to produce multi-term totals.

If you need to add a new class to your gradebook--*new* meaning a class with new students or new course-section numbers--you don't need this chapter. Instead, take a look at the section *To add a class* on page 20.

Starting a New Term

Although you can start a new term at any time, we recommend that you wait until the end of a term to do so. This will help minimize the number of changes that may need to be made to your roster, seating chart and options in the new term.

To start a new term for a class:

- 1 Switch to the class.
- 2 From the Tool menu, choose Term Tools->Start New Term. Easy Grade Pro will automatically put a checkmark for the appropriate term in the Records window for the class. It will then switch to the new term and copy the students to it.
- 3 To set the calendar or edit other class options, click the View/Edit Class Options button in the window that automatically appears.

To edit the term label for a term:

- 1 Choose Records from the Chart menu or click the Record stool
- 2 Select the Classes tab.
- 3 Edit the name of the term. This change applies to all classes in a gradebook.



To add the Prior Term and Next Term tools to the toolbar:

These tools can make it easier to switch back and forth between terms.

1 Press on any tool or empty tool location and hold the mouse down for at least a second. From the menu that pops up, choose the Prior Term tool



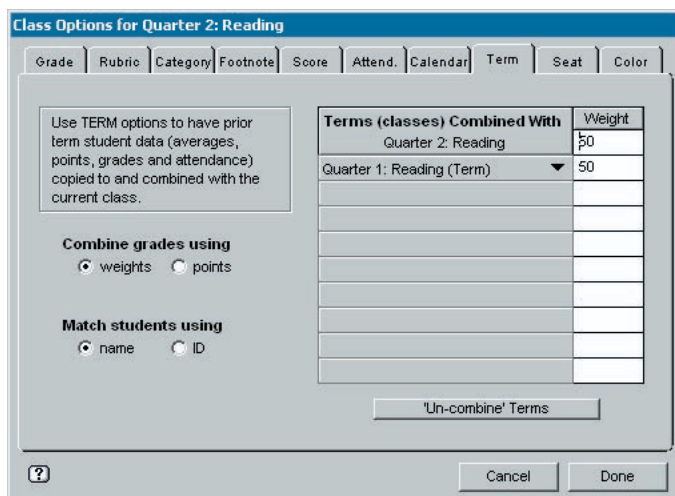
2 Repeat the process to add the Next Term tool



3 To relocate any tool, press and drag (quickly) the tool to the desired location.

Combining Terms (Class Options: Term)

At any time, you can combine your students' grade and attendance data from two or more terms to produce multi-term totals. Once combined, you can view summaries and print reports that include the totals and individual term data.



To set or edit term options:

1 Switch to a class in your current term.

2 Choose Term Tools->Combine Terms from the Tool menu. The Term view of the Class Options window will open (shown above).

3 You must decide to combine your term data using weights or points. Select *weights* if you want each term to have a set value. Don't use this method unless you are at or near the end of the current term because temporary grade distortions can occur when the current term has only a few assignments. Select *points* if you want the terms to be combined by summing all the points that a student has earned. This option is not available if any of the classes being combined uses category weighting.

4 Choose to match the students across classes by ID or name. Each student's ID number or name must be completely identical in all terms.

5 Carefully select the prior-term classes by pressing on one or more menus below the name of the current class. When selecting classes, you must choose between combining the term or the overall grade. In most cases, you should choose *Term*. However, if one of the classes you are combining has term options set in it, you may want to choose *Overall* instead.

Here is an example to explain the difference between *Term* and *Overall*. Let's say your gradebook has five terms as follows: Quarter 1, Quarter 2, Quarter 3, Quarter 4 and Year. In the Quarter 2 class, you combine *Term* grades from Quarters 1 and 2. In the Quarter 4 class, you combine *Term* grades from Quarters 3 and 4. In the Year class, you could combine *Term* grades from Quarters 1, 2, 3 and 4 but you could, instead, combine *Overall* grades from Quarters 2 and 4.

6 If you have selected *Combine grades using weights*, enter the term weights in the *Weights* column. They must sum to 100%.

7 Click *Done*. EasyGradePro will go to each of the prior-term classes and try to match the students. Whenever a match is found, the student's points, grade and attendance totals for that term are copied to and combined with the current class. A window will appear listing any students that could not be found in prior terms.

Questions about Combining Terms

What do I do when a student didn't match when combining terms but should have?

In most cases, the problem occurs because the student's name or ID number in the prior-term class is different. Correct this and return to the current class; from the current-term class, choose *Term Tools* -> *Recombine Terms* from the *Tool* menu. EasyGradePro will start the process over and, again, let you know who hasn't matched.

How often do I need to combine terms? How do I recombine terms?

Generally, you will combine terms only once for a class. However, if you make any changes to grades or attendance data in any of the prior-term classes, you should recombine the terms to copy the updated data into your current term. To recombine the data, choose *Term Tools* -> *Recombine Terms* from the *Tool* menu.

How do I un-combine terms?

You may occasionally want to combine terms just long enough to print certain reports. To later un-combine terms, choose *Term Tools* -> *Combine Terms* from the *Tools* menu. Click the '*Un-combine*' *Terms* button. When you exit from this window, your class will be un-combined.

How is a class changed by using combine term options?

After combining, the *Overall* grades and attendance totals found in charts, in summaries and in reports reflect all combined terms. Many reports and summaries will display multi-term data automatically or as an option. In the score and attendance charts, special columns can be added to display data from individual terms. (See page 57 for information on adding special data columns.)

FAQ: I've combined terms but the prior-term grades or attendance data in reports are wrong. How do I fix this?

This problem occurs if you change grades or attendance marks in a prior-term class after you've combined its data with your current-term class. To fix this, choose **Term Tools** -> **Recombine Terms** from the **Tool** menu. This will copy the changed data to your current-term class.

FAQ: I need to print reports that show grades from multiple terms but I don't want the grades to be combined to form a multi-term overall grade. What do I do?

Choose **Term Tools** -> **Combine Terms** from the **Tool** menu. In the **Term** view of the **Class Options** window, combine your terms using weights, but set the term weights to 100% for the current term class and 0% for all the prior-term classes.

FAQ: I have to include a weighted final exam. What do I do?

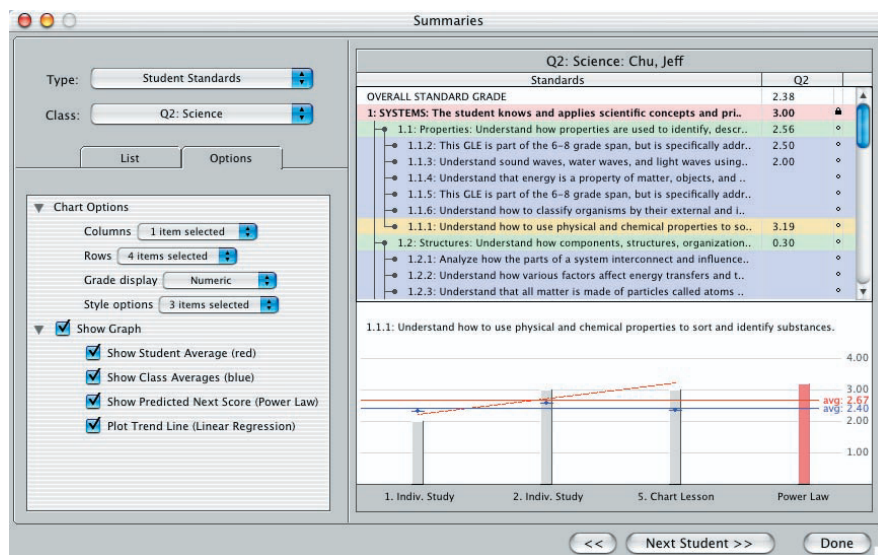
When a final exam must be weighted with one or more other terms, the final exam should be treated in the same way as the other terms. As an example, you might set up your terms in the **Records** window as follows: **Semester 1**, **Semester 2** and **Final Exam**. Your **Final Exam** will actually be a separate class within your gradebook. From within the **Final Exam Class**, you might set the combine term options as follows: **Semester 1**-40%, **Semester 2**-40% and **Final Exam**-20%. The overall grades will be found in the **Final Exam Class**.

12 Using Summaries

EasyGradePro provides two powerful tools for analysis of student performance: the Summaries window and the Mini-Summary window. This chapter explains how to utilize both of these tools.

Opening the Summaries Window

The Summaries window can be a tremendous aid in your efforts to identify and meet the needs of your students. Its multiple views with graphs, charts, calendars, notes and comments can help you understand your students' strengths, weaknesses and changes in performance over time. The Summaries window also is the place to go to curfew or lock a student's overall grade, to lock in a standard grade, to enter notes about a class or a student and to enter report card comments.



To open the Summaries window, do one of the following:

- Select Summaries from the Chart menu.

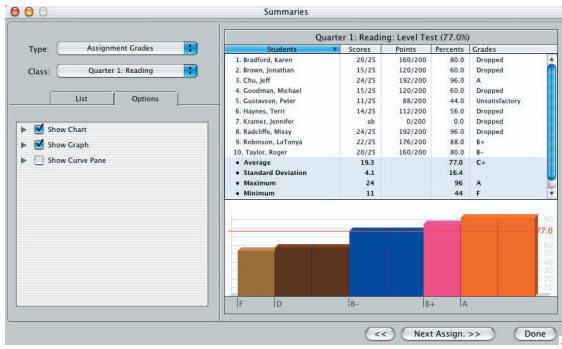
- Click the Summaries tool . To view the summary of a specific student or assignment, select the item first and then click this tool.
- Double-click a row or column number in any chart (except the seating chart).
- Right-click (Windows) or control-click (Macintosh) on a student or assignment name and choose View Summary from the menu that pops up.

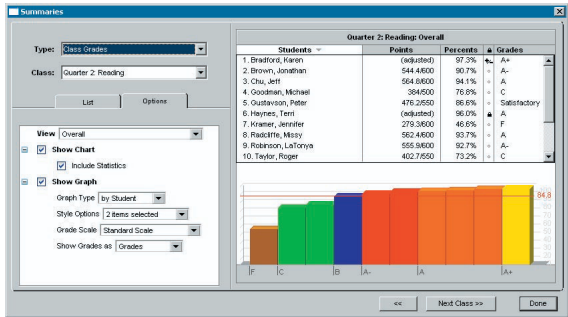
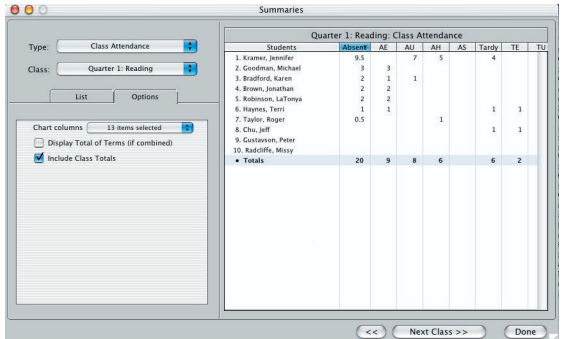
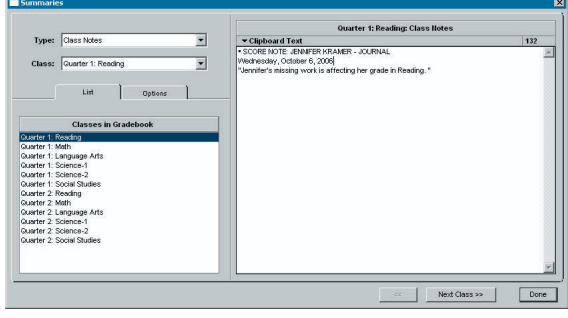
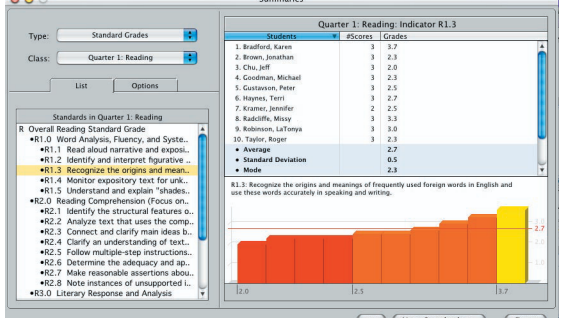
Using the Summaries Window

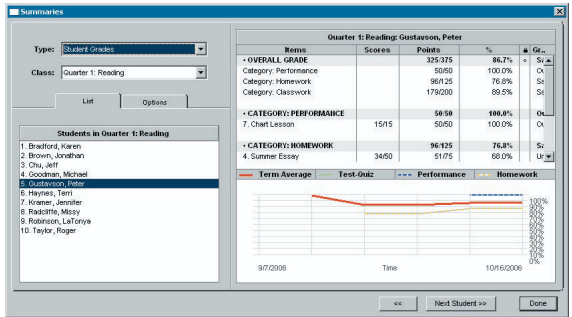
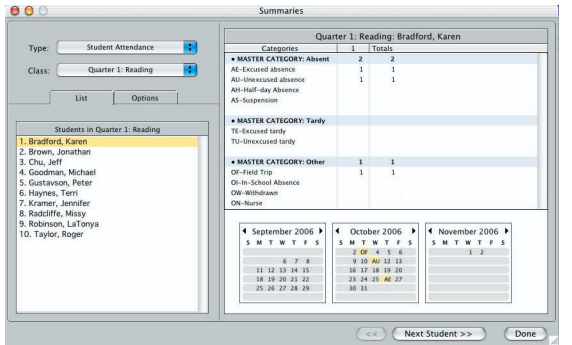
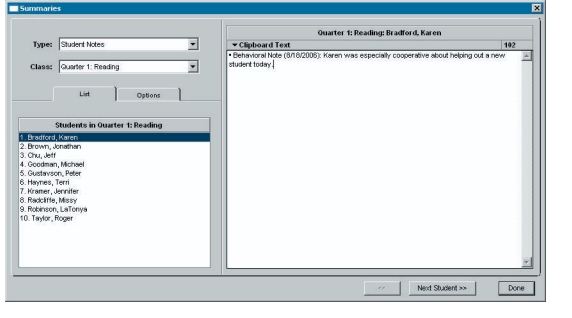
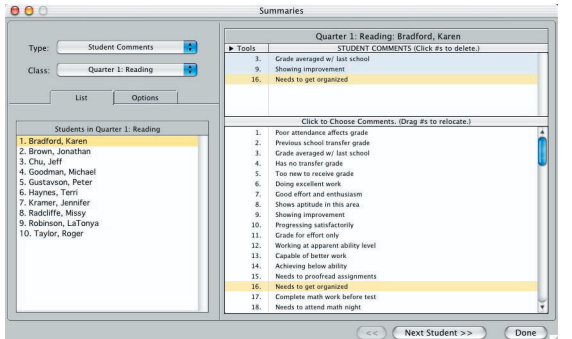
- Use the Type menu at the top-left corner of the window to choose among the different types of summaries.
- Use the Class menu to switch to any class in any term. Since you can freely switch classes, this is very useful when comparing performance across sections of the same course and across terms of the same class.
- Depending on the type of summary being viewed, the list under the List tab will display students, assignments, standards or classes. Use this list to switch to the desired item.
- A variety of options can be found under the Options tab that allow you to control the display and function of the summary.
- In some of the lists, there are small circles in narrow columns. Pressing on these circles brings up menus that allow the locking, curving or unlocking of overall and standard grades.
- In some of the lists, there are column titles with small arrows. These indicate that you can click on the title and on other titles in the list to sort the column either up or down. The arrow indicates the direction of sorting.

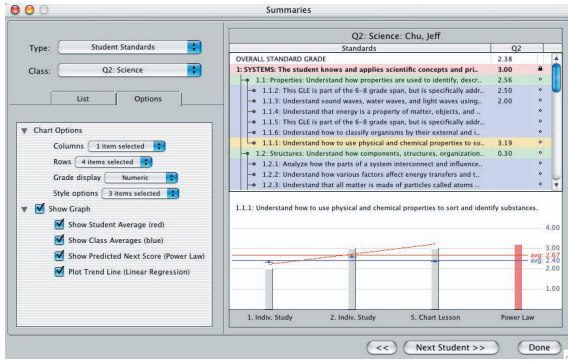
Types of Summaries

There are ten different views and each has its own uses as the following chart illustrates.

Summary Type	Uses	
Assignment Grades	• View lists of student performance on any assignments sorted by name or grade. • View statistics. • View bargraphs by grade or student with color and other options. • Curve the assignment. See page 54 for information on using the Summaries window to curve an assignment.	

SummaryType	Uses	
ClassGrades	- Viewlistsofstudentperformance overalloronany category. - Viewstatistics. - Viewbargraphsbygradeorstu- dentwithcolorandotheroptions. - Lockorcurveanystudent'sover- allgrade.(Pressingonthesmall circles.)Seepage55forinforma- tiononusingtheSummarieswin- dowtolockorcurveastudent's overallgrade.	
Class Attendance	- Viewlistsofstudentswithtotals onselectedattendancecategories. - Sortthelistsbyanyattendance category. - Getclasstotals.	
ClassNotes	- Recordallkindsofnotesabout anyclass. - Spell-check.Useclipboardtext optionstoinsertstoredtext.See <i>GradebookOptions:ClipboardText</i> onpage37formoreinformation.	
Standard Grades	- Viewlistsofstudentperformance onanystandardsortedbyrubric gradeandthenumberoftotal scores. - Viewstatistics. - Viewbargraphsbygradeorstu- dentwithcolorandotheroptions.	

SummaryType	Uses	
Student Grades	- Viewslistsofstudentscoresbrokendownbyterm,categoryand assignment. - Lockastudent'soverallgrade. (Pressonthesmallcircle.) - Viewlinegraphsthatshowperformancevertime. - Verifythecalculations.	
Student Attendance	- Viewlistsofstudentattendance totalsbrokendownbyterm. - Viewcalendarsthatdisplaya student'sattendance marksby date.	
StudentNotes	- Recordallkindsofnotesabout anystudent. - Spell-check.Useclipboardtext optionstoinsertstoredtextwith variables. - Thesenotescanbeincludedin studentprogressreportsthatare printed,postedonlineoremailed.	
Student Comments	- Setupamasterlistofupto100 comments.Sortthecomments andexportthelistasapluginfile tobedistributedtoothers.See<i>UsingPlug-in</i>onpage118. - Selectuptosixcommentsper student. - Usetoolstohavecommentsauto-selectedforstudentsbasedon user-definedrules. - Copycommentsfromtheprior term. - Thesecommentscanbeincluded instudentprogressreportsthatareprinted,postedonlineor emailed.	

SummaryType	Uses	
Student Standards	- View list of student standard grades with a variety of options. - Manually lock in a grade for any standard or override any calculated grade. (Press on the small circles.) - View graphs of performance on any standard with a variety of options.	

FAQ: How can I check the calculations for one of my students?

The Summaries window can help you check all the calculations that go into computing the overall grade for a student. To open this window, double-click on the student's row number and select Student Grades from the Type menu. Under the Option tab, turn on the Show Chart option. For a related topic, see FAQ: How is a student's overall grade calculated? on page 51.

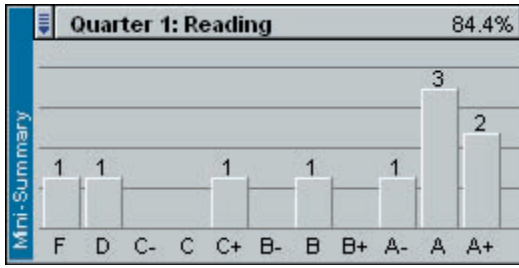
Using the Mini-Summaries Window

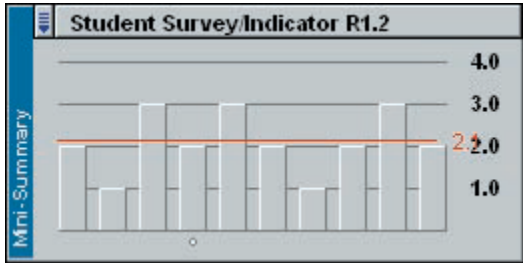
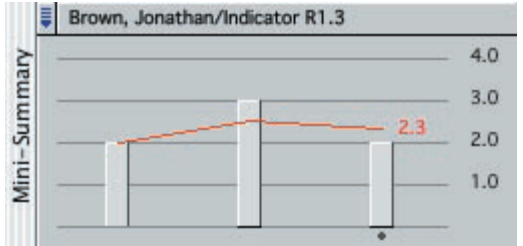
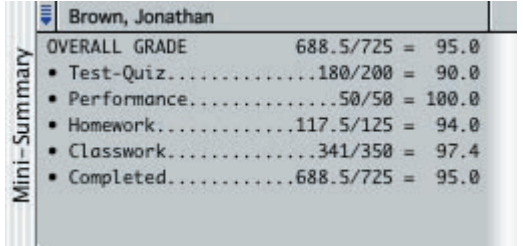
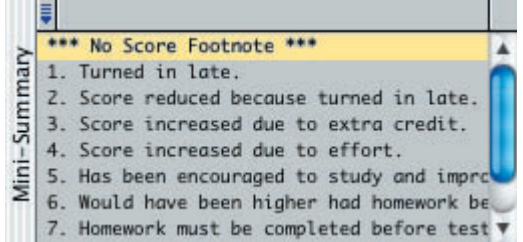
The Mini-Summary window can display graphs and lists while you are working in any of the charts. It can also be used to attach footnotes to scores and show score notes in the score chart.

To make the Mini-Summary window visible:

- 1 Choose Gradebook Options from the Edit menu.
- 2 Select the General tab.
- 3 Open the Tool Options section.
- 4 Turn on the Show Mini-Summary option.

Use the small blue button near the top-left corner of the mini-summary window to choose among the different types of summaries. There are six different views as this chart explains:

SummaryType	Uses	
Class Graph	View a class bar graph with class average change as percents-based and standards-based scores are entered.	

SummaryType	Uses	
AssignmentGraph	View a bar graph with class average change as percents-based and standards-based scores are entered.	
StudentGraph	- View a line/bar graph with student performance over time. - Automatically switches between percents-based and standards-based views.	
StudentGrades	View a list of student totals.	
ScoreFootnotes	Apply score footnotes to one or more selected scores by clicking on a footnote in the Mini-Summary.	
ScoreText	View the score note for any selected score.	

13 Printing Reports

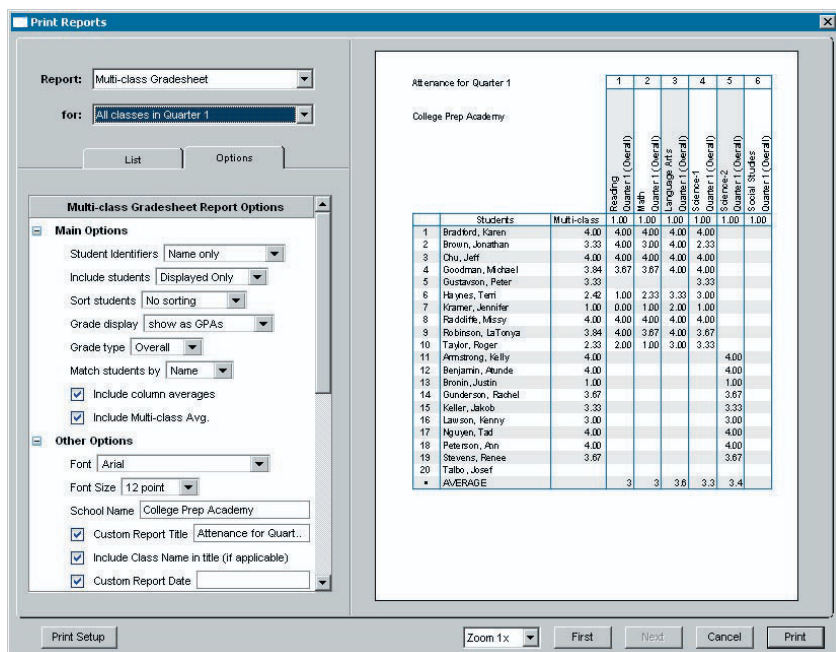
EasyGradePro offers numerous comprehensive reports. Regardless of the report, you'll follow the same steps when printing: open the Print Reports window, select the report, set options while viewing a preview of the report and then print. This chapter begins by explaining this process in general. It then describes each of the reports.

Using the Print Window

1 Choose Print from the File menu or click the Print tool



The Print Reports window will open



2 Choose a report from the Reports menu near the top. Notice that a preview of the report, based on the current set of options, will appear.

3 To set the range of the reports, press on the *formenu* (below the *Report menu*). You can choose to print reports for one class, for all classes in the current term or for selected classes, students or assignments. If the choose the last item, then click on the *List* tab and select one or more items from the list. Depending on the report selected, the list will display students, assignments, or classes. To select multiple items, hold down the shift, ctrl (Windows) or command (Macintosh) key while clicking.

4 To set the options for the reports, click on the *Option* tab and make your selections. The report preview will be automatically updated as you make your selections.

5 To change the size of the preview, press on the menu below the preview and choose *Fit To Window*, *Zoom 1x*, *Zoom 1.5x* or *Zoom 2x*. The *Fit To Window* view shows the entire page and the cursor is a magnifying glass. By clicking on any part of the page, the view automatically switches to the *Zoom 1x* view. In any of the zoomed views, the cursor appears as a hand. By pressing the mouse button, the page can be dragged about.

6 To change the orientation or paper type for the printed reports, click the *Print Setup* button in the lower left corner.

7 Select *Print* to begin printing. The *Print* window for your type of printer will open where you can set some final print options and begin printing.

FAQ: Where is ePrint?

If you are familiar with older versions of EasyGradePro, you may be wondering where the *ePrint* feature is. With *ePrint*, each report page could be saved as a separate file in PICT format (Macintosh) or BMP format (Windows) to be opened by virtually any graphics program. Now that EasyGradePro allows you to create HTML reports, *ePrint* has much less usefulness and EasyGradePro 4.0 no longer officially offers *ePrint*. However, it still can be found. Here's how: on a Windows computer, hold down the Ctrl (Windows) or option (Macintosh) key while clicking the *Print* button in the lower right corner of the *Print* window. Be sure to save the reports to an empty folder!

General Options for all Reports

Under the *Option* tab, you'll find a list of options for each report. The bottom set of options are titled *General Options for all Reports*. These options are shared by all reports and include:

- *Font Options*. Use this to set the font type and size. To maximize the amount of data that will fit on a page, set the font size to a small value.
- *School or Teacher name*. This will appear near the top of all reports.
- *Custom Report Title*. Use this option to change the name of any report (i.e. *Washington School Report Card*).
- *Custom Report Date*. Use this option to change the date that appears on a report in case you don't want the current date to appear. In fact, you can use this option to include any text, not just the date.
- *Print in color*. Most reports can be printed in color. Keep in mind that color printing typically costs more and takes longer.

FAQ: How can I maximize the columns on each page?

To maximize the number of columns that will fit on a page, use the Page/Print Setup option to set the orientation to landscape view (sideways) and the scale to between 60% and 80%. If your printer doesn't support scaling, set the font size to a small value.

FAQ: How do I print multiple reports per sheet of paper?

Many printers today allow you to choose the number of pages to be printed on each sheet of paper. They do this by shrinking each page the correct amount and placing the pages at different locations on the paper. These options are known as layout options and can be found in the print window that appears after you click the Print button.

FAQ: How do I change the teacher or school name that appears on reports?

Site license version: The school's name is entered into the program when it is first used. It can only be changed by reinstalling the program. The teacher's name can be changed in the Print Reports window. **Single-user license version:** The teacher's name is entered into the program when it is first used. It can only be changed by reinstalling the program. The school's name can be changed in the Print Reports window. Note: it is safer to reinstall EasyGradePro without losing any data as long as your gradebook is not named Demo Gradebook or Demo.egp.

Types of Reports

There are numerous reports and each has its own features as the following chart illustrates.

Report	Description	
Assignment Chart	- This report mirrors the onscreen Assignment chart. It includes assignment names and their record information (i.e. maximum score, points, date, category, etc.). - Options allow you to select the record items to be included in the report. - It can be used for archiving assignment record settings.	
Assignment Graphs	- This report includes bar graphs of students' grades on one or more assignments. - A variety of statistics can be included. - It can be used as a poster for classroom displays since student names are not included.	

Report	Description																																																																																																																																					
Assignment Summary	- This report includes ranked lists of students and their grades on one or more assignments. - It can be used as a poster for displaying grades on an assignment.	ASSIGNMENT SUMMARY - Quarter 1: Reading Name, Friday, August 18 1. Journal Intro. (9/7/06) avg:100.0% <table><thead><tr><th>#</th><th>Students</th><th>Scores</th><th>Grades</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>1</td><td>Bradford, Karen</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A+</td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td>Brown, Jonathan</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A+</td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td>Chu, Jeff</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A+</td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td>Goodman, Michael</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A+</td></tr><tr><td>5</td><td>Gustavson, Peter</td><td>40/50</td><td>80.0% Satisfactory</td></tr><tr><td>6</td><td>Haynes, Terri</td><td>mi</td><td>0.0% F</td></tr><tr><td>7</td><td>Fraser, Jennifer</td><td>mi</td><td>0.0% F</td></tr><tr><td>8</td><td>Rodcliffe, Missy</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A+</td></tr><tr><td>9</td><td>Robinson, LaTonya</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A+</td></tr><tr><td>10</td><td>Taylor, Roger</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A+</td></tr></tbody></table> 2. Student Survey (9/11/06) avg:80.0% <table><thead><tr><th>#</th><th>Students</th><th>Scores</th><th>Grades</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>1</td><td>Bradford, Karen</td><td>yes</td><td>100.0% A+</td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td>Brown, Jonathan</td><td>yes</td><td>100.0% A+</td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td>Chu, Jeff</td><td>yes</td><td>100.0% A+</td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td>Goodman, Michael</td><td>yes</td><td>100.0% A+</td></tr><tr><td>5</td><td>Gustavson, Peter</td><td>yes</td><td>100.0% Outstanding</td></tr><tr><td>6</td><td>Haynes, Terri</td><td>no</td><td>0.0% F</td></tr><tr><td>7</td><td>Fraser, Jennifer</td><td>no</td><td>0.0% F</td></tr><tr><td>8</td><td>Rodcliffe, Missy</td><td>yes</td><td>100.0% A+</td></tr><tr><td>9</td><td>Robinson, LaTonya</td><td>yes</td><td>100.0% A+</td></tr><tr><td>10</td><td>Taylor, Roger</td><td>yes</td><td>100.0% A+</td></tr></tbody></table>	#	Students	Scores	Grades	1	Bradford, Karen	50/50	100.0% A+	2	Brown, Jonathan	50/50	100.0% A+	3	Chu, Jeff	50/50	100.0% A+	4	Goodman, Michael	50/50	100.0% A+	5	Gustavson, Peter	40/50	80.0% Satisfactory	6	Haynes, Terri	mi	0.0% F	7	Fraser, Jennifer	mi	0.0% F	8	Rodcliffe, Missy	50/50	100.0% A+	9	Robinson, LaTonya	50/50	100.0% A+	10	Taylor, Roger	50/50	100.0% A+	#	Students	Scores	Grades	1	Bradford, Karen	yes	100.0% A+	2	Brown, Jonathan	yes	100.0% A+	3	Chu, Jeff	yes	100.0% A+	4	Goodman, Michael	yes	100.0% A+	5	Gustavson, Peter	yes	100.0% Outstanding	6	Haynes, Terri	no	0.0% F	7	Fraser, Jennifer	no	0.0% F	8	Rodcliffe, Missy	yes	100.0% A+	9	Robinson, LaTonya	yes	100.0% A+	10	Taylor, Roger	yes	100.0% A+																																												
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Class Graphs	- This report displays bar graphs of overall grades in one or more classes. - It can be used as a poster for classroom displays since student names are not included.	CLASS GRAPHS Name, Friday, August 18 Quarter 1: Reading (100.0%) Quarter 1: Math (100.0%) Quarter 1: Science (100.0%) Quarter 1: Social Studies (100.0%) Quarter 1: Language Arts (100.0%) Quarter 1: Physical Education (100.0%)																																																																																																																																				
Class Missing Work	- This report includes a very concise list of missing work in one or more classes. If you select multiple classes, the missing work will be combined across classes. - The missing work can be grouped by student or assignment. - Although it is meant for the teacher, it can be used as a poster or cut up and given to students.	CLASS MISSING WORK - Quarter 1: Social Studies Name, Friday, August 18 Missing Work for Fraser, Jennifer 8/18/06 <table><tbody><tr><td>Journal Intro. (m), 9/7/06, Classroom</td><td>Quarter 1: Reading</td></tr><tr><td>Level Test (ab), 9/14/06, Test-Quiz</td><td>Quarter 1: Reading</td></tr><tr><td>Indiv. Study (mc), 9/25/06, Classroom</td><td>Quarter 1: Reading</td></tr><tr><td>Journal (mc), 10/5/06, Homework</td><td>Quarter 1: Reading</td></tr><tr><td>Math Placement Test (mc), 9/10/06, Test-Quiz</td><td>Quarter 1: Math</td></tr><tr><td>Chapter 1-8 (1-13) (mc), 9/14/06, Homework</td><td>Quarter 1: Math</td></tr><tr><td>Creative Story #1 (ab), 9/10/06, Homework</td><td>Quarter 1: Language Arts</td></tr><tr><td>Plant Quiz (ab), 9/14/06, Test-Quiz</td><td>Quarter 1: Science-1</td></tr><tr><td>Animal Kingdom Worksheet (m), 10/1/06, Homework</td><td>Quarter 1: Science-1</td></tr><tr><td>Current Events Self-Study (ab), 9/10/06, Homework</td><td>Quarter 1: Social Studies</td></tr><tr><td>Lands of the World Quiz (ab), 9/25/06, Test-Quiz</td><td>Quarter 1: Social Studies</td></tr><tr><td>Lands Report (mc), 9/28/06, Homework</td><td>Quarter 1: Social Studies</td></tr><tr><td>Map Skills (m), 10/16/06, Map Skills</td><td>Quarter 1: Social Studies</td></tr></tbody></table> Missing Work for Taylor, Roger 8/18/06 <table><tbody><tr><td>Chart Lesson (mc), 10/1/06, Performance</td><td>Quarter 1: Reading</td></tr></tbody></table> Missing Work for Brown, Jonathan 8/18/06 <table><tbody><tr><td>Chapter 1-2 Review (mc), 10/1/06, Homework</td><td>Quarter 1: Math</td></tr><tr><td>Animals Quiz (mc), 10/9/06, Test-Quiz</td><td>Quarter 1: Science-1</td></tr></tbody></table> Missing Work for Brown, Justin 8/18/06 <table><tbody><tr><td>Plant Kingdom (m), 9/10/06, Classroom</td><td>Quarter 1: Science-2</td></tr><tr><td>Plant Quiz (mc), 9/14/06, Test-Quiz</td><td>Quarter 1: Science-2</td></tr></tbody></table>	Journal Intro. (m), 9/7/06, Classroom	Quarter 1: Reading	Level Test (ab), 9/14/06, Test-Quiz	Quarter 1: Reading	Indiv. Study (mc), 9/25/06, Classroom	Quarter 1: Reading	Journal (mc), 10/5/06, Homework	Quarter 1: Reading	Math Placement Test (mc), 9/10/06, Test-Quiz	Quarter 1: Math	Chapter 1-8 (1-13) (mc), 9/14/06, Homework	Quarter 1: Math	Creative Story #1 (ab), 9/10/06, Homework	Quarter 1: Language Arts	Plant Quiz (ab), 9/14/06, Test-Quiz	Quarter 1: Science-1	Animal Kingdom Worksheet (m), 10/1/06, Homework	Quarter 1: Science-1	Current Events Self-Study (ab), 9/10/06, Homework	Quarter 1: Social Studies	Lands of the World Quiz (ab), 9/25/06, Test-Quiz	Quarter 1: Social Studies	Lands Report (mc), 9/28/06, Homework	Quarter 1: Social Studies	Map Skills (m), 10/16/06, Map Skills	Quarter 1: Social Studies	Chart Lesson (mc), 10/1/06, Performance	Quarter 1: Reading	Chapter 1-2 Review (mc), 10/1/06, Homework	Quarter 1: Math	Animals Quiz (mc), 10/9/06, Test-Quiz	Quarter 1: Science-1	Plant Kingdom (m), 9/10/06, Classroom	Quarter 1: Science-2	Plant Quiz (mc), 9/14/06, Test-Quiz	Quarter 1: Science-2																																																																																																
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ScoreChart	- ThisreportmirrorstheonscreenScorechart. - Extrarowsandcolumnscanbeincluded. - Itcanbeusedforrecordingassignmentsandcoresonpaper,forreportingtermattendance to the office or for archiving score data.	
SeatingChart	- TheseatingchartreportmirrorstheonscreenSeatingchart. - Itcanbeusedforreference,takingpaperattendance,forlearningstudentnamesandfor substituteteachers.	
Standards Chart	- Thisreportdisplaysstandards,standard gradesandstandardscoresforallstudents. - Avarietyofstatisticscanbeincluded. - Itcanbeusedforarchivingstudentstandard dataandforanalysisofperformanceonstandards individually and as a class.	
StudentChart	- ThisreportmirrorstheonscreenStudent chart. It includes student names and their record information (i.e. ID, gender, status, address etc.). - Itcanbeusedforarchivingstudentrecord dataandforcreatingspecialtyreportsfor book numbers, phon number, addresses, etc.	
Student MissingWork	- Thisreportincludesalistofassignments for which a student has scores that count as missing. It can include missing work from multiple subjects for a student in a single report. - Use this report to missing assignment to students and parents.	

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StudentNotes	- Thisreportsallowyoutoprintthenotesin theStudentNotesviewoftheSummaries window.Youcanalsoincludethescorenotes. - Itcanbeusedforreportingandarchiving thesenotes.	STUDENT NOTES - Quarter 1: Reading Harris, Hilary, August 11 Choi, Jeff - Book Report: Great report!! Shows much work. Kramer, Jennifer - Journal Entry: Hilary shows great effort despite his difficulties with language. No score given. - Level Test: Hilary scored low on this but is trying. No score recorded. - Science Essay: ESL student. Hilary was hard, getting better. - Class Essay: Hilary tried his best to follow the subject of the essay topic. Still has great trouble translating meanings into his writing. No score given. Kramer, Jennifer - Journal Entry: Jennifer said she didn't want to do this work and ripped the papers. Very frustrated. - Journal: Jennifer's missing work is affecting her grade in Reading. Taylor, Roger - Chart Lesson: Was there only for half of lesson due to hand practice.																																																																																								
Student Progress(re-reportcard)	- Thisreportincludescomprehensiveinfor-mationaboutasinglestudentfromoneor multipleclasses. - Extensiveoptionsareavailablegivingyou greatcontroloverthecontentofeachreport. - Itcanbeusedtoreportstudentinformation toparents,studentsandforstudentfolders. Itcanbeusedasareportcard.	STUDENT PROGRESS REPORT Bradford, Karen Hilary, August 18 Bradford, Karen Hello Parents, This is the first progress report of the year. Please look it over and let me know if you have any questions. We are off to a great start and want to keep the momentum going throughout the year! You can contact me at... <table><thead><tr><th>Quarter 1 Assignments</th><th>Score</th><th>Points</th><th>Grade</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>1 8/1/06 Homework</td><td>50/50</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A</td></tr><tr><td>3 8/14/06 Test-Quiz</td><td>28/25</td><td>140/200</td><td>88.0% Dropped</td></tr><tr><td>4 8/14/06 Homework</td><td>50/50</td><td>75/75</td><td>100.0% A</td></tr><tr><td>5 8/25/06 Homework</td><td>50/50</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A</td></tr><tr><td>6 8/29/06 Homework</td><td>50/50</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A</td></tr><tr><td>7 10/1/06 Performance</td><td>15/15</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A</td></tr><tr><td>8 10/29/06 Homework</td><td>50/50</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A</td></tr><tr><td>9 10/30/06 Test-Quiz</td><td>47/50</td><td>188/200</td><td>94.0% A</td></tr><tr><td>10 11/16/06 Homework</td><td>50/50</td><td>187/180</td><td>103.9% A</td></tr></tbody></table><table><thead><tr><th>Quarter 2 Assignments</th><th>Score</th><th>Points</th><th>Grade</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>1 8/12/06 Test-Quiz</td><td>50/50</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A</td></tr><tr><td>2 8/18/06 Homework</td><td>15/15</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A</td></tr><tr><td>3 8/18/06 Homework</td><td>50/50</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A</td></tr><tr><td>5 8/25/06 Homework</td><td>47/50</td><td>84/100</td><td>84.0% A</td></tr><tr><td>6 8/29/06 Homework</td><td>50/50</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A</td></tr><tr><td>7 10/1/06 Homework</td><td>50/50</td><td>75/75</td><td>100.0% A</td></tr><tr><td>8 10/29/06 Test-Quiz</td><td>33/35</td><td>140/200</td><td>88.0% B</td></tr><tr><td>10 11/16/06 Homework</td><td>50/50</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A</td></tr></tbody></table><table><thead><tr><th>Quarter 3 Assignments</th><th>Score</th><th>Points</th><th>Grade</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>1 8/20/06 Homework</td><td>50/50</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A</td></tr><tr><td>2 8/21/06 Homework</td><td>50/50</td><td>50/50</td><td>100.0% A</td></tr></tbody></table>	Quarter 1 Assignments	Score	Points	Grade	1 8/1/06 Homework	50/50	50/50	100.0% A	3 8/14/06 Test-Quiz	28/25	140/200	88.0% Dropped	4 8/14/06 Homework	50/50	75/75	100.0% A	5 8/25/06 Homework	50/50	50/50	100.0% A	6 8/29/06 Homework	50/50	50/50	100.0% A	7 10/1/06 Performance	15/15	50/50	100.0% A	8 10/29/06 Homework	50/50	50/50	100.0% A	9 10/30/06 Test-Quiz	47/50	188/200	94.0% A	10 11/16/06 Homework	50/50	187/180	103.9% A	Quarter 2 Assignments	Score	Points	Grade	1 8/12/06 Test-Quiz	50/50	50/50	100.0% A	2 8/18/06 Homework	15/15	50/50	100.0% A	3 8/18/06 Homework	50/50	50/50	100.0% A	5 8/25/06 Homework	47/50	84/100	84.0% A	6 8/29/06 Homework	50/50	50/50	100.0% A	7 10/1/06 Homework	50/50	75/75	100.0% A	8 10/29/06 Test-Quiz	33/35	140/200	88.0% B	10 11/16/06 Homework	50/50	50/50	100.0% A	Quarter 3 Assignments	Score	Points	Grade	1 8/20/06 Homework	50/50	50/50	100.0% A	2 8/21/06 Homework	50/50	50/50	100.0% A
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2 8/21/06 Homework	50/50	50/50	100.0% A																																																																																							

FAQ:HowcanIgetaprogressreporttofitonasingle sheetofpaper?

Onewaytoshortenaprogressreportistolimitthenumberofassignmentsatareincluded.Therearetwocommon waystodothis:1)intheoptionswindowfor aprogressreport,clickthesetbuttonaftertheAssignmentChartoption, chooseAssignmentsonorafter->fromtheIncludemenuandsetadateonthecalendar;2)inthecorechart,use itemsintheViewmenutohidesomeoftheassignments;intheoptionswindow foraprogressreport,clickthesetbuttonaftertheAssignmentChartoptionandchooseDisplayedAssignmentsOnlyfromtheIncludemenu.

FAQ:Someassignmentsarenotshowingupinprogressreports.Howdofixthis?

FromtheChartmenu,chooseAssignment.FindthecolumnlabeledProgressReport.Makesureyoudon'thavethis fieldsettoExcludeonassignmentstobeincluded.

FAQ:Whyareclassesmissingonastudent'smulti-classprogressreport?WhyamIgettingtwodifferent multi-classprogressreportsforastudent,eachwithdifferentclasses?

Thestudent'snameor IDnumberisdifferentinthedifferentclass(es).CorrectthenameorIDnumberandprint again.

FAQ: How do I remove the Overall column in a multi-class progress report?

If you have combined two or more terms, the multi-class progress report automatically includes columns for each term and for the overall grade. If you want to include individual term grades but not the overall column, combine your terms using weights of 0% for each prior term class and 100% for the current term class. Also, do not curve or lock the overall grade for any student in any current term class. Under these conditions, Easy Grade Pro will automatically omit the Overall column.

FAQ: How can I use the multi-class progress report as a report card for multiple teachers' grades?

First create a master gradebook that contains gradebooks from multiple teachers. To do so, start a new gradebook. When a new window appears stating that the gradebook has no classes, click the Import button (or choose Import from the File menu). Under the Built-in Format tab, select Combine Gradebooks and click Next. In the window that appears, select one of the gradebooks and click Open. In a matter of seconds, all classes in the other gradebook will be imported in the master gradebook. Continue using the Combine Gradebooks format until all gradebooks have been imported. Print reports. It is important that the students' names or ID numbers are identical in all teachers' gradebooks. Note: there is a 250 class limit for a gradebook which means that you can't typically combine up to ten gradebooks.

FAQ: How do I show points in a progress report?

In the options window for a progress report, click the set button after the Grade Summary Chart option and turn on Points Earned. Click the set button after the Assignment Chart option and turn on Points Earned.

FAQ: How can I use a progress report as a missing work report?... as an attendance report?

In the options window for a progress report, turn on the Assignment Chart item, click the set button after this item and choose Missing Assignments Only from the Include menu. For an attendance report, turn on the Attendance Summary item, click the set button after this item to select the desired attendance items. Click the Labels button in the main Print Reports window to change the title of the report.

FAQ: What is the Completed Work Average and how is it calculated?

The Completed Work average, which is found in summaries and reports, is calculated in the same way as the student's Overall average except that assignments with scores that count as missing and scores of zero (which typically indicate missing work) are omitted. If a student has no scores that count as missing or zero scores, then the Overall average (assuming that terms have not been combined) and the Completed Work average will be identical. Since missing scores and zeros can have a large, negative impact on a student's Overall average, the Completed Work average can be useful in assessing student capabilities and in motivating students to complete work.

14 Emailing Student Reports

Keeping students and parents regularly informed about classroom performance can be one of the most beneficial tasks that a teacher can perform. It can also be time-consuming and costly. By using EasyGrade Pro's emailing tools, this task can become quick and inexpensive. EasyGrade Pro allows you to email student progress reports *directly* to students and parents without any need for a dedicated email program.

In order to email, you'll need two things: 1) email addresses of students, parents, or guardians, and 2) access to an SMTP (email) server that supports the most common protocols for emailing. In many cases, you can use the SMTP server that you use for emailing at school or at home. Unfortunately, the free email services likely won't work; they are typically limited to encourage people to switch to fee-based services. Fortunately, there are numerous inexpensive services available. Visit www.easygrade.pro.com for our current recommendations. Although not required, we strongly recommend that you use a high-speed internet connection so that the emails can be sent quickly.

Email Addresses

You can enter up to two email addresses for each student in a class for the student, parent, or guardian. If a student does not have an email address, the student will be excluded when reports are emailed. If many or most students have the same domain (i.e. `student1@myserver.com`, `student2@myserver.com`), then you can omit the domain (i.e. `@myserver.com`); a default domain can be entered later for all students with missing domains.

To enter email addresses in the Records window:

- 1 Choose Records from the Chart menu.
- 2 Select the Student tab.
- 3 Select the first (or desired) student from the Record menu.
- 4 Enter email addresses in the *Email Address 1* and *Email Address 2* fields.

To enter email addresses in the Student chart:

- 1 Choose Student from the Chart menu.

2 Find the column titled Email1 and Email2.

3 Type the addresses.

Email Setup Options

Before you can send emails, you will need to set certain options in your gradebook known as Email Setup options. You will need information from your school or your ISP for setting these options. It may be helpful to study your Account settings in your current email program—the settings in Easy Grade Pro will likely be very similar.

When setting these options, accuracy is critical; spelling, punctuation, spacing must be exact or else the SMTP server will reject the emails.

The screenshot shows the 'Email/Internet' window. On the left, the 'Email Setup' section is expanded, showing fields for Teacher Email, Teacher Name for Email, SMTP (email) Server, and SMTP (email) Password. There are also checkboxes for 'Override default SMTP port: 25', 'SMTP Server requires authentication', and 'Batch emails to avoid spam-blocking'. The 'Batch emails to avoid spam-blocking' section includes 'Emails in batch' (set to 1) and 'Delay between batches' (set to 5 sec). At the bottom, there is a 'Default @domain for incomplete email addresses:' field. On the right, the 'STUDENT PROGRESS REPORT' for Friday, August 18, 2006, is displayed for Bradford, Karen. The report includes a message to parents and a table of Quarter 1 Assignments.

#	Date	Reading	Assignment	Score	Points	Grade
1	9/7/06	Classwork	Journal Intro.	50/50	50/50	100.0% A+
3	9/14/06	Test-Quiz	Level Test	20/25	160/200	80.0% Dropped
4	9/14/06	Homework	Summer Essay	50/50	75/75	100.0% A+
5	9/25/06	Classwork	Indiv. Study	50/50	50/50	100.0% A+
6	9/28/06	Classwork	Literature Circle Report	50/50	50/50	100.0% A+
7	10/1/06	Performance	Chart Lesson	15/15	50/50	100.0%

To set Email Setup options:

1 Choose Email/Internet from the File menu. The Email/Internet window will open (shown above).

2 From the Action menu, select Email Student Reports.

3 Select the Option tab.

4 Find the Email Setup section and click the button to the left to open the list of options.

5 In the *Teacher Email* field, enter your email address. This is used 1) when you send email to yourself to confirm that emails are being sent properly and 2) as the return email address when the recipients want to respond to the emails you've sent.

6 In the *Teacher Name for Email* field, enter your name as you'd like it to appear in the From field in the receiver's email program.

7 In the *SMTP (email) Server* field, enter your outgoing email server name. SMTP servers are the com-

puter that takes the emails we send and routes them through the internet. The SMTP server name often includes the letters 'smtp'.

8 The *Override default SMTP port* option should not be set unless your documentation directs you to set this. If so, turn this option on and set the port number in the box.

9 The next set of options involves Authentication. Authentication is a process in which EasyGradePro proves your identity to the SMTP server so that it will accept your emails. If your SMTP server requires authentication (and most do), turn on the *SMTP Server requires authentication* option and enter your *Account ID* and *Password*.

EasyGradePro supports the most common authentication types. If your SMTP server requires an authentication type not supported by EasyGradePro, then it will refuse the connection. In this case, it will be necessary to use a different SMTP server. There are many inexpensive SMTP services available on the internet that support the most common authentication types. Visit www.easygradepro.com for our current recommendations.

10 The *Batch emails to avoid spam-blocking* option should not be set unless you experience a certain type of problem while emailing. If you are able to regularly email a certain number of reports and then receive an error message, you may be experiencing spam-blocking. Some SMTP servers limit the number of emails being sent at one time in an attempt to block spam. EasyGradePro will display the error message from the SMTP server; it may be cryptic or it may clearly indicate that the SMTP server has stopped accepting emails because too many have been sent (i.e. 451 requested action aborted: too many messages on a single connection). If you suspect spam-blocking, turn on this option and use the *Emails in batch* option to set how many emails are sent as a group and the *Delay between batches* option to set the delay in seconds between each group of emails. Setting the batch to 1 and the delay to 60 seconds will likely be successful but may require a lot of time to email all reports. Use a trial-and-error approach to find settings that will allow successful emailing in the least amount of time. Alternately, you could switch to a less restrictive SMTP server.

11 (Optional) If many or most of your student email addresses share the same domain and you entered their email addresses without domains, put the domain in the *Default@domain for incomplete email addresses* field.

Emailing Reports

Once you have entered email addresses for your students and have entered Email Setup options, you are ready to begin emailing. Here's how:

1 Choose *Email/Internet* from the File menu. The Email/Internet window will open.

2 From the Action menu, select *Email Student Reports*.

3 From the *formenu*, choose which students are to receive emails. Students without email addresses will be automatically omitted. If you select the *Students selected in the list* option, then click the List tab and select the desired students. Hold down the Ctrl (Windows), Command (Macintosh) or shift key to select multiple students.

4 Select the Option tab. In the *Email Subject* field, enter the text that you would like to have appear in the

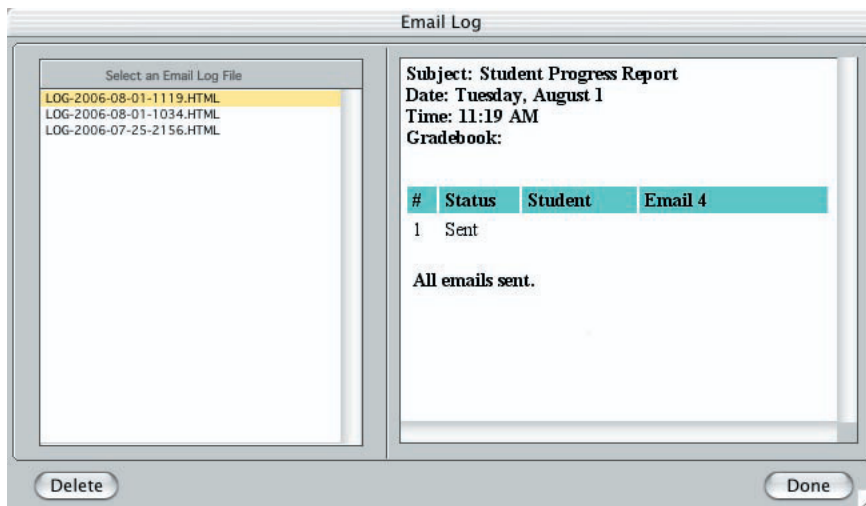
receiver's email program in the Subject field. If you would like to have the student's name or ID also appear in the subject, set the **With Student** menu appropriately.

5 Set the **Email To** options. At least one item must be selected. It is strongly recommended that, at first, you send all email to yourself exclusively until you are happy with the results. Then send email to others.

6 Set all desired options in the **Report Options** section of the list of options. As you make changes, they will be reflected in the preview pane to the right.

7 Click the **Send** button to begin emailing. If this button is disabled, then check your **Email Options** to ensure that you have everything set up properly. Also, make sure that, if you are emailing only to students selected in the list, you have at least one student selected.

8 (Optional) Click the **Email Log** button to open the window where you can view the results of all email attempts. This window can be especially helpful if errors occur so you can determine which students were sent emails.



FAQ: I've emailed reports successfully but some receiversexplain that they can't view them. How come?

EasyGradePro's email reports use HTML to make them more readable, professional-looking and attractive. Most email programs will have no trouble displaying them. In some cases, a user might turn off HTML in their email programs and so won't be able to view the report. In other cases, a user might have an email program that is too old to display HTML. In anticipation of this, EasyGradePro's report emails include an alternate message to be displayed to minimize confusion...

"This student grade report is in HTML format. Since your email program does not understand this format, you will not be able to view it. Please inform the sender."

If a person reports this to you, advise them to try to turn on HTML in their email program or switch to a newer one.

15 Internet Reports

EasyGradePro offers different ways to securely post student reports on the internet: Website Reports, Edline and Basmati. Each is very different and has its own set of features. Use the chart below to help you choose the best option for your situation and then jump to the appropriate section that follows for detailed instructions. This chapter also explains how to create HTML student reports for general use.

	WEBSITE REPORTS	EDLINE	BASMATI
Webserver	School or district web server or web space provided by an ISP.	Secure server provided and maintained by Edline.	School or district web server.
For	Individuals and schools.	Schools and districts.	Schools and districts.
To upload	The teacher uses Easy Grade Pro to create a folder of reports. The teacher then uses an ftp program (or other means) to upload the folder to the webserver.	EasyGradePro works closely with Edline to automatically upload reports to Edline's web server.	The teacher uses Easy Grade Pro to create a report file. The teacher then uses a web browser to upload the file to the webserver.
Security	Password protection. Passwords are managed by the teacher.	Encryption of uploaded reports. Secure website. Passwords for school personnel, students and passwords.	Password protection.
Other	Free. Can work with existing school or personal webpages.	Monthly or annual fee. Full-featured service. Import students into EasyGradePro from Edline.	Free. Can work with existing school webpages.

Using Website Reports

EasyGradePro's Website Reports are for individual teachers and for schools that want a free and secure way to post student reports for viewing on the internet. EasyGradePro creates the reports and the security pages. The reports can then be transferred to your school's web server or to web space provided by an ISP using ftp or some other means.

To gain access to a report, the viewer must enter the student's name and password. Security comes through the use of encrypted student report names and Javascript built into web browsers. For best security, we recommend that reports are not viewed using computers shared by others in a public environment because the browser history stored by web browsers may allow access to reports previously viewed. This risk can be substantially reduced if the browser history is turned off.

To setup Website Reports with password security:

1 Choose Student from the Chart menu and enter passwords in the Password column. Not only are passwords used to gain access to reports on the internet, they are used as filters when creating reports: students without passwords are skipped. Passwords may consist of letters and numbers and must be between six and twenty-four characters in length. They are not case sensitive.

FAQ: I've imported passwords. Why aren't they showing up?

It is possible to import student passwords from roster files into EasyGradePro gradebooks. However, if the password is not at least six characters in length, EasyGradePro will discard it. Passwords below this minimum are substantially easier to hack; that's why EasyGradePro won't accept them.

2 Choose Email/Internet from the File menu or click the Internet tool



to open the Email/Internet

STUDENT PROGRESS REPORT
Saturday, August 19

Bradford, Karen Name

Hello Parents,

This is the first progress report of the year. Please look it over and let me know if you have any questions. We are off to a great start and want to keep the momentum going throughout the year! You can contact me at....

Quarter 1 Assignments

#	Date	Reading	Assignment	Score	Points	Grade
1	9/7/06	Classwork	Journal Intro.	50/50	50/50	100.0% A+
3	9/14/06	Test-Quiz	Level Test	20/25	160/200	80.0% Dropped
4	9/14/06	Homework	Summer Essay	50/50	75/75	100.0% A+
5	9/25/06	Classwork	Indiv. Study	50/50	50/50	100.0% A+
6	9/28/06	Classwork	Literature Circle Report	50/50	50/50	100.0% A+
7	10/1/06	Performance	Chart Lesson	15/15	50/50	100.0% A+
8	10/5/06	Homework	Journal	50/50	50/50	100.0% A+
9	10/9/06	Test-Quiz	In-Class Essay	47/50	188/200	94.0% A
10	10/16/06	Classwork	Book Report	100/100	100/100	100.0% A+

3 From the *Action* menu, select *Create Website Reports*.

4 From the *formenu*, select the classes. If you only teach one class or if you wish to post only one class online, then select the first item. Most teachers will select the second item to include all classes in the current term. If you select the last item, be sure to select one or more classes from the list below the *List* tab.

5 Set options under the *Option* tab. The effects of most options are instantly viewable in the preview to the right. The *Security Page Options* are exceptions. The security page is a password page where the viewer must choose a class, enter a name and password. Use the *Include Greeting Text* option to create a message for this page. Use the *Include Teacher Email* to enter your email address if you'd like it to appear as well.

FAQ: How can I ensure that I don't compromise the privacy rights of my students?

*For the greatest security, we recommend that you either turn off the *Include Student Title Data* option or that you set the *Student Identifiers* option to *Omit for Security*. This will help ensure that, even if a report is hacked, the identity of the student will remain unknown.*

6 Click the *Create* button. Follow the prompt to create a folder on your desktop. Give the folder an exact name such as 'teachername' *Grades*. Perhaps your school will provide you with a name. Easy Grade Pro will automatically create the main page, named *index.html*, other special files and a folder with reports for each class. Be sure to use the same folder name every time you create reports so that the link that you set up to your *index.html* does not break when uploading new reports.

FAQ: Why don't I see an *index.html* page in each folder?

*When creating Website reports, Easy Grade Pro will remind you to name the main file as *index.html*. However, Easy Grade Pro does not force you to use *index.html* in case your school wants you to use something else. If you changed this name either by accident or on purpose, then Easy Grade Pro will remember this name and reuse it the next time. To change it back, go through the steps to create website reports and change the name back to *index.html*.*

7 Quit Easy Grade Pro.

8 (Optional) To view the reports before uploading them to your web server, find the folder you created with the reports, open it and double-click on the *index.html* page. If it doesn't open, first open your web browser, choose *Open* from the *File* menu, then navigate to the *index.html* page and open it.

9 Transfer the folder of reports to your web server. If you will be posting grades on your school server, your school may provide you with the instructions to complete this step. If you will be posting grades on your ISP's web server, then you will likely need an ftp program to upload the folder. FTP programs are commonly available at computer software stores. Your ISP will be able to provide you with the settings that you'll need for your ftp program. If your web layout program includes an ftp program, you may be able to use it to upload the folder of reports to your web server.

10 Using a web layout program, provide a link from your school's webpage or a personal webpage to the *index.html* page within your folder of grade reports on your web server. The web layout program will have instructions on how to set up links.

Using Edline

Edline provides a complete Internet platform that serves as your school's website or as a companion website. It allows easy uploading of student reports directly from EasyGrade Pro making it the easiest way to regularly upload reports. For information view www.edline.com or call 1-800-491-0010. Once your Edline account has been set up and your school's classes and students have been defined, you'll be able to begin downloading classes and uploading student reports.

To download classes and students:

- 1 Create a new gradebook but do not add classes to it. For help with this step, refer to the section *Starting a New Gradebook* on page 19. You do not need to add classes yet.
- 2 When the *Guide Me: No Classes* window appears, click the *Edline Class Data Sync* button. Or, choose Email/Internet from the File menu.
- 3 From the *Action* menu, choose *Sync Classes with Edline* and click the *Sync* button. Follow the prompts that appear. To update your class rosters at a later date, choose Email/Internet from the File menu and repeat this step.

To prepare your classes for uploading reports:

If you downloaded classes and students from Edline using the *Sync Classes with Edline* tool, then your gradebook is already set up for uploading reports. Otherwise, you will need to enter Class IDs for all classes and IDs for all students before uploading. Here's how:

- 1 Obtain lists of Class IDs and student IDs from your school.
- 2 To enter Class IDs, choose *Records* from the *Chart* menu and select the *Classes* tab. Find the *Custom Data* title. Enter the Class ID into the first row under *Custom Data* unless you are directed by your school to use a different row. Switch to the next class and repeat this. Continue until all classes have Class IDs.
- 3 To enter student IDs, choose *Student* from the *Chart* menu. Find the *ID* column and enter all student IDs. Continue until all students have IDs in all classes.

To upload reports:

- 1 Choose Email/Internet from the File menu or click the Internet tool  to open the Email/Internet window.
- 2 From the *Action* menu, select *Upload Reports to Edline*.
- 3 From the *form* menu, select the classes. If you select the last item, be sure to select one or more classes from the list below the List tab.
- 4 Select the *Options* tab and set the Edline Options:
 - The *Edline Report/Folder Name* is the name of the folder to hold the reports on Edline. This name will be visible to viewers. You can use one or more folders for different reports such as *Quarter 1 Reports*, *Quarter 2 Reports*, *Final Reports*, *Missing Work Reports*, *November Grades*, etc. If you want to upload reports that replace older reports for your student, use the same name for the folder. If you want to upload reports that do not replace older reports, use a new folder name.
 - From the *Get Edline Class ID from* menu, select the field in the *Records* window that is holding the Clas-

sID. Select the first item unless your school directs you to select something else.

5 If you turn on the *Include Multiple Classes (in each report)* option, then you will need to enter a special ClassID into the *Edline (multi-class) ClassID* field. Don't do this unless your school directs you to do so and provides you with a special ClassID. You must also enter an *Edline (multi-class) Class Title* (i.e. *Ms. Demo's 6th Grade*).

6 Set the remaining report options under the *Options* tab as desired.

7 Click the **Upload** button. If you are not using a *always on* connection to the Internet, be sure to connect before clicking **Upload**. EasyGrade Pro will open your web browser to the Edline server and send the reports. During the process you will be prompted to enter your Edline screen name and password.

8 View one or more reports. To view the reports, log into Edline and go to the homepage for any class whose reports you uploaded. Click on the name of the report folder in the **Contents** box. You will see a list of reports. The title of each report is the student's name. To view an individual report, click on a student's name. You, as the teacher, will see all the reports. When students and parents click on the folder, they will only see their own reports.

Using Basmati

Basmati is *open-source software* which means the software is not only free, but the actual code is available and can be freely modified by those that know how. It can run on your school or district's web server. Software and documentation are available for downloading at <http://www.sourceforge.net>. (Search for Basmati.) Parents and students can use a single password to view grades from all classes and teachers. Once your school or district has set up the software on its server, you can use EasyGrade Pro to generate a single grade file with information on all of your students and classes and upload it to the server using your browser.

To prepare your classes for uploading reports:

1 Ensure that each class in your grade book has a *Course Code* and other values. These codes may be imported into your grade book directly from school administration software or you may need to manually enter them into fields in the **Records** window for each class you teach. To open this window, choose **Records** from the **Chart** menu. Then select the **Classes** tab. Typically, the *Course Code* will be in the first field under the **Custom Data** title and the others below it. Follow the instructions provided by your school.

2 Ensure that each student has a student ID. The IDs may be imported into your grade book directly from school administration software or you may need to manually enter them. The student ID can be entered into the student ID field in the **Records** window, under the **Students** tab or can be entered directly into the **Student** chart. Choose **Student** from the **Chart** menu to view this chart.

To create a Basmati report file:

1 Choose **Email/Internet** from the **File** menu or click the **Internet** tool



to open the **Email/Internet** window.

2 From the **Action** menu, select *Create Basmati file*.

3 From the **form** menu, select the classes. If you select the last item, be sure to select one or more classes from the list below the **List** tab.

4 Select the *Options* tab and set the Basmati Options using these guidelines:

- *Course#*. Set this to the appropriate custom field in the Records window. This field is required.
- *Section#* and *Period#*. Set these to omit or to the appropriate custom fields in the Records window.
- *Students and Assignments*. Use these to set which students and assignments are to be included. Use these in conjunction with the filters found in the View menu.
- *Teacher Name*. Put your name in this field.
- *Teacher Email*. Put your email in this field. This field is required.
- *TchrID*. Put your password in this field for access to Basmati. This field is required.
- *Phone*. Put your school phone number in this field.
- *Control*. Leave this field blank unless instructed to use it.

5 Click **Create** and save the Basmati.txt file to the desktop of your computer or some other location.

6 Quit EasyGradePro.

To upload a Basmati report file to your school's web server:

- 1 Open your web browser and navigate to your school's Basmati Faculty page.
- 2 Login and click the **Submit File** button.
- 3 Click the **Browse** button. Find and select the Basmati.txt file you created with EasyGradePro.
- 4 Click the **Submit File to Basmati** button.
- 5 For security, be sure to delete the Basmati.txt file when done uploading.

Creating HTML Reports

You can create student reports in HTML format for viewing on your own computer. These can be useful when conferencing with others about student performance.

To create student HTML reports:

1 Choose **Email/Internet** from the **File** menu or use the **Internet** tool



to open the **Email/Internet** window.

2 From the **Action** menu, select **Create HTML Reports**.

3 From the **form** menu, select the students. If you select the last item, be sure to select one or more students from the list below the **List** tab.

4 Set options under the *Options* tab.

5 Click the **Create** button. Follow the prompts to create a folder on your desktop. You may wish to name it something like *Student Reports*. EasyGradePro will create a folder inside it with student reports for each class.

6 Quit EasyGradePro and view the reports using your web browser. Find the folder you created, open it and double-click on any report page. If it doesn't open, open your web browser, choose **Open** from the **File** menu, then navigate to the report and open it.

16 Porting

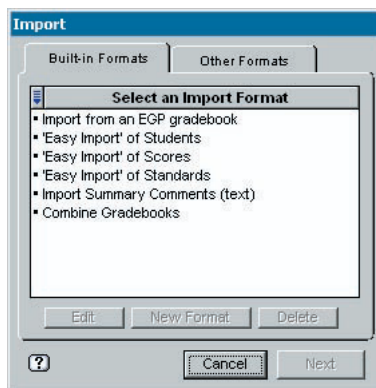
Porting refers to the transfer of data to and from your gradebook. To import means to copy data from another file to your gradebook. To export means to create a new file that holds data from your gradebook. This chapter explains the many ways you can port data.

Importing

Typically, importing is used to bring student names and other student record information into a gradebook, but it can also be used to import options, scores and more. You can import from EasyGradePro gradebooks and text files.

To import:

1 Select **Import** from the **File** menu or use the **Import** tool  to open the **Import** window. The **Import** window has two tabs. Under the first, you'll find the built-in formats. Under the second you'll find user-defined and other editable formats. A format specifies the fields and structure of the data to be imported

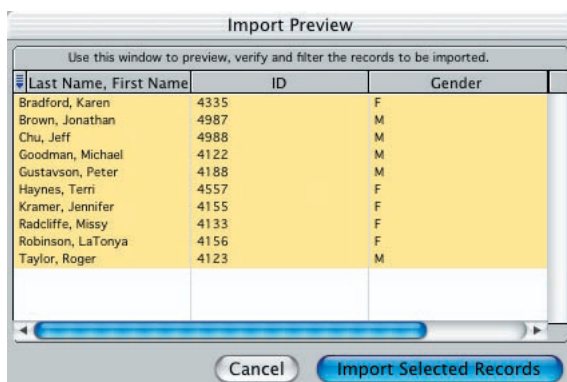


2 (Optional) If the format that you need is not present, you can create one by first clicking the **Other** **Format** tab and then clicking the **New Format** button. For help in creating a format, refer to the section *Creating Formats for Importing and Exporting* on page 113.

3 Select a format, click Next. The formats include:

- **Import from an EGP Gradebook.** Use this format to copy students, options, assignments, a whole class, etc. from another Easy Grade Pro gradebook. The Import Gradebook window will appear where you can select the items to be imported.
- **“Easy Import” of Students.** Use this format to import students from most tab-separated or comma-separated text files. Many database and spreadsheet programs use this format when creating text files. The Easy Import window will open where you can identify the fields in a record from the file. You must identify the first and last names but all other fields are optional. You must also name the format so that it can be added to the Import window where it can be reused directly.
- **“Easy Import” of Scores.** Use this format to import scores from most tab-separated or comma-separated text files. The records may be in any order as long as each contains a score and an ID number (or student name) to be used for matching. The Easy Import window will open where you must identify the score and the ID number (or student name) fields.
- **“Easy Import” of Standards.** Use this format to import standards from most tab-separated or comma-separated text files. The records may be in any order as long as each contains a standard ID and standard text. The Easy Import window will open where you must identify these fields.
- **Import Summary Comments.** Use this format to import a list of summary comments from a text file. The file must have comments only. This will replace the list in the Student Comments view of the Summaries window.
- **Combine Gradebooks.** Use this format to combine one or more gradebooks from other teachers into a single master gradebook to be used for the printing of multi-class progress reports or other reports. Note: there is a 250 class limit for a gradebook which means that you can typically combine up to ten gradebooks.
- **Other Formats.** The formats that appear under the Other Formats tab can only be used to import students and student record data from text files. There is a small blue arrow above the list of formats which allows you to duplicate a format or create a plug-in of a format. A plug-in is a small file that makes it easy to distribute a format to other Easy Grade Pro users. See *Using Plug-in* on page 138 for additional information.

4 For some formats, the Import Preview window will appear so that you can verify the data and select the records (students) to be imported.



Be sure to check that the data in the columns properly match the column titles. If they match, click the **Import Selected Records** button. If a selected student has the same ID number as a student currently in the class, the import data will be used to *update* the student's record information. The student will not be duplicated in the class. This behavior allows you to import additional data, such as email addresses and passwords, later as long as the file as student ID numbers for matching.

FAQ: Can EasyGrade Pro import student rosters from my school's school administration software and can it export grade data back to it?

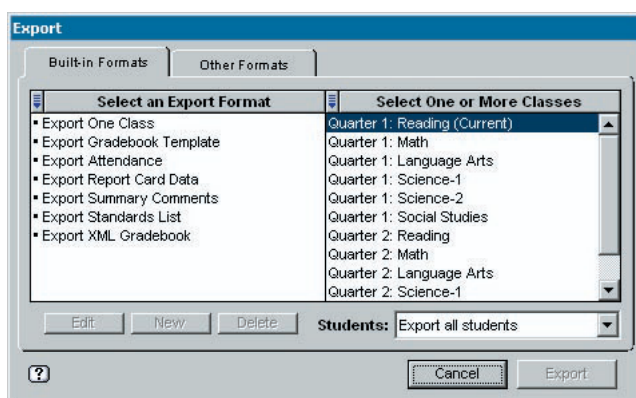
In many cases the answer is 'Yes'. If your school administration software can produce a roster file for a class in text format and if it can read a grade file for a class in text format, the standard version of EasyGrade Pro can probably share data with it. You, or someone at your school with the proper knowledge and expertise may have to create import and export formats within EasyGrade Pro. Plug-ins can be used to distribute the format to other users. For help, see *Creating Formats for Importing and Exporting* on page 113 and *Using Plug-ins* on page 118. In some cases, custom versions of EasyGrade Pro are required. Contact Orbis Software for availability and pricing for custom versions.

Exporting

Exporting is typically used to transfer student grade data to a program used to print report cards, but it can also be used to transfer all kinds of student information to word processor, spreadsheet or database software to take advantage of the unique tools of these programs. When exporting, you can create two types of files: EasyGrade Pro gradebooks and text files. *Text* is a standard file format that many programs use for transferring data to other programs.

To export:

1 Select **Export** from the **File** menu or use the **Export** tool **EX** to open the **Export** window. The **Export** window has two tabs. Under the first tab, you'll find export formats that are built-in. Under the second tab you'll find user-defined and other editable formats. A format is used to specify the fields of the data to be exported.



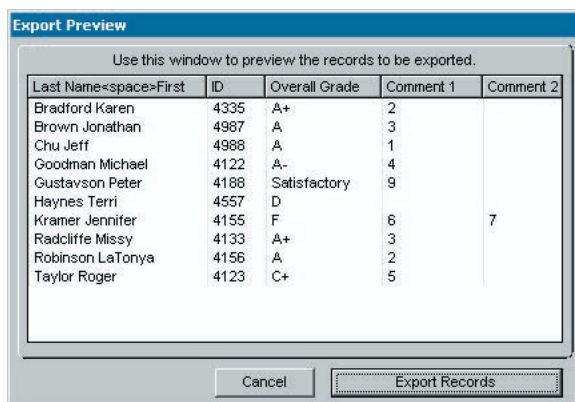
2 (Optional) If the format that you need is not present, you can create one by first clicking the **Other Formats** tab and then clicking the **New Format** button. For help in creating a format, refer to the section *Creating Formats for Importing and Exporting* on page 113.

3 Select the classes to be exported from the list on the left. Select the students to be exported using the menu below the list.

4 Select a format and click Next. What happens after clicking depends on the selected format. The formats include:

- **ExportOneClass.** Use this format to create a new gradebook with a single class. This can be used to create a file with data to be imported into another gradebook.
- **ExportGradebookTemplate.** Use this format to create a new gradebook that has only the settings from the gradebook options, class options, comments windows. The template can be used by others when starting their gradebooks.
- **ExportAttendance.** This format is usually not selected directly because it is automatically used whenever the Export Attendance tool is selected from the toolbar. For help, refer to the section *Exporting Attendance* on page 114.
- **ExportReportCardData.** This format can be used to export student graded data to database software that prints custom report cards. This is explained in detail in the section *Using the Report Card Data Format* on page 116.
- **ExportSummaryComments.** Use this format to create a text file of the list of comments found in the Summaries window.
- **ExportStandardsList.** Use this format to create a text file of the standards in a class.
- **ExportXMLGradebook.** This format allows you to export virtually all student data from one or more classes in an XML format. Although this data will not be usable by most off-the-shelf programs, district programmers or programmers at other software companies can write their own program to take advantage of this data for your benefit. For example, a program could be written to gather the student standard grades from the XML files created by multiple teachers for an analysis of student performance on state standards.
- **Other Formats.** The formats that appear under the Other Format tab can only be used to export student data to text files. There is a small blue arrow above the list of formats which allows you to duplicate or create a plug-in of a format. A plug-in is a small file that makes it easy to distribute a format to other Easy GradePro users. See *Using Plug-in* on page 118 for additional information.

5 If the Export Preview window appears, verify the data and click the Export button.



Creating Formats for Importing or Exporting

If you wish to import or export student data with spreadsheet, database, school administration and other software, you may need to create a porting format. This section explains how to create formats that appear under the Other Format tab in the Import and Export windows.

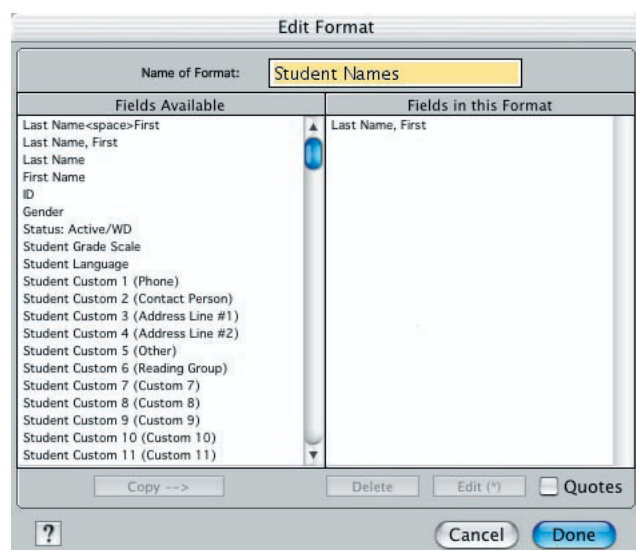
Creating formats requires a certain amount of knowledge of file formats and ASCII codes. In addition, it requires 100% accuracy or else unpredictable results may occur. Proceed with caution!

By default, EasyGrade Pro separates fields (pieces of data) using tabs (ASCII 9) and separates records using a CR (carriage return, ASCII 13). Many word processing, spreadsheet and consumer database programs also use this format when porting. In the PC world, many programs use a CR/LF (carriage return/line feed, ASCII 13/10) combination instead of a CR. You may need to modify a format to include a CR/LF. For help with this, see *FAQ: How do I set the record delimiter to the CR/LF used by most Windows programs?* on page 114.

If you will be porting to or from school administration software, things can be much more difficult because these programs tend to use custom formats. For example, some files may use fixed-length fields (instead of variable length fields) that are left or right justified, with special fill characters and no delimiter except at the end of a record. In many but not all cases, formats can be created in EasyGrade Pro to work with school administrative software.

To create a format:

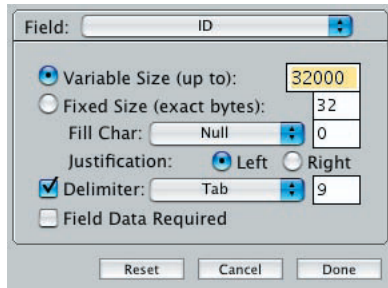
1 From the Import or Export window, select the Other Format tab. Then click the New button. The New Format window will open. On the left side of this window is a list of fields that are available for use in the format.



2 To add a field to your format, select it in the list on the left and click the Copy button. The field is copied to the format list on the right. If a field is in the wrong position in the format list, press on it and drag it to the new location. A format is limited to thirty fields per record.

3 (Optional) Select the Quotes button. Set this item if the data has (if importing) or should have (if exporting) quotation marks around each field. Under many circumstances, EasyGrade Pro will remove quotation marks automatically during importing.

4 (Optional) To customize a field, select it and click the Edit button. EasyGrade Pro automatically uses a tab-delimited format in which each field is variable in length and is followed by a tab (ASCII 9) for most fields and a CR (ASCII 13) for the last field in a record. To change this formatting, or to make a field required (for export formats), select the field in the list on the right and click the Edit button. A small window will open with options for changing the format of a field.



Only those with sufficient knowledge of file formats should attempt to make changes in this window. Any field that has been customized will have an asterisk appended to its name in the list.

If you set the *Field Data Required* item in an export format, EasyGrade Pro will block exporting until all required data are complete.

5 Name the format in the text field at the top of the window and click Done. The name will appear under the Other Format tab in the Import or Export window.

FAQ: How do I set the record delimiter to the CR/LF used by most Windows programs?

By default, EasyGrade Pro adds a CR (ASCII 13) to the end of a record. If your format requires a CR/LF (ASCII 13/10) combination, follow these steps:

- Change the delimiter of the last field to CR (ASCII 13). To do this, select the last field and click the Edit button. In the window that opens, change the delimiter to CR.
- Add a Blank Field to the format. To do this, select Blank Field (the last field) in the list on the left and click the Copy button.
- Change the delimiter of the Blank Field to LF (ASCII 10). To do this, select the field and click the Edit button. In the window that opens, change the delimiter to LF.

Exporting Attendance

EasyGrade Pro allows you to export attendance over a network in just a few steps.

To prepare for the exporting of attendance:

Careful preparations are required before exporting can begin. These are listed next.

- **Attendance Folder.** A folder must be set up on a shared volume to hold the daily attendance export files. The pathname (name of folder, enclosing folders and volume) must not change once exporting has begun. The volume should be automatically mounted on each teacher's computer.

- **Attendance Categories.** Each teacher's gradebook must have the school's attendance categories and codes. Although these can be set by each teacher using the Class Options window, it is suggested that a gradebook template be set up and made available to teachers.

• **ExportAttendanceFormat.** EasyGradePro has a built-in export format for attendance. This format has the name *ExportAttendance* and can be found under the Built-in Formatstab of the Export window. It has the following fields:

- Field1 SelectedDate
- Field2 ID
- Field3 LastName,First
- Field4 SelectedDay'sAttendance

If desired, you can create your own custom format. See the section *Creating Formats for Importing and Exporting* on page 113 for help. In order for EasyGradePro to use your format, it must be named *ExportAttendance*. It is best to include the format in a gradebook template.

• **CalendarSettings.** Attendance data cannot be recorded until calendar options have been set in the Class Options window.

• **ExportAttendanceTool.** The ExportAttendance tool  is used to start the export process. It must be placed on either the toolbar. To add the tool, press and hold on any occupied or unoccupied tool location. Select the ExportAttendance tool from the menu that appears. It is best to include this setting in the gradebook template.

• **GradebookTemplate.** A gradebook template can be used to ensure that all teachers' gradebooks have the same settings. It also minimizes the work that teachers must do. First create a gradebook with the right settings. Then create a template of the gradebook. Refer to the section *Exporting* starting on page 111 for help. Teachers should create their gradebooks directly from the template.

To export attendance:

Before you can export attendance, your gradebook must have the correct attendance categories and export format. The ExportAttendanceTool must be on the toolbar and the volume to receive your attendance data must be mounted on your computer. You must know the name to use for your export file and the location in which it is to be saved. Be sure to enter your attendance data in the attendance chart or seating chart first. Then follow these steps:

1 Click the ExportAttendance tool. A small calendar will appear (shown below). This calendar will automatically display the current date but you may change this by clicking on another date. Click OK.



2 EasyGradePro will gather the attendance data for the selected date and present it in the Export Preview window (shown below). This window is used to verify the attendance data. Note that only students with attendance marks appear. Even if the preview window is empty, it is important to export so that a file is created indicating that attendance has been sent. Click the Export Records button.



3 If this is the first time that you are exporting attendance from the gradebook, the standard Save dialog window will open allowing you to name and save the export file. Use the unique name given to you. The location to save the file should be the attendance folder set up on a shared volume. EasyGradePro will remember the name and location and use them automatically in the future.

If you saved the file using the wrong name or location, you must reset EasyGradePro. To do this, click the Export Records button in the Export Preview window while holding down the *option* (Macintosh) or *Ctrl* (Windows) key. You will be able to reset the name and location.

Using the Report Card Data Format

This section explains the Report Card Data export format found in the Export window of EasyGradePro. This format can be used to export student data to a general-purpose database program so that custom report cards can be printed.

The Report Card Data format consists of 157 fields (listed to the right). Virtually every piece of data about a student is included (other than individual attendance marks and assignment scores). Even the text found in the Summaries window is included. This format results in a tab-delimited text file.

In most cases, this format *cannot* be used with the expensive, out-of-the-box school administration programs. Such programs have very specific data formatting requirements and lack the flexibility to handle the data in the 157 fields.

Rather, this format is to be used with general-purpose database programs, ones that offer a rich set of tools for importing, sorting, searching, data manipulation, and form creation. These powerful programs are relatively inexpensive and are available for both Macintosh and Windows computers. However, using one of these programs to create a well-designed database requires much skill and time. This task is best left to experts.

Once setup, it can be fast and easy to print your school's report cards using data from files created using EasyGradePro's Report Card Data format.

1 LastName,First	54 Category5Grade	107 Term7Points
2 LastName	55 Category6Points	108 Term7%
3 FirstName	56 Category6%	109 Term7Grade
4 ID	57 Category6Grade	110 Term8Points
5 Gender	58 Category7Points	111 Term8%
6 Status	59 Category7%	112 Term8Grade
7 GradeScale	60 Category7Grade	113 Term9Points
8 Language	61 Category8Points	114 Term9%
9 StudentCustom1	62 Category8%	115 Term9Grade
10 StudentCustom2	63 Category8Grade	116 Term10Points
11 StudentCustom3	64 Category9Points	117 Term10%
12 StudentCustom4	65 Category9%	118 Term10Grade
13 StudentCustom5	66 Category9Grade	119 MasterAttendance1
14 StudentCustom6	67 Category10Points	120 MasterAttendance2
15 StudentCustom7	68 Category10%	121 MasterAttendance3
16 StudentCustom8	69 Category10Grade	122 MasterAttendance4
17 StudentCustom9	70 Category11Points	123 MasterAttendance5
18 StudentCustom10	71 Category11%	124 MasterAttendance6
19 StudentCustom11	72 Category11Grade	125 MasterAttendance7
20 StudentCustom12	73 Category12Points	126 MasterAttendance8
21 ClassName	74 Category12%	127 MasterAttendance9
22 ClassWeight	75 Category12Grade	128 MasterAttendance10
23 ClassCustom1	76 Category13Points	129 Attendance1
24 ClassCustom2	77 Category13%	130 Attendance2
25 ClassCustom3	78 Category13Grade	131 Attendance3
26 ClassCustom4	79 Category14Points	132 Attendance4
27 ClassCustom5	80 Category14%	133 Attendance5
28 ClassCustom6	81 Category14Grade	134 Attendance6
29 ClassCustom7	82 Category15Points	135 Attendance7
30 ClassCustom8	83 Category15%	136 Attendance8
31 OverallPoints	84 Category15Grade	137 Attendance9
32 Overall%	85 #MissingAssignments	138 Attendance10
33 OverallGrade	86 CompletedWorkPoints	139 Attendance11
34 ClassRank	87 CompletedWork%	140 Attendance12
35 ClassAverage%	88 CompletedWorkGrade	141 Attendance13
36 ClassAverageGrade	89 Term1Points	142 Attendance14
37 CurrentTermPoints	90 Term1%	143 Attendance15
38 CurrentTerm%	91 Term1Grade	144 Today'sDate(short)
39 CurrentTermGrade	92 Term2Points	145 Comment1(number)
40 Category1Points	93 Term2%	146 Comment2(number)
41 Category1%	94 Term2Grade	147 Comment3(number)
42 Category1Grade	95 Term3Points	148 Comment4(number)
43 Category2Points	96 Term3%	149 Comment5(number)
44 Category2%	97 Term3Grade	150 Comment6(number)
45 Category2Grade	98 Term4Points	151 Comment1(text)
46 Category3Points	99 Term4%	152 Comment2(text)
47 Category3%	100 Term4Grade	153 Comment3(text)
48 Category3Grade	101 Term5Points	154 Comment4(text)
49 Category4Points	102 Term5%	155 Comment5(text)
50 Category4%	103 Term5Grade	156 Comment6(text)
51 Category4Grade	104 Term6Points	157 StudentSummaryNote
52 Category5Points	105 Term6%	
53 Category5%	106 Term6Grade	

Using Plug-ins

Plug-ins are small files created using Easy Grade Pro that can be used to distribute import formats, export formats, standards lists and summary comments to other Easy Grade Pro users.

To create a plug-in of an import or export format:

Choose Import or Export from the File menu, click the Other Format tab and select the desired format from the list. Press on the small blue arrow above the list and choose *Save Item as Plug-in* from the menu that appears. Then name and save the plug-in.

To create a plug-in of a set of standards:

Choose Records from the menu, click the Standard tab and press on the small button next to the Standard ID. Choose *Save Standards as Plug-in*. Then name and save the plug-in.

To create a plug-in of the list of comments in the Summaries window:

Choose Summaries from the Chart menu, click the Students tab on the left and the Comments (balloon) tab on the right. Press on the small blue arrow above the lower list and choose *Save Comments as Plug-in* from the menu that appears. Then name and save the plug-in.

To distribute a plug-in file:

Plug-in files should be placed in the same folder as the Easy Grade Pro application or should be placed in a folder titled *Plug-ins* found in the same folder as the Easy Grade Pro application. Whenever a person opens an Easy Grade Pro gradebook, Easy Grade Pro scans the plug-in and transfers their contents to the gradebook.

Be careful with plug-ins. A plug-in with comments will prevent the user from making lasting changes to comments in the Summary window. If the user makes changes to comments, the next time the gradebook is opened, the changes will be erased and replaced with what is found in the comments plug-in.

To remove a plug-in:

Drag the file out of the *Plug-ins* folder and out of the Easy Grade Pro folder. Note: this does not remove the contents of a plug-in from a gradebook if the contents have already been read into the gradebook.

17 Technical Support

This chapter includes the most frequently asked technical questions about EasyGradePro and where to find the answers. If you can't find your question in this section, at the end you'll find email and phone information for contacting technical support at Orbis Software.

FAQs: Frequently Asked Questions

Chapter 1: Getting Started

- *Can EasyGradePro be networked? (page 6)*
- *Why am I getting an error message when I try to register EasyGradePro? (page 6)*
- *What is the best way to learn the basics of EasyGradePro in the shortest amount of time? (page 8)*

Chapter 3: Gradebooks and Classes

- *EasyGradePro saves automatically. What does this mean? (page 20)*

Chapter 4: Setting Options

- *What is grade-clicking? How does it work? (page 24)*
- *How do I set up my 5-point (or some other point) grading system? (Part 1) (page 25)*
- *How do I enter a checkmark as a special score? (page 27)*
- *How do I set up my 5-point (or some other point) grading system? (Part 2) (page 28)*
- *I don't remember the password. How do I get back in? (page 34)*
- *When I switch classes, my gradebook displays a message 'Gradebook is locked--changes could not be saved'. What is happening? (page 34)*
- *I have a group of students (or just one student) with unique assignments. How can I create a filter to show just this group and its assignments? (page 36)*

Chapter 5: Students and Assignments

- *How do I show a student on the status as has been set to WD (hidden)? (page 42)*
- *Why are the dates wrong on the calendars and in the charts? (page 43)*

- *What are maximum score and points? How should I set them? (page 44)*
- *If I use category weighting, does it matter how I set assignment points? (page 44)*
- *Why can't I change the status on one of my assignments? It is stuck on Normal. (page 45)*

Chapter 6: Using the Score Chart

- *Why does the Find window keep popping up when I enter a score? (page 49)*
- *How does Easy Grade Pro treat blank score cells? How can I easily set all blanks to a certain score? (page 49)*
- *How is a student's overall grade calculated? (page 51)*
- *Why wasn't the lowest score dropped? Why are fewer scores being dropped for some students? (page 53)*
- *How can I keep my original scores on an assignment that I want to curve? (page 55)*

Chapter 7: Using the Standard Chart

- *How many standard ss should I add to my class? (page 64)*
- *What is the Power Law Formula for standards-based grading? (page 66)*

Chapter 9: Making and Managing Backups

- *My gradebook's name is 'Copy of copy of...' What is going on? (page 78)*

Chapter 11: Working with Terms

- *I've combined terms but the prior-term grades or attendance data in reports are wrong. How do I fix this? (page 83)*
- *I need to print reports that show grades from multiple terms but I don't want the grades to be combined to form a multi-term overall grade. What do I do? (page 84)*
- *I have to include a weighted final exam. What do I do? (page 84)*

Chapter 12: Using Summaries

- *How can I check the calculations for one of my students? (page 89)*

Chapter 13: Printing Reports

- *Where is Print? (page 92)*
- *How can I maximize the columns on each page? (page 93)*
- *How do I print multiple reports per sheet of paper? (page 93)*
- *How do I change the teacher or school name that appears on reports? (page 93)*
- *How can I get a progress report to fit on a single sheet of paper? (page 97)*
- *Some assignments are not showing up in progress reports. How do I fix this? (page 97)*
- *Why are classes missing on a student's multi-class progress report? (page 97)*
- *How do I remove the Overall column in a multi-class progress report? (page 98)*
- *How can I use the multi-class progress report as a report card for multiple teachers' grades? (page 98)*
- *How do I show points in a progress report? (page 98)*
- *How can I use a progress report as a missing work report?... as an attendance report? (page 98)*
- *What is the Completed Work Average and how is it calculated? (page 98)*

Chapter 14: Emailing Student Reports

- *I've emailed reports successfully but some receivers explain that they can't view them. How come? (page 99)*

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Chapter 15: Internet Reports

- *I've imported passwords. Why aren't they showing up?* (page 104)
- *How can I ensure that I don't compromise the privacy rights of my students?* (page 105)
- *Why don't I see an index.html page in each folder?* (page 105)

Chapter 16: Porting

- *Can EasyGrade Pro import student rosters from my school's school administration software and can it export graded data back to it?* (page 111)
- *How do I set the record delimiter to the CR/LF used by most Windows programs?* (page 114)

Contacting Orbis Software for Technical Support

Orbis Software provides free technical support to registered users. Before you contact us, please be sure that you have read the FAQs above and you've researched this manual. Be sure to have the following information: your registration number, the version number of EasyGrade Pro (i.e. 4.0.0), your operating system (i.e. XP, MacOS 10.2.8) and a clear description of the problem. If calling for technical support, you are strongly encouraged to be at your computer.

Address: P.O. BOX 73745, Puyallup, WA 98373

Phone: (253) 848-6899 (Pacific Time)

Fax: (253) 848-6505 (fax only)

Web: www.orbissoft.com or www.easygrade.pro

Support: support@orbissoft.com

Sales: sales@orbissoft.com

Tools Reference

Up to twenty tools can be placed on the tool bar. To place a tool on the tool bar, press and hold on any unused tool or on an empty location. From the menu that pops up, select the desired tool.



Add Assignment

Opens the Records window to the first empty assignment record.



Add Furniture

Adds a piece of furniture to the seating chart.



Add Student

Opens the Records window to the first empty student record.



Auto-fill Attendance Scores

Replaces blank scores on selected assignments with special scores based on attendance marks.



Change Scores

Changes all occurrences of a certain score to another score.



Class Options

Opens a window where class options can be edited.



Copy Class Data

Copies selected students, assignments and options to other classes.



Curve Scores

Opens a window where the distribution of scores can be changed.



Delete

Deletes the selected scores, students, assignments, furniture, etc.



Export Attendance

Exports one day's attendance data to a text file over a network.



Export

Opens the Export window.



Fill Across

Repeats the selected data across a row to the last column.



Fill Down

Repeats the selected data down a column to the last row.



Find

Opens a window where search text can be entered.



Find Again

Finds the next matching student or assignment.



Help

Opens the in-context Help window.



Import

Opens the Import window.



Internet

Opens a window where reports can be emailed or prepared for posting on the web.



Lock Gradebook

Locks the gradebook and opens the Lock window.



Next Class

Switches to the next class in the current term.



Next Term

Switches to the next term of the current class.



Print

Opens a window where reports can be printed.



Prior Class

Switches to the prior class in the current term.



Prior Term

Switches to the prior term for the current class.



Restricted Access

Turns the RA mode on and off.



Records

Opens a window with class, student, assignment and standard records.



Rotate Seat

Rotates the selected furniture 90° clockwise.



Save Copy

Makes a backup copy of the current gradebook.



Score Note

Opens a window where text can be entered about a score.



Sort

Sorts students, assignments and seats based on the current chart.



Summaries

Opens a window with extensive summaries.



Undo

Reverses the last action.

Menus Reference

FileMenuReference

File	Use this menu item to...
New...	create a new gradebook
Open...	find and open a gradebook
Close	close the current gradebook
Open Recent	automatically find and open a recently opened gradebook
Save Copy...	save a backup copy of the current gradebook
Compress	make the gradebook smaller
Import...	bring in students (or other data) from another gradebook or text file
Export...	create a file with data from your gradebook to be used by another user or program
Palm Setup...	set syncing options for EGPClipboard
Email/Internet...	email reports, create reports for web posting
Print...	print reports
RAMode	turn on or off the Restricted Access mode
Lock...	lock the gradebook and open the Locked window
Exit	quit

EditMenuReference

Edit	Use this menu item to...
Undo	reverse the last action
Cut	erase the selected items and copy them to the clipboard
Copy	copy the selected items to the clipboard
Paste	copy the items on the clipboard to the insertion point
Clear	erase the selected items
Class Options...	set options for the current class
Gradebook Options...	set options for the entire gradebook

ToolMenuReference

Tool	Use this menu item to...
Copy	copy any class data from one class to others
Add	add a class, student, assignment or standard to this class
Delete	delete a class, student, etc.
Fill	repeat data to the last row/column
Find	find a student or assignment
Score Tools	change groups of scores, curve, lock, enter notes or auto-fill attendance scores
Seat Tools	add furniture, set seat format, rotate seats
Term Tools	combine terms, recombine terms, start a new term

ViewMenuReference

View	Use this menu item to...
Show All	→ 'unhide' all class data except for WD(hidden) students
Show Selected	→ hide all rows/columns except for selected ones
Hide Selected	→ hide selected rows/columns
Filters	▶ → show and hide items based on rules
Sort Assign.	→ change the order of assignments
Sort Seats	→ sort students into seats
Sort Students	→ change the order of students
Sort Standards...	→ change the order of standards
Sort Classes...	→ change the order of classes
Group Students...	→ put students into groups randomly or based on ability

ChartMenuReference

Chart	Use this menu item to...
Score	→ view the Score chart
Attendance	→ view the Attendance chart
Seating	→ view the Seating chart
Student	→ view the Student chart
Assignment	→ view the Assignment chart
Standard	→ view the Standard chart
Records...	→ view, edit or add classes, students, assignments and standards
Summaries...	→ view summaries of student performance

ClassMenuReference

Class	Use this menu item to...
Next	→ view the next class
Prior	→ view the prior class
Term 1	▶ → switch to any class in any term
Term 2	▶
Term 3	▶ (The labels in this menu will reflect the labels found in the Records window.)
Term 4	▶
Term 5	▶
Term 6	▶
Term 7	▶
Term 8	▶
Term 9	▶
Term 10	▶

HelpMenuReference

Help	Use this menu item to...
EasyGradeProHelp	→ view in-context Help
EasyGradeProManual	→ view the user manual
EasyGradeProOnline	→ view the EasyGradePro website
Show Tool Tags(Tips)	→ toggle on or off the small tool name box that appears when the mouse is over a tool